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NEW DELHI/METRO/GURUGRAM/NOIDA
Wednesday, **October 28**, 2026

Hindustan Times

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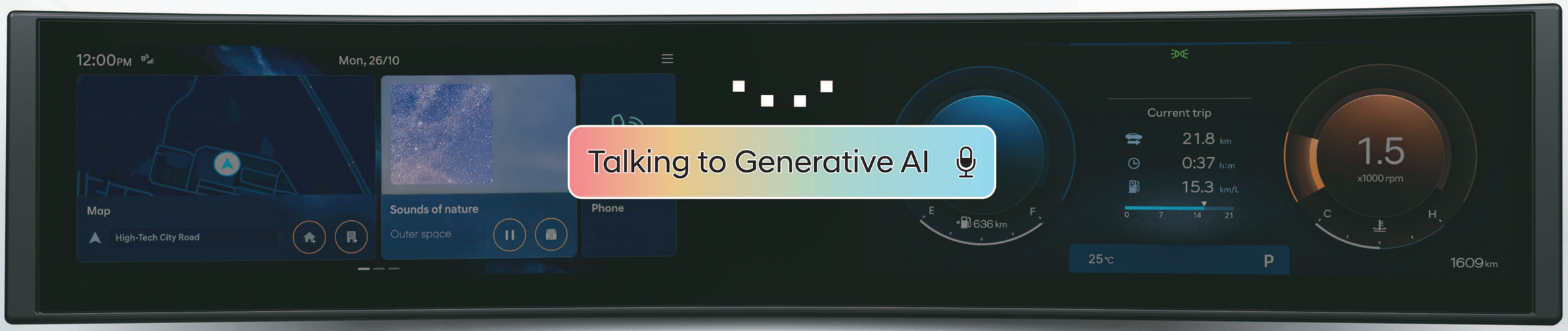

AI ON
Generative AI voice assistant

Safety ON
Level 2 Pro ADAS | 23 features

Comfort ON
Spacious & ergonomic interiors

Performance ON
Dash Boost mode & Sporty drive tech

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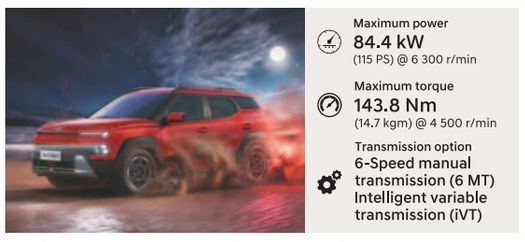
Style ON - Progressive SUV design

Comfort ON - Spacious & ergonomic interiors (2 600 mm Wheelbase)

Safety ON - Built on global K enhanced platform



Performance ON - 1.5 l MPi petrol engine

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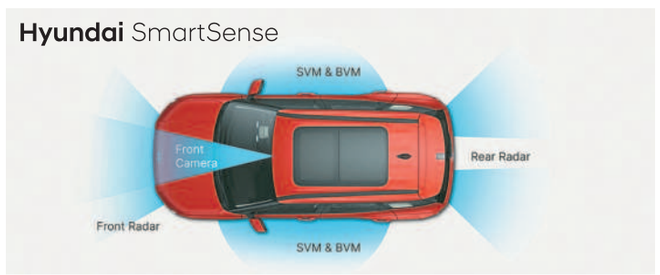

ADAS Level 2 Pro | 23 features

Performance ON

1.5 l MPi Petrol Engine
4 cylinder

Maximum power
84.4 kW (115 PS) @ 6 300 r/min

Transmission option
6-Speed manual transmission (6 MT)
Intelligent variable transmission (iVT)

Engine specification

Dash Boost mode & Sporty drive tech (iVT only)

Spacious cabin - Ample head room, shoulder room and leg room | Easy ingress & egress

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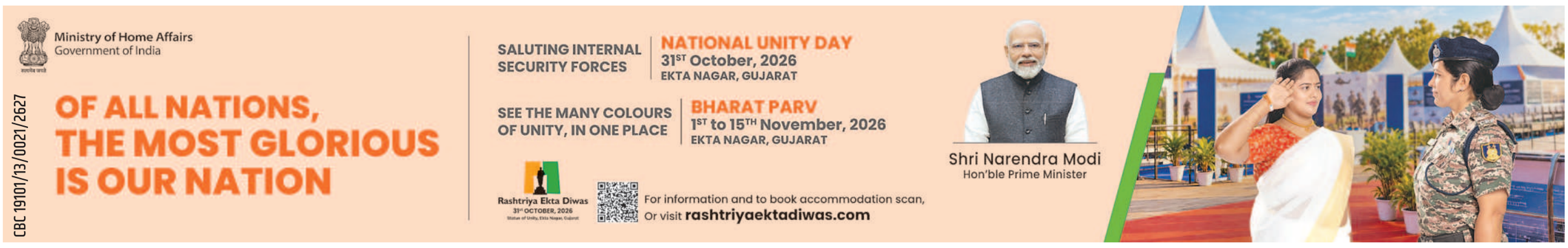

94% voters with notices to remain on Delhi roll

Saloni Bhatia
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Roughly 94% of the 3.3 million people — flagged either for logical discrepancies or not having a link to the 2002 base roll — have successfully argued their case and will be included in the final roll after the special intensive revision (SIR), the Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO) said on Tuesday.

Data showed that 3,126,576 of the 3,314,032 notices issued to electors were disposed of by Tuesday and marked for inclusion in the final roll, accounting for 94.34% of the total. The remaining cases are to be disposed of by November 30, the deadline prescribed by the Election Commission of India.

Delhi's final roll is set to be published on December 4.

"We had set a deadline of November 25 for disposal of claims and objections. With the pace the work is progressing, the notices should be cleared within a week," an official said on the condition of anonymity.

The 3.3 million-strong category comprised two groups.

The first group, logical dis-

continued on →14

What the numbers show

Category	Voters issued notices	Marked for inclusion	Unresolved or excluded
Logical discrepancies	1,934,243	1,896,675	37,568
Not mapped	1,379,789	1,229,901	1,49,888
Total	3,314,032	3,126,576	1,87,456

NEARLY 10MN DELETED IN FINAL K'TAKA ROLL

Karnataka released its final electoral roll on Tuesday, dropping 9.97 million names after SIR, with the Bengaluru region accounting for the highest percentage of deletions and the coastal district of Udupi accounting for the lowest. The final electoral roll contains 45,455,689 general electors, compared to 55,432,314 on the rolls as of June 16, when SIR began, marking a reduction of 9,976,625. The 18% deleted from the pre-SIR roll in Karnataka is the highest among major states. →P10

SC says it will examine records, stops short of telling EC to preserve SIR files

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday refrained from directing the Election Commission of India (ECI) to preserve its files, internal notings and communications in the controversy over alleged unilateral decisions on SIR, even as it assured petitioners it would examine the records.

The bench adjourned the hearing on a clutch of petitions challenging ECI's functioning and allegations that chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar took key decisions without the concurrence of the other two election commissioners. When senior advocates Abhishek Manu Singhvi and Menaka Guruswamy sought an order directing ECI to preserve all files, file notings and communications, solicitor general Tushar Mehta and senior advocate Maninder Singh, appearing for ECI, opposed the request. Singhvi said the petitioners were seeking only an "innocuous order".

The bench responded: "We are aware of everything. Do not worry, we will examine." →P10

150k shifted to safety as cyclone intensifies

Srinivasa Rao Apparasu and Debabrata Mohanty
letters@hindustantimes.com

HYDERABAD/BHUBANESWAR: Cyclone Arnab intensified over west-central Bay of Bengal and picked up speed late on Tuesday, barrelling towards the coast of Andhra Pradesh, even as nearly 150,000 people were moved to shelters and rescue teams were deployed as part of efforts to mitigate the destruction caused by the weather system.

The very severe cyclonic storm was forecast "to cross Andhra Pradesh and Yanam coasts between Bapatla and Visakhapatnam between 2am and 4 am on Wednesday", a weather department update said on Tuesday evening.

The department had earlier forecast the cyclone to cross the Andhra Pradesh coast on Wednesday forenoon.

Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Uttar Pradesh and Bihar were placed on alert for heavy rain and strong winds.

According to statements by state governments, Andhra Pradesh moved 90,000 people till Tuesday evening and Odisha about 48,000. Further evacuation in vulnerable areas is expected during the night and Wednesday morning, officials said.

"Our idea is only one; not even losing a single life. Saving all lives is our priority. There is no need for people to panic but they have to take precautions," Andhra Pradesh chief minister N Chandrababu Naidu said.

In Andhra Pradesh, the cyclone impact began early Tuesday, with gusty winds reported from coastal districts. Heavy rainfall accompanied by strong winds was expected to intensify in north coastal Andhra Pradesh. State disaster management authority managing director Prakhar Jain said the cyclone moved at a speed of 25 kmph for six hours.

The cyclone was expected to continue west-northwestward before turning northwestward, with winds along the coast reaching speeds of 90–100 kmph. The wind speeds during landfall may increase to 115–125 kmph, with gusts reaching up to 140

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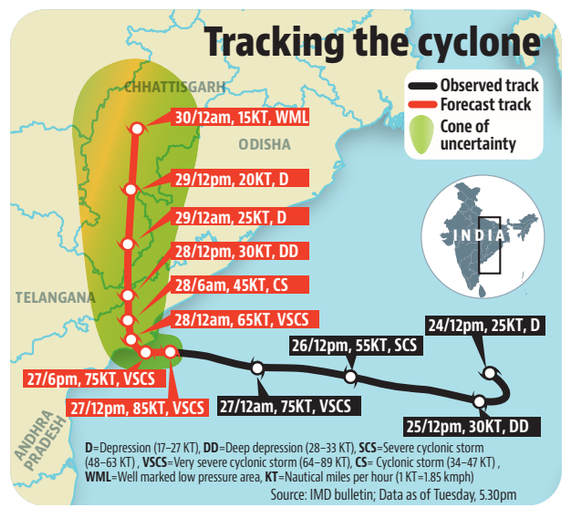


Imran Khan

HC STAYS IMRAN KHAN 'LEAVE INDIA' NOTICE TILL NOV 2

Karuna Nidhi
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Bombay high court on Tuesday placed the notice issued by the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) directing actor Imran Khan, a US national, to leave India by October 28 on hold till the case's next hearing on November 2. →P11

INDIA INVITES PAK TO SCO EVENT IN DELHI NEXT MTH

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India has invited all 10 countries of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), including Pakistan, for the bloc's inaugural Civilisational Dialogue Forum in Delhi from November 20-22, official said. Pakistan last attended the SCO's foreign ministers' meeting in Goa in 2023. →P12

EC orders transfer of officers in 5 states set for polls in '27

Himanshi Dahiya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Tuesday directed the governments of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand to transfer certain categories of officers connected to election work, marking a procedural step that usually paves the way for assembly elections.

All five states are scheduled to go to the polls in early 2027.

In a letter to the chief secretaries and chief electoral officers of the five states, ECI said officers posted in their home districts, those who have completed three years in a district in the last four years, or will do so by May 31, 2027, in the case of Uttar Pradesh, must be transferred.

The cut-off date for completing three years is March 31, 2027, for Goa, Manipur, Punjab and Uttarakhand, and May 31, 2027, for Uttar Pradesh.

Five years ago, this order was issued on October 13, 2021 and the assembly elections eventually announced on January 8, 2022 and conducted between February 10 and March 27. →P10

GOA, MANIPUR, PUNJAB, U'KHAND AND UTTAR PRADESH ARE SCHEDULED TO GO TO POLLS EARLY IN 2027

U.P. CEO APOLOGISES OVER COMMENTS ON VOTER ROLL NAME ERRORS

LUCKNOW: The office of Uttar Pradesh chief electoral officer (CEO) Navdeep Rinwa on Tuesday apologised for the reply posted by its social media handle to an Aam Aadmi Party MP over an erroneous name in a voter slip. It said the "tone and tenor" of the communication were not in line with what is expected of the official handle.

"We sincerely apologise to those who are surprised and upset by this. From now on, our communication will be polite and formal," the UP CEO's office said on X. →P10

High stakes, high turnout in Israel election

Israel's Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu casts his ballot, with his wife Sara, at a polling station in Jerusalem. Israelis voted on Tuesday in record numbers, logging a nearly 67% turnout as of 6pm local time, in a tense election widely seen as a referendum on Netanyahu's leadership since the Hamas-led October 2023 attack and the wars that have since shaken West Asia. >Twinbook AFP

{ 2 DAYS AFTER COLLAPSE IN NE DELHI }

Building owner booked for culpable homicide

Hemani Bhandari
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Tuesday added charges of culpable homicide not amounting to murder to the first information report in the collapse of a building where construction work was going on in northeast Delhi's Harsh Vihar that killed two people. The development comes after claims that there was a long gap between the incident and the arrival of the first emergency vehicle, which may have delayed the rescue operation. The FIR also contains allegations that the building owner ignored a request to add support before starting construction work. →P4

FIR STATES OWNER IGNORED REQUEST TO ADD SUPPORT BEFORE STARTING CONSTRUCTION

HC lays down TN temple entry rule for non-Hindus

Ayesha Arvind
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: The Madras High Court has said that non-Hindus cannot enter 'Agamic' temples in Tamil Nadu without affirming their reverence for the presiding deity and giving an undertaking agreeing to follow the customs and practices of the temple.

In an order passed on October 30, the court said: "If any Non-Hindu claims to visit particular deity in the temple, then the respondents shall obtain undertaking from the said Non-Hindu that he is having faith in the deity and he would follow the customs and practices of Hindu religion and also abide by the temple customs and on such undertaking the said Non-Hindu may be allowed to visit the temple." The court also praised Chief Minister Vijay for following the prescribed procedure before entering a temple in Madurai, despite being Christian by faith. It noted that Vijay signed an undertaking and was not asked to convert to Hinduism. →P12

SC FLAGS PRIVACY, MEDIA FREEDOM BALANCE IN PLEA AGAINST DPDP ACT

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday stressed the need to strike a balance between citizens' right to privacy and the media's freedom to investigate and report, as it issued notice on a petition by the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA) challenging provisions of the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023, and the rules framed under it in 2025.

A bench, comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, also issued notice on the association's interim prayer for a stay on the operation of the challenged provisions.

The court will hear the matter on November 17. →P12

intwinbook

- SC raps govt, DCGI over expired drug approvals
- Need proof of intent in GST fraud cases: CBIC
- China brands drop Mbappe over Mao meme remarks

Injured cheetah dies in MP, pellets found in body, say officials

Shruti Tomar
letters@hindustantimes.com

BHOPAL: A 19-month-old male cheetah that was shot last week died during treatment in Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh on Tuesday, said wildlife officials, in what is the first such killing in the country since the animals were reintroduced four years ago.

The cheetah, KNG22, was shot with pellets, veterinarians confirmed after extracting five pellets from its body.

Officials said the cheetah was likely shot by a resident of Bamori village, but did not rule out the possibility of poaching. A Special Task Force (STF) was constituted to investigate the killing.

The adolescent cheetah was rescued from the Pahargarh range in Morena on Sunday evening and taken to Kuno National Park for treatment.

"The scan revealed multiple metallic foreign bodies in the body – at lumbar vertebra (L1), in the region between the first lumbar (L1) and thirteenth thoracic (T13) vertebrae and ventral to the T13 vertebra," said Dr Shobha Javre of Nanaji Deshmukh Veterinary Science University in Jabalpur, who was treating the cheetah at Kuno. The cheetah was later shifted to Jabalpur for treatment.

"Two metallic foreign bodies were also detected in the subcutaneous tissues near the left shoulder region and another was located within the parenchyma of the right lung. Emergency surgery was performed, during which five firearm pellets were recovered from its body. The cheetah succumbed

continued on →14

THE CHEETAH, KNG22, WAS SHOT WITH PELLETS; SPECIAL TASK FORCE FORMED BY GOVT TO PROBE THE KILLING

2 men killed in separate WB police encounters

KOLKATA/BERHAMPORE: Two people, accused in separate cases, have been killed in police encounters in a single day in West Bengal, with police alleging that both tried to snatch firearms from officers and tried to flee after firing at them during crime reconstruction. The deceased were identified as Prahlad Das, 23, and Samiul Sheikh, 40. →P11

MEN PARADED BY KOL POLICE AFTER YOUTH, HIS FATHER STRIPPED

The Kolkata police on Tuesday paraded three men who allegedly held an 18-year-old man, his father and his friend at gunpoint and forced them to walk naked on Sunday in Sarsuna area of southeast Kolkata, opposition leaders in West Bengal claimed, terming it an "uncivilised practice". →P11

NETWORK FAILURE DISRUPTS OPS AT MUMBAI AIRPORT

NEW DELHI/MUMBAI: A network failure at Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport on Tuesday evening forced the airport and airlines to process passengers by hand at one of the busiest times of the day, as nearly half the flights due out between 7pm and 9pm left an hour or more late. Of the 44 flights scheduled to leave in that window, 18 took off an hour or more late and three were cancelled, data showed. →P14

{ PROLIFIC FORWARD }

The nearly man makes it: Kane beats Mbappe, Yamal, snaps 25-yr English wait for Ballon d'Or

Harry Kane after receiving the Ballon d'Or. AFP

Aditya Maheshwari
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Harry Kane waited 15 years to win his first major club trophy, finally breaking the drought with Bayern Munich. On Tuesday, in his fourth season at the German club, the England captain claimed football's most coveted individual prize, winning the Ballon d'Or ahead of Kylian Mbappe and Lamine Yamal.

"It feels really, really like a dream," said Kane, who became the first English player to win the prize since Michael Owen in 2001. For football's nearly man, the journey to the top could have ended before it began. As a child, Kane went for trials at Arsenal, only to be rejected. He then turned to Tottenham Hotspur, but was turned away again.

He eventually found his way into Tottenham's academy, beginning a long association with the club that saw him emerge as one of the Premier League's most prolific strikers before joining Bayern Munich.

Last season, the 33-year-old scored 73 goals and tallied 8 assists for club and country. →P17

PUTELLAS SECURES RECORD-EQUALLING THIRD BALLON D'OR

Spain star Alexia Putellas won her record-equalling third women's Ballon d'Or after leading Barcelona to multiple trophies last season, including the Women's Champions League. Putellas, who joined London City Lionesses this year, helped Spain win the Women's Nations League last December. The 32-year-old ended Spain teammate Aitana Bonmati's 3-year reign. Putellas won the award in 2021 and 2022, tore her ACL and saw Bonmati rise to stardom. AP

WHY NOT PUT ALL MEDICINES IN PRICE CONTROL REGIME, SC ASKS CENTRE

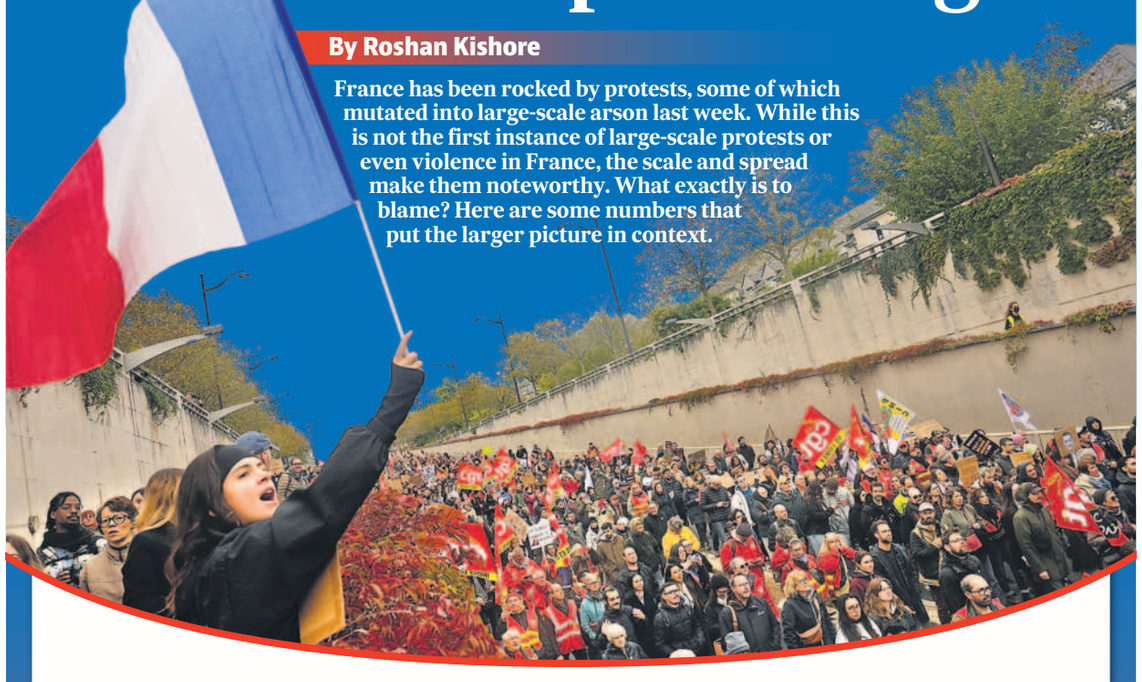
Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday questioned the Centre over its failure to bring all medicines under price control, asking why economic interests should weigh over citizens' lives and why pharmaceutical companies should be allowed to charge high prices for essential drugs. Reserving its order on two petitions challenging high medicine prices, the bench questioned the wide gap between the maximum retail price (MRP) and the price to retailer (PTR). →P12

PAGE ONE PLUS

NUMBER THEORY

Les misérables: Why are the French protesting?



By Roshan Kishore

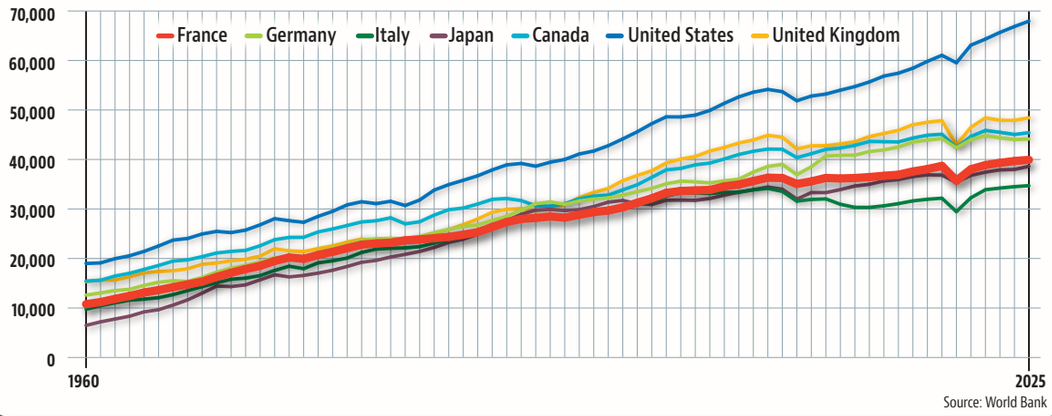
France has been rocked by protests, some of which mutated into large-scale arson last week. While this is not the first instance of large-scale protests or even violence in France, the scale and spread make them noteworthy. What exactly is to blame? Here are some numbers that put the larger picture in context.

1 Barring the US, most G7 countries have seen a stagnation in living standards

France is one of the countries in the elite club of G7, the largest developed economies in the world. While France's per capita incomes are still much higher than most non-developed economies, what is also true for France and the G7 (except the US) is that mass incomes have experienced a prolonged economic stagnation. This is best seen in real per capita GDP for G7 countries which, barring the US, have almost stopped growing since the 2008 Global Financial Crisis. Add to this the income inequality, squeeze on things such as real spending on education and inflation, and the economic pain is real.

France's mass incomes have been stagnant in the last two decades

Per capita GDP (constant 2015 $) have stalled for G7 countries ex-US since the 2008 Global Financial Crisis. France is among the more worse off in the club



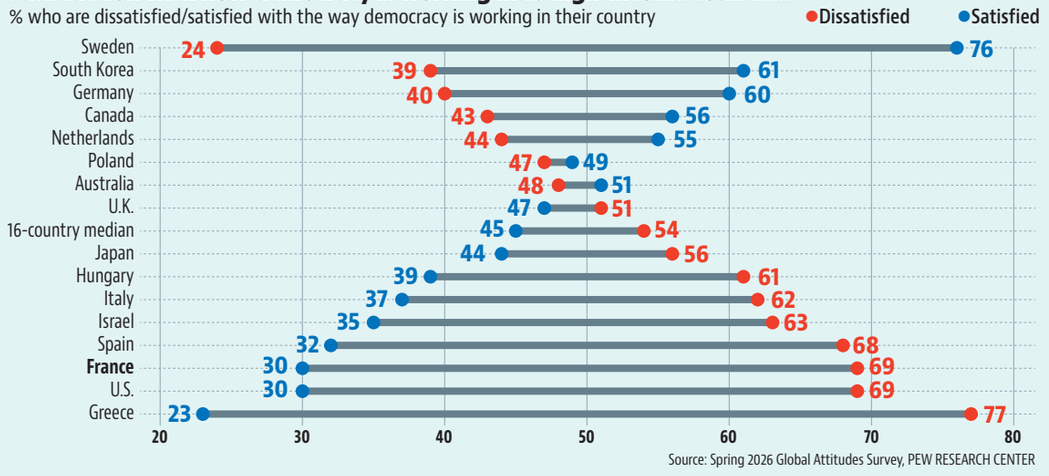
Source: World Bank

2 France has among the highest dissatisfaction levels vis-à-vis democracy

With the economy stalling regarding mass well-being, politics could not have remained unaffected in most advanced economies. The first shock came in 2016 with the Brexit vote in the UK and Donald Trump becoming the US President. France dodged a right-wing political coup when Emmanuel Macron defeated right-wing leader Marine Le Pen in the 2017 elections. While Macron has managed to prevent a right-wing takeover of the French government, the casualty has been France's faith in democracy itself. Findings from a 2025 Pew Survey show that France had among the lowest satisfaction levels with how democracy was functioning. What was even more worrying was that a large number also thought that things could not be changed for the better. The protests are only a kinetic manifestation of the French losing faith in the political system. The disillusionment and perhaps even hopelessness are deeply ingrained now.

Satisfaction with how democracy is working in 16 high-income countries

% who are dissatisfied/satisfied with the way democracy is working in their country



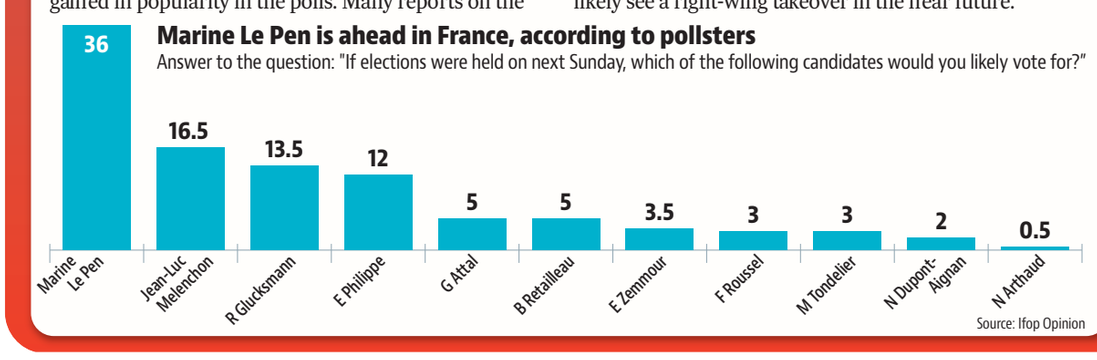
Source: Spring 2026 Global Attitudes Survey, PEW RESEARCH CENTER

3 Anarchy before a coup d'état?

Under Macron, France has managed to preserve its political centre despite a growing squeeze from both the right and the left. Because the French constitution limits presidents to two terms, Macron cannot run in the elections to be held next year. Polling numbers suggest that neither Macron's chosen protégées nor the left are likely to prevent Marine Le Pen from taking the presidency this time. Le Pen is likely to have a large lead in the first round and will perhaps sail through the run-off as well. A survey held on October 17-20 after the protests shows that Le Pen has gained in popularity in the polls. Many reports on the French protests have accused the hard left led by Jean-Luc Melenchon of stoking the protests, although Melenchon has denied any responsibility for violence. However, many commentators see in the protests a complete emaciation of centrist politics in France and a growing polarisation between the hard right and the hard left. With the centrists unable to maintain even basic order and the hard right trying to outflank it as a force for stability rather than disorder, France could be headed for a situation where so-called progressive politics mutates into protests against a state that will likely see a right-wing takeover in the near future.

Marine Le Pen is ahead in France, according to pollsters

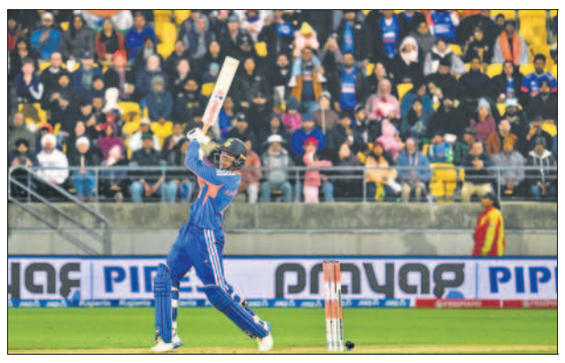
Answer to the question: "If elections were held on next Sunday, which of the following candidates would you likely vote for?"



Source: Ifop Opinion

{ SPORT } WELLINGTON

Abhishek's 38-ball 113 leads India to series win over NZ



An aggressive partnership by Abhishek Sharma and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi propelled India to a six-wicket win and a series victory over New Zealand in Wellington on Tuesday. India sewed up the five-match series with two games to spare, chasing down New Zealand's total of 198 in just 13.2 overs, Abhishek blasting 113 and Sooryavanshi 45. The opening pair combined for a 133-run partnership in just 7.1 overs. Abhishek hit nine fours and 11 sixes in his 38-ball knock, receiving a standing ovation when he eventually fell to the bowling of Kyle Jamieson. By that stage, India had reached 178-2 after just 10 overs. "Key was pretty simple, that me and Vaibhav enjoy our time," Abhishek said of their partnership. "Getting 100 in five overs, have not seen that before at the international level," India captain Shreyas Iyer said. "Credit where it is due, the way they played is exceptional." →P18

{ WORLD } PASSPORTS CANCELLED

Flavio Bolsonaro heads to US after losing election in Brazil

Brazilian Senator Flavio Bolsonaro has left the country for the United States after losing Sunday's presidential election and refusing to comply with a Supreme Court order to hand over his passports, two sources said. Bolsonaro's lawyer also did not respond. It was not immediately clear where Bolsonaro was heading, what time he would arrive or whether he would seek asylum. US President Donald Trump's administration has previously alleged Flavio's father, former President Jair Bolsonaro, was a victim of judicial persecution in Brazil. Bolsonaro was favoured to win Sunday's presidential election but ended up losing in a shock result to leftist Lula. On Monday, he was given 24 hours to surrender his passports as part of a money laundering probe in which he denies wrongdoing, but that deadline has now lapsed, two other sources said, leading to his documents being cancelled. REUTERS

Satcom to Starlink: How a niche idea hit mainstream

Vishal Mathur
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: In November 1998, Iridium switched on a constellation of 66 satellites to power phones that worked anywhere on Earth.

Yes, 1998, for the dream of a global, earth-wide communication network beaming from outer space is neither a modern Silicon Valley invention, nor did it begin with Starlink. The late 90s and early 2000s saw satellite communication (or Satcom) technology companies such as Iridium, Inmarsat, Globalstar and Teledesic work on a vision that was fundamentally sound, but, like it often happens in technology, premature.

Back then, the companies were using a mix of geostationary orbit (GEO), medium Earth orbit (MEO), and low Earth orbit (LEO) satellites. Inmarsat, for instance, used GEO satellites, which had wider coverage at the trade-off for latency (time taken between sending a request and getting a response). LEOs promised faster connectivity with a vision toward internet from the sky, but needed more satellites in the constellation.

Big idea, bad numbers

Nine months after Iridium, backed financially and technologically by Motorola, flipped the switch, it filed for bankruptcy. It was symptomatic of a larger problem. "Technological evolution often precedes commercial demand. Iridium's first-generation network required an investment of over $5 billion, while satellite handsets were prohibitively expensive for mainstream consumers," says Prabhu Ram, vice president - Industry Research Group, CyberMedia Research (CMR). This coincided with the expansion of more affordable terrestrial mobile networks, which eventually became a mass-market product.

While Satcom companies chased a promise, the reality was that the phone handsets were almost the size of, and weighed as much as, a brick. They cost around $3,000 and call charges were several dollars per minute.

There is no official data on the exact number of active satellite phones in India during the early 2000s, as the technology was not commercially deployed to the Indian public at scale and was heavily regulated.

At the time of bankruptcy in 1999, Iridium had an estimated 20,000 users against a reported forecast of 500,000 subscribers, in the US. Globalstar, in 2002, had around 77,000 subscribers.

Relevance, and evolution

Yet, Satcom survived, albeit in a different form, with niche use cases, proving that the first chapter of the Satcom story wasn't a failure of the technology or of physics, but that satellite constellations and ground stations were simply too costly to keep prices affordable.

"Expensive devices and usage charges limited consumer demand, making it difficult for providers to recover their investments, especially as cellular networks were expanding and becoming more affordable. However, satellite connectivity remained essential for shipping, aviation, offshore energy and other remote industries where terrestrial networks could not reach," says Subhadip Roy, senior analyst at Counterpoint Research. "Today, satellite connectivity is increasingly complementing mobile networks to fill these coverage gaps."

A SpaceX rocket carrying Starlink satellites after launching from Cape Canaveral in the US. REUTERS

In an era where SpaceX's Starlink dominates modern communication conversations, the inspiration can be traced back to the original Satcom vision, albeit at a larger scale, a stronger satellite constellation, and the promise of high-speed internet covering every inch of Earth. And instead of Satcom's original voice focus, Starlink's bet is broadband.

SpaceX operates the largest, and rapidly growing LEO satellite constellation ever, with more than 11,000 Starlink satellites in space at the end of September. It is understood that the company has most of the necessary approvals for its satellite broadband services even in India.

"Starlink builds on the foundations laid by earlier systems and is seeking to extend that proposition to broadband at a greater scale. Ultimately, commercial success will depend not just on technological advances, but on whether pricing, regulation and market demand align," says CMR's Ram.

For context, Starlink pricing for home broadband connections in many markets ranges between $55 for 100Mbps and $130 per month for up to 400Mbps speeds (that's between ₹5,207 and ₹12,307). It is not confirmed if the company will maintain pricing parity in India or adopt a different pricing approach as some multinationals have.

"India already has some of the world's cheapest mobile data and expanding 5G coverage, making it difficult for satellite broadband to compete on price in well-connected urban areas. Capacity is another constraint, as satellite networks have finite bandwidth over each coverage area," Counterpoint's Roy explains.

A quick check of India's broadband and mobile data tariffs illustrates this. Airtel's home broadband plans are priced upwards of ₹499 per month while Jio's tariffs start at ₹399 per month. With 5G being a viable mobile broadband avenue in most cities, there is the value addition from tariff plans that bundle unlimited data. Airtel and Jio's prepaid plans with unlimited 5G are priced at ₹349 with a 28-day validity.

"The bigger opportunity (for Satcom) lies in connecting remote villages, hill and border areas, mines, energy sites and ships, where terrestrial networks are unavailable or unreliable," says Roy. That is exactly what Starlink got right in its early years in many regions. In a market such as India, while fighting incumbents on price may be difficult for the foreseeable future, niche use-cases are where it can find immediate traction.

Satellite connectivity may also prove relevant for emergency services and e-governance. In November, Starlink and the state of Maharashtra signed a Letter of Intent (LOI), making the latter the first Indian state to do so, to connect remote and underserved districts such as Gadchiroli, Nandurbar, Washim, and Dharashiv, with e-governance, education, and healthcare services. Gujarat and Meghalaya also have similar memorandums to explore satellite internet for remote infrastructure.

This has been Starlink's approach everywhere.

Rather than competing with cellular networks and fibre broadband in cities, Starlink initially targeted fixed locations that terrestrial networks had ignored — rural homes, remote enterprise locations, ships, land mobility and commercial aircraft.

Starlink says more than 30,000 aircraft including from airlines such as Emirates, Qatar Airways and United Airlines, now have the Aero Terminal, delivering between 250Mbps and 1Gbps speeds to passengers without any paywalls. That's hundreds, if not thousands of flyers, experiencing the fastest internet service on transcontinental and long-haul flights.

Emirates and Qatar Airways, for instance, were previously using Satcom data services by prominent Geneva-headquartered aviation telecommunications provider SITA OnAir and Inmarsat Global Xpress on most of their fleet. Speeds on connected devices such as smartphones or laptops would range between 0.5Mbps and 16Mbps in the real-world, depending on equipment and satellite coverage in the region the aircraft was overflying.

The regulatory conversation

In India, applications for satellite broadband from Airtel, Jio, and Starlink are all in queue. HT understands that while they have requisite technical clearances, they still need a security clearance from the home ministry.

"India's framework needs to distinguish between satellite and terrestrial services without compromising security or creating an uneven playing field. Satellite broadband should complement terrestrial networks, not be treated as either an identical service or an exempt alternative," says Ram.

In 2010, India clamped down on Satcom usage with strict licensing and permission requirements, including a Department of Telecom (DoT) license and mandatory customs clearances for travellers landing in India with satphones.

India's national security contentions with satellite broadband services such as Starlink include concerns about the lack of control over a network that may be abruptly turned off or slowed down (by the company; as it has reportedly done in Ukraine), data localisation, and key infrastructure such as base stations. Security and data routing are the biggest sticking points. Last year, India tightened its security framework for satellite operators with the Department of Telecommunications' (DoT) security framework for Global Mobile Personal Communication by Satellite (GMPCS) providers.

It mandates that all network control centres, satellite earth station gateways and user data routing infrastructure must be physically located within India. Routing Indian user traffic through foreign gateways or inter-satellite links is prohibited. Strict geofencing must block service near international borders and sensitive areas, with active monitoring zones required within 50 kilometres of borders and coasts.

The new guidelines apply to all satellite communications services intending to have commercial operations in the country, including Space X's Starlink, and Airtel's Eutelsat OneWeb, with the latter also awaiting approval. In January, DoT issued a Unified License (UL) authorizing GMPCS service to three companies — OneWeb India Communications Private Limited, Jio Satellite Communications Limited, and Starlink Satellite Communications Private Limited.

Days earlier, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said that Starlink service speeds in the country were slowed down significantly, hindering military efforts that relied heavily on Starlink's Starshield military service to prevent drone attacks. On Saturday last week, Musk admitted he was behind the speed restriction; the decision was taken as "Ukraine military violated Starlink terms of service and used it for offensive drone strikes to kill people." he said. But he maintained that the US government controlled whatever changes happened with Starshield, according to news agency AFP.

Counterpoint's Roy notes a brewing development in the broader tech space, that would provide a boost for satellite broadband. "Chipmakers, device manufacturers and telecom operators are looking to integrate satellite connectivity into their products and services. In India, this could help extend connectivity to remote and underserved areas while supporting businesses in sectors such as mining, energy and logistics," he says.

As recent years have shown, the underlying premise of Satcom was never wrong; it was simply a generation too early. What it needed was an industrialised space programme of the 2020s, and a world entirely dependent on data, to turn the skyward dream of the 1990s into an everyday utility.

It now has.

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Culpable homicide case in Harsh Vihar collapse

Hemani Bhandari
hemani.bhandari@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Tuesday added charges of culpable homicide not amounting to murder to the first information report (FIR) in the collapse of a building where construction work was going on in northeast Delhi's Harsh Vihar that killed two people.

The development comes after claims that there was a long gap between the incident and the arrival of the first emergency vehicle, which may have delayed the rescue operation. The FIR also contains allegations that the building owner ignored a request to add support before starting construction work in the building.

Deputy commissioner of police (northeast) Rahool Alwal told HT that section 105 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) had been added to the FIR, which was registered on Monday under sections 106(1) (causing death due to negligence), 290 (negligent conduct regarding the pulling down, repairing, or construction of buildings that endangers human life) and 3(5) (common intention).

On Sunday evening, the collapse occurred at Milan Garden on Sewa Dham Road in Harsh Vihar, an unauthorised colony. Two men, feared trapped under the debris, were pulled out during an overnight rescue operation on Monday morning. They were taken to GTB Hospital, where doctors declared them dead on arrival.

The deceased were identified as Chanderpal, 60, and his son Vijay Kumar, 33, residents of Gali No. 14 in Harsh Vihar. They had taken a contract for shuttering work at the building.

Police said the main contractor, who had taken up the construction work, identified as Arjun is on the run. The building owner, Manoj Kumar, who allegedly locked the gate and fled after the collapse, was arrested on Monday. Both are named in the FIR.

HT on Monday reported that the first call to police and fire department was made more than an hour after the incident occurred, according to police officials, eyewitnesses, and victims' families, a gap that likely delayed rescue operations and allowed the building owner to flee.

According to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), the rear portion of the first-floor structure appears to have collapsed while the owner was replacing the existing T-iron and stone-slab roofing with a reinforced cement concrete (RCC) slab. The debris reportedly fell onto the ground-floor roof, which collapsed.

According to the FIR, seen by HT, registered based on a complaint by the victim's other son, Yash, the victims had asked the building owner to install support on the existing lintel — a structural beam—because it was weak but he did not heed the request.

"The lintel on the ground floor was weak and work was underway on the first floor... We had asked both Manoj and Arjun to install a support pillar below the existing lintel but they did not listen to us and asked us to continue the work," Yash was quoted in the FIR.

There appeared to be different versions of when the authorities were alerted to the incident.

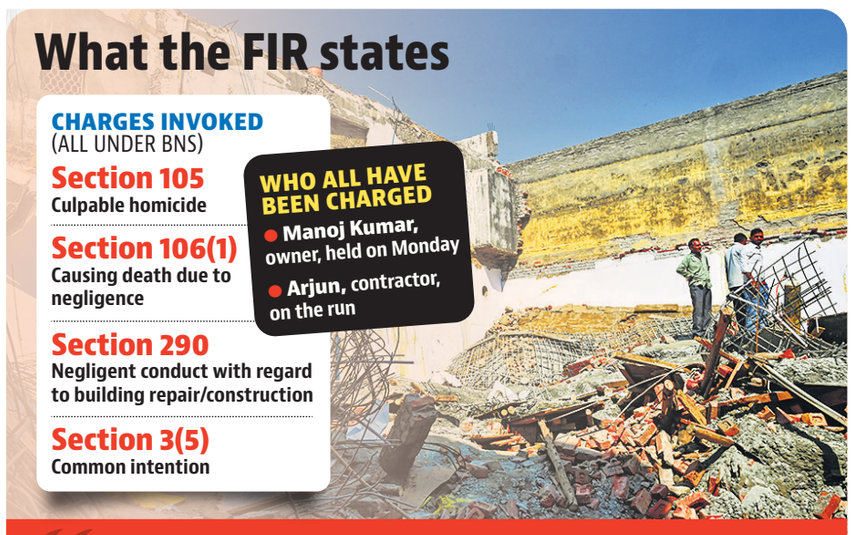
A senior police officer part of the team investigating the case, who asked to remain anonymous, said that preliminary inquiry had established that the collapse occurred around 5.45pm and that the PCR call was made at 6:46pm, "at least an hour after" the incident.

Owner Kumar was present at the time, the officer said, adding that Kumar locked the gate and fled, fearing assault by locals and legal action. "At 6.46pm, the PCR call was made by the building owner's son, Khushwinder Kumar. The owner was called to open the gate," the officer said, describing the owner's actions as gross negligence.

The same time was cited in press releases issued by the Delhi Police and Delhi Fire Services (DFS) on Sunday night, as well as the police general diary entry accessed by HT.

According to DFS records, the incident was reported at 6.46pm. Police, fire personnel, Civil Defence volunteers and a National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) team joined the DFS' operation, with two ambulances and a crane deployed in addition to six fire tenders.

What the FIR states



CHARGES INVOKED (ALL UNDER BNS)

Section 105 — Culpable homicide

Section 106(1) — Causing death due to negligence

Section 290 — Negligent conduct with regard to building repair/construction

Section 3(5) — Common intention

WHO ALL HAVE BEEN CHARGED

- Manoj Kumar, owner, held on Monday
- Arjun, contractor, on the run

"The lintel on the ground floor was weak and work was underway on the first floor... We had asked both Manoj and Arjun to install a support pillar below the existing lintel but they did not listen to us and asked us to continue the work. —FIR, filed by victim's son

DELHI DISTRICT COURTS SHUT AS LAWYERS HOLD INDEFINITE STRIKE

Arnabjit Sur
arnabjit.sur@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Lawyers across Delhi's district courts will continue their strike indefinitely and march to the Delhi Police headquarters on Thursday, demanding the suspension of an assistant commissioner of police (ACP) and the station house officer (SHO) of Shahdara police station over allegations of threatening advocates last week. The decision was taken through a resolution passed on Tuesday.

A senior police officer, requesting anonymity, offered a different account of the incident, alleging that the lawyers had misbehaved with the ACP and the SHO. "A case was registered for alleged misbehaviour with police. Their allegation that the ACP pointed his service pistol at them is being probed," the officer said.

The dispute stems from an FIR registered at Shahdara police station after advocate Lalit Bansal sustained a head injury in an alleged assault by two unidentified men on October 23.

SC TELLS CENTRE TO REVISIT NORMS ON ACID REGULATION

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed the Centre to revisit its policy on regulating the open sale of acid over rising cases of acid attacks, and sought by November 23 an affidavit on the reasons that make open sale indispensable.

"You can identify the purposes for which sale of acid is necessitated and then suggest measures to be implemented by states," the bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, also comprising justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said.

The bench was dealing with a petition over lack of rehabilitative for survivors, in connection with an incident of acid attack on a woman on October 6 in Bhajanpura. ABRAHAM THOMAS

{ LACK OF PROGRESS } 50,000 UNITS STUCK

SC proposes receivers for Supertech projects

Abraham Thomas
abraham.thomas@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday questioned NBCC India Ltd's handling of 16 stalled Supertech housing projects, proposing the idea of appointing an independent receiver to oversee the completion of projects after homebuyers alleged that more than ₹30 crore had been spent on project management since December 2024 without a single tender being issued.

The projects, spread across Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Uttarakhand and Karnataka, involve nearly 50,000 housing units.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant said: "We have realised nothing is happening. Either we dissolve the committee and appoint a receiver as we did in the Amrapali or Unitech matters, where the government constituted a board of directors in public interest to construct the stalled projects."

A receiver is a neutral third party appointed by a court to manage property or business interests involved in a dispute or financial distress.

Representing homebuyers, senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy told the court that NBCC, appointed as project management consultant (PMC) by the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) in December 2024, had yet to issue tenders for the projects despite spending more than ₹30 crore on hiring.

The bench, also comprising justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said the proposed arrangement must not impose any additional financial burden on homebuyers. "We are aware of it. There was reasonable progress in the Unitech matter. That kind of model can also work. What we propose to do is to appoint a receiver."

Currently, an Apex Court Committee (ACC) is overseeing the matter regarding the stalled projects. This committee is headed by former Supreme Court judge -- justice (retd) Krishna Murari -- and also comprises representatives of financial institutions, NBCC and real estate experts.

NBCC, represented by attorney general R Venkataramani, informed the court that the company had issued a tender for one project and was processing tenders for the remaining ones. Construction would begin next year, he said. NBCC has also filed a separate petition seeking exemptions under the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA) to facilitate completion of the insolvency-ridden projects.

In May, NCLAT rejected NBCC's request for a RERA exemption and its plea to increase fees on the sale of unfinished flats.

Guruswamy opposed the proposed exemption, arguing that it would leave homebuyers without a remedy. She also told the court that the ACC had rejected a proposal from a construction firm to complete the projects. A former Supertech director had also approached the committee with a financier, but the proposal was rejected over concerns about high interest rates, she said.

The bench invited all stakeholders to submit proposals by the next hearing on November 16. The court requested Venkataramani to propose names for a court receiver. "If we find that the financier is above board, we will disband the committee and allow the work to be undertaken under an independent court receiver and the PMC may or may not be NBCC," it said.

The court said that it will not permit homebuyers to be burdened further as it cited unsold inventory and vacant plots of land within the projects as sources of generating funds for completing the stalled construction work.

While taking over the 16 projects, NBCC had sought a separate 1% marketing fee over and above the 8% PMC fee as a condition for undertaking the work. However, the NCLAT order restructured the fee-matrix as a consolidated 8% (7% PMC + 1% marketing), which, according to NBCC, undermined project viability and disincentivised the implementing agency.

'Nothing is happening'

WHAT COURT SAID

- We have realised nothing is happening. Either we dissolve the committee and appoint a receiver as we did in the Amrapali or Unitech matters
- We are very clear there should be no additional burden on the homebuyers
- We will allow all stakeholders to bring a proposal by the next date of hearing. If we find that the financier is above board, we will disband the committee

What NBCC said:

- Tender for one of the 16 projects has been issued and for the remaining, the process is underway
- Work on these projects will commence next year

What homebuyers said:

Exempting NBCC from Rera will leave residents with no remedy

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Proclamation Requiring the Appearance of the Accused Person

(Section 84 BNSS)

A complaint has been filed before me stating that the accused, Abdul Ansari s/o Aziz Ansari, r/o Awaragard, Footpath, Sriniwaspuri, Delhi, has committed a punishable offense (or is suspected of having committed an offense) under FIR No. 19/2022 U/s 3RP(UP) Act, registered at Police Station RPF Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi, and the arrest warrant issued against him has been returned with the endorsement that the said accused Abdul Ansari could not be found, and it has been satisfactorily shown to me that the said accused Abdul Ansari has absconded (or is concealing himself to evade the execution of the said warrant). Therefore, it is hereby proclaimed that the said accused Abdul Ansari, in connection with FIR No. 19/2022 U/S 3RP(UP) Act, registered at Police Station RPF Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi, is required to appear before this Court on or before 21.12.2026 to answer the said complaint.

By Order
Shri Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II,
(Central) Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

3745/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Taiyaba

General public is hereby informed that a girl namely **Taiyaba, D/o Shaveer, R/o H.No. D-565, Gali No. 14, D-Block, Shriram Colony, Khajuri, Delhi has been missing since 02.09.2026 at about 04:00 PM from her home.** In this regard **FIR No. 387/2026, U/s 137(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, Dated 03.09.2026** has been lodged at Police Station Khajuri Khas, Delhi. The description of missing girl is as under:

Name: Taiyaba, Age: 17 Years, Height: 5', Complexion: Shallow, Face: Long, Built: Thin, Wearing: Jeans & Red Colour Kurta and Slipper in Feet.

If anyone has any information about this missing girl please inform P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi.

Web: http://cbi.nic.in, E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638/24368641, Fax: 011-24368639

SHO
Police Station Khajuri Khas, Delhi
Ph: 8750870727, 9013270355

DP/15471/NE/2026

Appeal for Identification

General public is hereby informed that one male person **Namely:** Saleem, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Geeta Ghat Sofia NGO Civil Lines, Delhi, **Age:** 45 Yrs. **Height:** 5'6", **Sex:** Male, **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Face:** Oval, **Build:** Normal **Wearing:** Hospital Clothes **Place of Recovery:** LNJP Hospital, Delhi The dead body has been preserved in LNJP Hospital, Delhi, Mortuary Delhi, for identification.

In this regard **DD No. 4A Dated: 21/10/2026** has been lodged at **Police Station: PS Civil Lines, Delhi,** Any clue come to notice please inform undersign.

SHO
P.S.: Civil Lines, Delhi
Phone: 9654963400, 8750870127

DP/15479/N/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

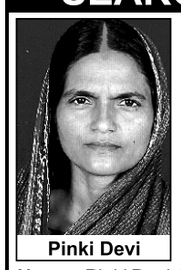
General public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of a male **Age:** Approx 62 Years, **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Oval, **Eyes:** Black, **ID Mark:** Tatoo of OM on Right Hand, was wearing White colour Kurta and Payjama and bare feet, was found near Out Gate, ISBT Anand Vihar, Delhi on 23.10.2026 at about 05:20 P.M. He was admitted in L.B.S. Hospital, Khichripur, Delhi in MLC No. 218/94 and during the treatment he was died on 24.10.2026. In this regard a case **DD No. 97A dated 24.10.2026 U/s 194 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, has been lodged at P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi.**

His dead body has been preserved in L.B.S. Hospital Mortuary, Delhi. Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone numbers.

SHO
P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi
Ph.: 8750870626, 9582312555

DP/15514/ED/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING



Pinki Devi

General Public is hereby informed that a female namely **Pinki Devi W/o Kalindra Prasad, R/o** C-63, Gali No.9, Kapashera, New Delhi has been missing since 13.10.2026 at 06.00 PM from her house in the jurisdiction of PS Kapashera, New Delhi. In this regard a **FIR No. 540/26, dated 15.10.2026 U/s 140(3) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023** has been lodged at PS, Kapashera, New Delhi. The description of missing female is as under :

Name : Pinki Devi, **Husband's Name :** Kalindra Prasad, **Age :** 34 years, **Height** : 5'5", **Face** : Round, **Built** : Medium, **Complexion** : Shallow, **Wearing** : Black Color Saree and Chappal in feet.

If anyone having any clue/information, kindly inform the undersigned at following phone numbers.

Website : http://cbi.nic.in
e-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax : 011-24368639
Ph. : 011-24368638, 24368641

SHO
P.S., Kapashera, New Delhi
Ph. : 011-25063758, 7065036226

DP/15380/SW/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

unknown

The general public is hereby informed that a Male whose name, family and residence is **unknown**, whose age was about 62 years was found unconscious at Bus Parking AG Side, New Delhi Railway Station on Dated 21.10.2026. The Unknown Person was taken to LHMC Hospital where he was declared brought dead. The Dead Body of the Deceased Person has been kept at LHMC Hospital Mortuary for 72 hours. In this regard, an information has been lodged vide **DD No. 66A Dated 21.10.2026 U/s 194 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita,2023, at PS New Delhi Railway Station, Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to identify the deceased person, but no clue has come to light, so far. The description of the UIDB is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** 62 Years, **Height:** 5'4" ft, **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Round, **Wearing:** Light Green Lower and Brown T-Shirt. If anyone has any information about his relatives, kindly inform the SHO/ New Delhi Railway Station, Delhi.

SHO
PS, New Delhi Railway Station, Delhi
Ph. No. 7988030508, 8750871305, 011-23744073

DP/15446/RLY/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of a male **Age:** Approx 35-40 Years, **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Long, was wearing Dirty White, Blue & Red colour T-shirt and Green colour Lower, was found dead Near PWD Pump House, Near Chatta Rail Chowk, Red Fort, Delhi on 18.10.2026. In this regard a case **DD No. 64A dated 18.10.2026 U/s 194 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023, has been lodged at P.S. Kotwali, Delhi.**

His dead body has been preserved in Subzi Mandi Mortuary, Delhi for 72 hours. Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone numbers.

SHO
P.S. Kotwali, Delhi
Ph.: 8750870121, 7011355201

DP/15498/N/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of a male Namely Unknown **S/o** Unknown, **R/o** Unknown **Age:** About 60-65 years, **Height:** 5'7", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Wearing:** Black Coloured T-Shirt and Dark Green Coloured Shorts was found dead on 24.10.2026 at 12:04 PM from Footpath, Near Kela Ghat Marg, Ring Road, Towards ISBT Flyover, Kashmere Gate, Delhi. In this regard a **DD No.64A Dated 24.10.2026** has been lodged at P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi.

If any one having any clue about deceased male may kindly inform the undersigned and contact on following numbers.

SHO
P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi
Ph.: 011-23968730
DP/15484/N/2026 Mob.: 8750870123

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Anjali

Shivani

General public is hereby informed that two female (depicted in the photo) Namely: 1. **Anjali, D/o: Arjun Sahni, R/o. Gali No. 9, Qutub Vihar, Goyla Dairy, New Delhi** and 2. **Shivani, D/o. Vishnu Dev Sahni, R/o. Plot No. 15, Near Hanuman Chowk, Qutab Vihar, Phase-II, Goyla Dairy, New Delhi** have been Missing from the area of **Sec-18, Dwakra since 18.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.** In this regard a missing report case vide **FIR No.352/2026 dated 18.10.2026 U/S 137(2) & 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhitas, 2023 has been lodged at P.S. Dwarka (North), Delhi.**

His Physical description is as under:-

Anjali: Sex: Female, **Age:** 19 Years, **Height:** 4' 6", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Wearing:** Pink kurti and Blue color jeans and Slippers.

Shivani: Sex: Female, **Age:** 16 Years, **Height:** 5', **Complexion:** Fair, **Wearing:** Wearing Top and Blue color Jeans and Slippers.

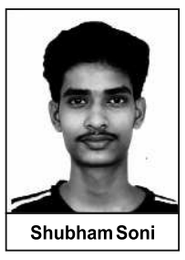
Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing females but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone having any information about this females please inform to the following.

Phone No.: 011-24368638, 011-24368641 | Fax No.: 011-24368639
Email id : cic@cbi.nic.in | Website : http://cbi.nic.in

SHO
P.S – Dwarka North, Delhi
Phone.: 9810941545

DP/15426/DW/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING BOY



Shubham Soni

General Public is hereby informed that one boy (depicted in the photo) namely Shubham Soni **S/o** Ashok Soni **R/o** A-6, Bapu Park, Kotla Mubarakpur, New Delhi **Aged**-18 Years 4 Months has been reported missing since 30.09.2026 at 7:30 AM from his residence vide **FIR No.213/2026 Dated 02.10.2026 u/s 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita,** registered at Police Station Kotla Mubarakpur, New Delhi. His physical description is as under:-

Complexion: Fair, **Height:** about 5'3", **Face:** Long, **Built:** Normal, **ID:** Old Scar on the Left Hand Elbow, **Clothing:** Light Blue Coloured Shirt, Dark Blue Coloured Pant and Blue-White Coloured Sport Shoes in feet (School Dress).

If anyone gets any information or clue about the missing boy, please contact the below mentioned :-

SHO, Kotla Mubarakpur, New Delhi
Tel.: 011-24620106
8750870828

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 24368639
Tel.: 24368638/24368641

DP/15373/SD/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

Saleem

The general public is hereby informed that a Male whose name is **Saleem,** residence is NGO Recovery Center, Sofia, Geeta Ghat, Civil Lines and family is unknown, whose age was about 45 years was admitted in AAA Hospital due to Illness on Dated 15.10.2026. The Unknown Person was referred to LNJP Hospital where he was declared dead during the treatment on Dated 21.10.2026. The Dead Body of the Deceased Person has been kept for P.M & Identification at LNJP Hospital Mortuary, Delhi. In this regard, an information has been lodged vide **DD No. 4A Dated 21.10.2026 at PS Civil Lines, Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to identify the deceased person, but no clue has come to light, so far. The description of the UIDB is as under:

Name: Saleem, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** 45 Years, **Height:** 5'6" ft, **Complexion:** White, **Built:** Normal, **Face:** Oval, **Wearing:** Hospital Clothes. If anyone has any information about his relatives, kindly inform the SHO/ Civil Lines, Delhi.

SHO
PS, Civil Lines, Delhi
Ph. No. 9654963400, 8750870127

DP/15462/N/2026

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Bhavna

General public is hereby informed that a Girl namely **Bhavna** D/o Akhilesh R/o H. No. 1037 near MCD School, Old Kondli, Delhi has been missing since 12.10.2026 at 06:10pm from the area of PS New Ashok Nagar, Delhi. In this regard **FIR No. 734/2026 Dated 18.10.2026 U/s 137(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 has been Lodged at PS New Ashok Nagar, Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to trace out the Missing Girl, but no clue has come to light so far. The description of the Missing Girl is as under:

Name: Bhavna, **Gender:** Girl, **Age:** 16 years, **Height:** 5'0" ft, **Complexion:** Fair, **Built:** Normal, **Face:** Round, **Hair:** Black, **Wearing:** Cream Salwar-Suit and Cream Color Slippers. If anyone has any information regarding this Missing Girl, kindly inform SHO/ New Ashok Nagar, Delhi.

E-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638, 24368641
Fax : 011-24368639
DP/15510/ED/2026

SHO
PS, New Ashok Nagar, Delhi
Ph. No. 8750870631, 9911112640

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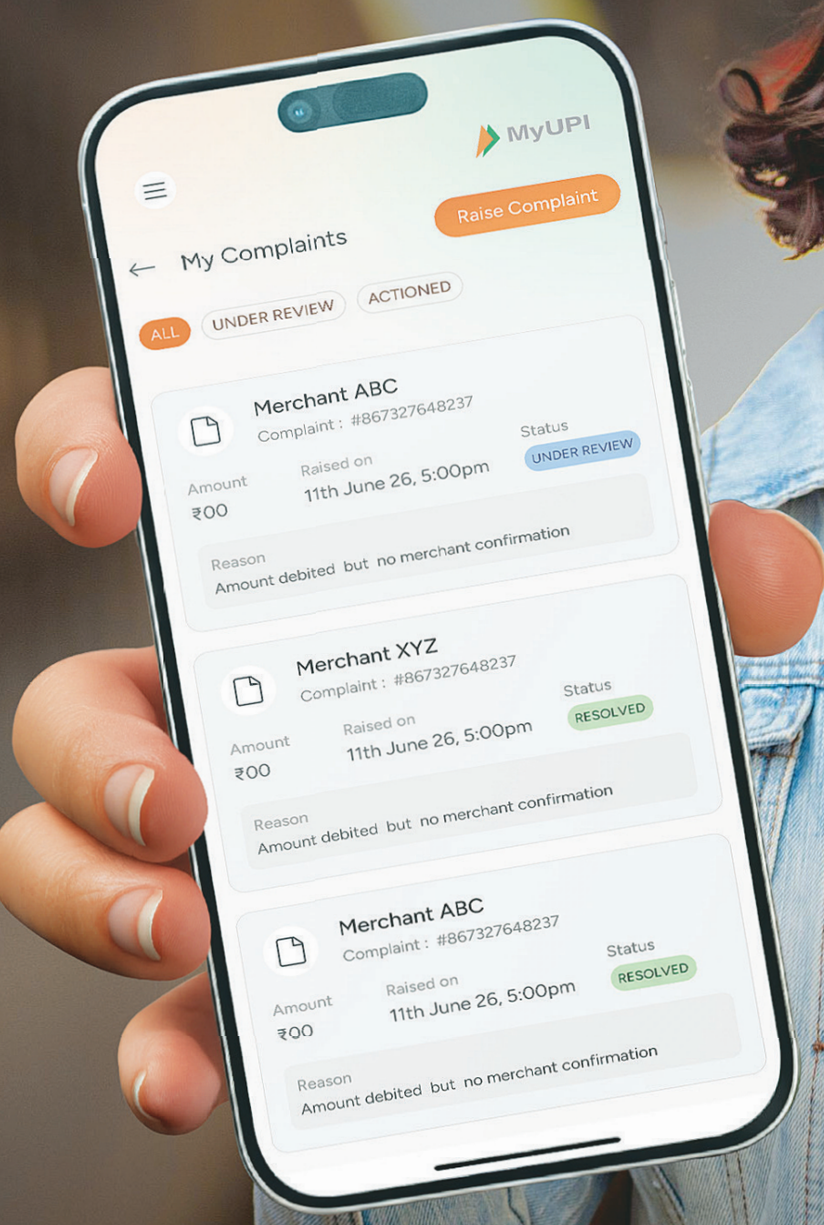

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Half of 524 pedestrian deaths in '26 from hit-and-run accidents

Karn Pratap Singh
karn.singh@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: More than 500 pedestrians have been killed on Delhi's roads so far this year, with unidentified vehicles accounting for half the deaths, according to Delhi Traffic Police data accessed by HT which highlighted the challenge of tracing motorists involved in fatal hit-and-run crashes.

Of the 524 pedestrian deaths recorded till October 15 this year, 262 involved "unknown vehicles". Privately owned cars were responsible for 69 deaths in cases where the offending vehicle was identified, while motorcycles and scooters accounted for 56, the data showed.

The 524 deaths occurred in 519 fatal crashes. Delhi recorded 1,322 road accidents involving pedestrians during the period, leaving 1,518 injured. Unknown vehicles were linked to 429 of these crashes, in which 466 pedestrians were injured.

The figures point the persistence of the problem. In 2024, 308 fatal hit-and-run crashes involving pedestrians and unidentified vehicles killed 309 people. The toll rose to 330 pedestrian deaths in 330 such crashes in 2025.

Privately owned cars and two-wheelers also accounted for significant fatalities. Cars were linked to 81 pedestrian deaths in 79 crashes in 2024, rising to 92 deaths in 90 crashes in 2025. Two-wheelers accounted for 53 deaths in 52 crashes in 2024 and 75 deaths in 75 crashes in 2025.

To be sure, since this data is maintained by traffic police, it only pertains to cases where the vehicle could not be located after the accident, and may not account for the investigation in a case where the errant vehicle was later identified.

A senior traffic police officer said a dedicated road crash cell analyses accident data to identify emerging patterns. "The data analysis focuses on identifying the accident-prone areas and the issues leading to road crashes. Any particular stretch reporting between five and 10 fatal accidents in a year becomes a hotspot, prompting a detailed study of the area by various agencies and organisations working on road safety," the officer said.

Heavy vehicles also contributed to the pedestrian toll. Trucks and other heavy transport and goods vehicles were involved in 82 fatal and non-fatal crashes, killing 41 pedestrians in 40 fatal crashes and injuring 46 in 42 non-fatal accidents, the data showed.

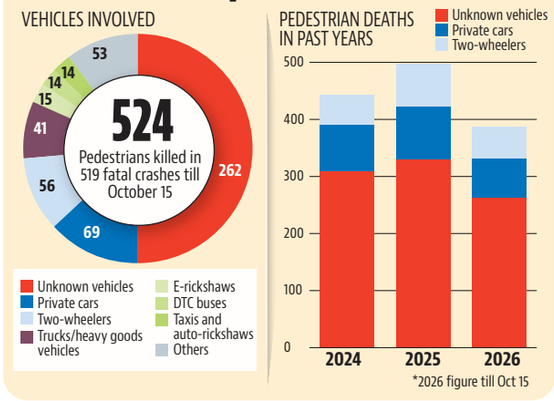
Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses were linked to 14 crashes that killed as many pedestrians till October 15. Another 35 pedestrians were injured in 29 non-fatal crashes involving DTC buses.

The fatalities have risen from nine in nine crashes involving DTC buses during the whole of 2025, a police officer said, adding that the reasons for the increase were being examined.

Road safety experts say curbing pedestrian deaths, particularly in hit-and-run cases, is a challenge for the police and other agencies given the rampant unauthorised pedestrian crossings. Covering streets with cameras to detect offending vehicles and taking pedestrian friendly measures are some key solutions to such road crashes.

"Delhi has a large network of high-speed corridors, where jaywalking is rampant. Further, installing more cameras, building pedestrian friendly foot overbridges at high pedestrian crossings are key solutions," said Dr S Velmurugan, senior adviser at National Council of Applied Economic Research, New Delhi.

What traffic police data shows



Barapullah mess: As above, so below

Traffic crawls along the Barapullah flyover stretch carrying vehicles from Mayur Vihar towards AIIMS on Tuesday. Phase III of the elevated corridor, which was opened for public use on September 29, has drawn severe criticism after triggering widespread congestion not only on the corridor itself, but also across parts of south and southeast Delhi. RAJ K RAJ /HT PHOTO

No 'immediate plans' of demolition at Race Course Masjid: Centre to Delhi HC

Shruti Kakkar
shruti.kakkar@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The central government on Tuesday told the Delhi High Court that there were no "immediate plans" to carry out a demolition of the Race Course Masjid, which is located near the Prime Minister's residence, and that access, water and electricity to the mosque were suspended over safety concerns due to ongoing demolition drives in its vicinity.

"As of now we (the authorities) are not demolishing anything," Centre's counsel Ashish Dixit told the bench of justice Anish Dayal.

The submission was made in a petition filed by Syed Ahmed Saud, a worshipper at the mosque, seeking directions to allow devotees access to the premises and protection against its impending demolition.

Saud's counsel, M Suffian Siddiqui, submitted that people were being prevented from entering the mosque and alleged that Delhi Waqf Board (DWB) had abdicated its responsibility by failing to take steps to ensure worshippers' access to the mosque. Siddiqui further submitted that an official of the Land and Development Office (L&DO) had met the mosque's imam and informed him that the premises had to be vacated as demolition was imminent.

The DWB's counsel, meanwhile, informed the bench that the board had submitted a representation to the L&DO and other authorities on October 19, but no decision had been taken so far.

Saud contended that the ongoing restrictions violated his fundamental right to practise religion under Article 25 of the Constitution. He claimed that the mosque was over 150 years old and had been notified as a waqf property in 1977. He asserted that the structure had Grade-II heritage status under a 2009 notification issued by the Delhi government. The court issued notice in the matter and asked the Centre and DWB's counsel to seek instructions. The matter will be next heard on October 29.

DELHI CANTT: PVT GUARD, HIT BY UNIDENTIFIED VEHICLE, DIES

HT Correspondent
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A 37-year-old private security guard died during treatment at a Delhi hospital after sustaining severe injuries in an alleged accident in Delhi Cantonment in the early hours of Saturday. Police are yet to identify the vehicle involved and ascertain how the accident occurred, officers said on Tuesday.

A senior police officer said Praveen Kumar, a resident of Uttam Nagar, was injured around 5.30am on Saturday when he was returning home from work.

"After being hit by an unidentified vehicle, he called his brother, who took him to a hospital. He succumbed to injuries on Sunday," the officer said.

Police said a case was registered on Sunday under sections 281 (rash driving or riding on a public way) and 106(1) (causing death by negligence) of the BNS at Delhi Cantonment station.

{ DELHI'S DRAFT I.T. POLICY } 2026-31

'2 tech hubs in city, digital skills push for 600K youth'

Saloni Bhatia
saloni.bhatia@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government's draft Information Technology Policy 2026-2031 proposes more than 200 Global Capability Centres (GCCs), two dedicated innovation and technology districts, financial incentives for technology companies, training for 500,000 to 600,000 young people in digital skills, and the digitisation of all notified government services.

The government's Information Technology Department has prepared the draft policy, a copy of which HT has seen, to position the national capital as a major destination for IT investments, startups and emerging technology businesses, while strengthening cybersecurity.

The policy will be valid for five years from the date of its gazette notification or until a successor policy is notified. A mid-term review is proposed for 2028.

The policy proposes setting up innovation and technology districts, with priority areas including south Delhi, Dwarka and east Delhi. These districts are envisaged as hubs offering office space, laboratories, co-working facilities and infrastructure for startups and technology companies. At least two such districts are proposed to be notified, with one becoming operational during the policy period, according to the proposal.

To attract investments, the government has proposed a single-window clearance mechanism with a target of processing standard approvals within 30 days. A dedicated GCC facilitation cell would serve as a single point of contact for companies seeking to establish operations in Delhi, the draft says.

The proposed incentives include a 10% rebate on electricity tariffs for eligible IT and IT-enabled services companies and GCCs, and reimbursement of internet expenses of up to ₹5 lakh annually for three years.

The draft also proposes a diversity incentive of ₹5,000 per month per eligible woman, Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe, or person with disability employee for five years. Other measures include training reimbursements, artificial intelligence computing credits and support for cybersecurity certifications.

The government has set a target of training young people in digital skills, including artificial intelligence, cloud computing, cybersecurity and data analytics, by 2031. It also aims to increase women's representation in the technology workforce to 40%.

On governance, the draft envisages bringing 100% of notified government services online through a unified portal.

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER 25001/1385/2627
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA
By E_Mail / e-Despatch
E Mail ID : serwcbaripada@gmail.com / Ph-No-06792-261343 / 261344 / Gangraj, Baripada
"e" Procurement Notice for Bridge Works
Identification No.- Online Tender- Bridge N.C.B. No. 435 for 2026-27
Letter No. 5543 Dated 26-10-26 //
1. Name of the work :- Bridge works under SBY in the District of Mayurbhanj
2. Total No. of work :- 05 No (Five)
3. Estimated Cost :- Rs.317.94 Lakhs to Rs.899.57 lakhs (approximately).
4. Eligible Class of Contractor : - As per annexure.
5. Period of Completion :- As per annexure.
6. Other details

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender in O/O C.C.E.R.W. Circle, Baripada	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Baripada	Bridge On-line N.C.B. No 435	Dt. 13.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Dt.30.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt.27.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt 01.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

* Further details can be seen from the website: www.tendersorissa.gov.in.
* Any Corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the above e_tender website only.
Sd/- Er. A.K Naik
Chief Construction Engineer, R.W. Circle, Baripada
OIPR - 25001/25181/1/26-27/0021

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA 34001/1065/2627
NIRMAN SOUDHA, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR
E-mail ID:cebuildings_orissa@yahoo.co.in / cebuildings@rediffmail.com
Tel. -(0674)- 2391523
INVITATIONS FOR BIDS (IFB)
File No.-B-I-Home-54/2026 38566 / Bhubaneswar, the 16th Oct, 2026
Invitation for Bids
1st Corrigendum
Tender Reference No. CE-Bldg-II-40/2026-27
Name of the Work: (1) Construction of Block Level Stadium in Saintala Block (with Indoor Hall) in Balangir District.
(2) Construction of Block Level Stadium in Deogaon Block (with Indoor Hall) in Balangir District.
(3) Construction of Block Level Stadium in M. Rampur Block (with Indoor Hall) in Kalahandi District,
(4) Construction of 40 Nos. of E-type Staff Qrs. (Block I (S+3) and Block-II (S+2)) at Parlakhemundi, Gajapati
(5) Construction of the Office Building and Record Room of the Additional Sub-Collector (Settlement and Consolidation), Puri".
The following changes have been made in Bid Identification No. CE-Bldg-II-40/2026-27
1. Bid documents such as DTCN / BOQ etc. can be seen / downloaded from the Govt. Website i.e. www.tendersorissa.gov.in, during the period from dt.30.10.2026 to 17.00 hours of dt.16.11.2026 instead of dt.12.10.2026 to dt.27.10.2026 for ONLINE BIDDING respectively.
2. Online bids shall be received till 17.00 Hours of dt.16.11.2026 instead of dt.27.10.2026.
3. The technical bids will be opened at 11.30 A.M. of dt.17.11.2026 instead of dt.28.10.2026.
All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.
Chief Engineer, Buildings-II, Odisha, Bhubaneswar
OIPR - 34001/34117/1/26-27/0087

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On behalf of President of India Dy. Cheif Mechanical Engineer, office at: Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work:-

NIT No.	383961
Name of Work and its location	Refurbishment of 22 LHB (LWACCW) coaches during MLR schedule at RCNK/SNP (As per Scope of Work).
Approx. Cost of Work	Tender Cost: Rs 106300391.30/- including GST@18% (Rupees Ten Crore Sixty-Three Lakh Three Hundred Ninety-One and Thirty Paisa Only).
Earnest Money	Rs. 21,26,000/-
Completion Period of Work	06 months from date of issue of Letter of acceptance.
Cost of Tender document (In Rs.)	NIL
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs. on 16.11.2026, Opening of Tender at 15:15 hrs on same day.
Website particulars, notice board location, complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Tender No.: 383961 Dated: 27.10.2026 3747/2026
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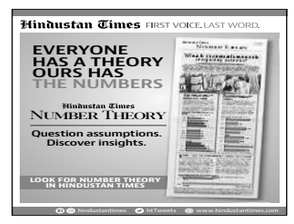

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25.07.1940 - 28.10.2007
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You will Stay in our Hearts Forever
Fondly Remembered by
Family Members, Relatives & Friends
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M/s. Harvinder & Company, New Delhi

ॐ
In loving Memory of
Shri Gautam Kr. Banerjee
28th October 1965 - 20th October 2026
"A life embraced with joy, a heart devoted to others."
With profound sorrow, we mourn the passing of Shri Gautam Kumar Banerjee, whose enthusiasm for life, generosity of spirit and genuine concern for others touched the lives of all who knew him.
He found happiness in life's simplest moments and shared it freely, extending kindness and support without expecting anything in return.
He leaves behind cherished memories of love, laughter, affection and a warmth that will remain in our hearts long after his passing.
Deeply loved, forever remembered and profoundly missed.
Bereaved Wife, Children and Family

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जल संसाधन विभाग
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सिंचाई यॉंत्रिक प्रमंडल, वीरपुर
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1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Repair and Maintenance work of the canal gates and other components of Mechanical Structures located at various points along the Western Koshi Main Canal 0.35km. and between the 0.4km. And 33.79 km. of the Western Koshi Main Canal (Nepal Portion) under the Jurisdiction of the Chief Engineer (Irrigation Creation), Darbhanga and the Irrigation Mechanical Division, Birpur.	495.23964	9.91	10,000.00	11,800.00	2 माह

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Sludge buildup, polluted drains raising Yamuna ammonia levels

Paras Singh
paras@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A study by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) has established that accumulated sludge on the Yamuna riverbed and polluted water from drains upstream are contributing to frequent spikes in ammonia levels in the river, which often lead to disruption in Delhi's water supply.

In a final report submitted to the Upper Yamuna River Board (UYRB), the CPCB has noted that the water holding pondage area, from which the Wazirabad and Chandrawal water treatment plants (WTPs) draw raw water, could be generating ammonia because of accumulating sludge.

Additionally, nitrogen-rich wastewater from drains in Haryana entering Yamuna has been identified as among the key factors why even the relatively cleaner stretch of the Yamuna between Palla and Wazirabad in Delhi has seen a deterioration in the water quality.

In the report, CPCB further said the pollution watchdog cautioned that dredging — the process of removing silt and sludge by underwater excavation — of the reservoir alone would not resolve the problem. It said the situation would improve only when nitrogen levels in water discharged into the Yamuna through drains are brought within acceptable limits.

"CPCB said that due to this, one-time de-sludging of the pond will not be effective, as the sludge carried by water containing high levels of nitrogen will again get deposited in the pond and will restore the problem," said a government official,

CPCB has said that the situation will improve only when nitrogen levels in water coming from drains are brought within acceptable limits. HT has seen the report.

On August 12, HT had reported that the UYRB had asked the CBCB to undertake a comprehensive study of the disruption in the city's water supply due to a spike in ammonia levels, particularly the sludge factor.

The raw water from Yamuna feeds the treatment plants in Wazirabad and Chandrawal, which supply water to the central, north and Old Delhi areas. A rise in ammonia levels, which are indicative of high industrial pollutant levels, leads to disruption in the water supply.

Periodic spikes in ammonia levels have been a long-standing point of dispute between Delhi and Haryana. The Delhi Jal Board (DJB) argues that the industrial pollutants, such as dyes, chlorides and ammonia-based chemicals, flow from the Panipat industrial drain.

DJB also regularly cites the intermixing of industrial waste in Sonipat, where two canals carrying freshwater and industrial water run parallel to each other, separated by a sand wall of a few inches.

In its submission to the UYRB, Haryana informed the CPCB that multiple steps are being taken to reduce pollution loads in drains ending up in Yamuna, including construction of a sewage treatment plant. "The programme is being strictly monitored by the Union home ministry," Haryana said in its submission.

Wazirabad pondage, a primary holding area formed by the Wazirabad barrage, spans approximately 250,000 square metres and has a depth of about 8.20 feet (2.5 metres).

SANCHIT KHANNA/HT

What CPCB flagged

Rise in ammonia levels, indicative of high industrial pollutant levels, leads to disruption in Delhi's water supply

Dredging — the process of removing silt and sludge by underwater excavation — of the reservoir alone would not resolve the problem

Situation would improve only when nitrogen levels in water discharged into the Yamuna through drains are brought within acceptable limits

CM: City to get 100K smart lights, 50K CCTVs for women's safety

NEW DELHI: Chief minister Rekha Gupta said on Tuesday the government is working to install 100,000 smart streetlights and 50,000 CCTV cameras to improve women's safety in the Capital.

Addressing students while inaugurating the Centenary Academic Building, Computer Centre, and Skill Development Centre at Delhi University's Daulat Ram College, the chief minister said every girl in Delhi should be able to pursue her dreams without fear, asserting that the government stood with them to protect their safety, dignity, and rights. HTC

Delhi is set to have more than 1,400 Chhath ghats this year, compared with 1,326 last year, chief minister Rekha Gupta announced on Tuesday after chairing a review meeting with officials from various departments and agencies. HT PHOTO

NCRTC RECEIVES BEST PASSENGER SERVICES AWARD

NEW DELHI: The National Capital Region Transport Corporation (NCRTC) has been conferred with an award for the best passenger services and satisfaction for the Delhi-Meerut Namo Bharat corridor at the 19th Urban Mobility India (UMI) Conference and Expo 2026, held in Bhubaneshwar, Odisha. The award was presented by housing and urban affairs minister Manohar Lal.

NCRTC said that since the phased commencement of operations from October 2023, the corridor has recorded over 4.8 crore passenger journeys. "Beyond improving individual journeys, it is strengthening the links between major urban centre," it added in a statement. HTC

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Mayank Austen Soofi

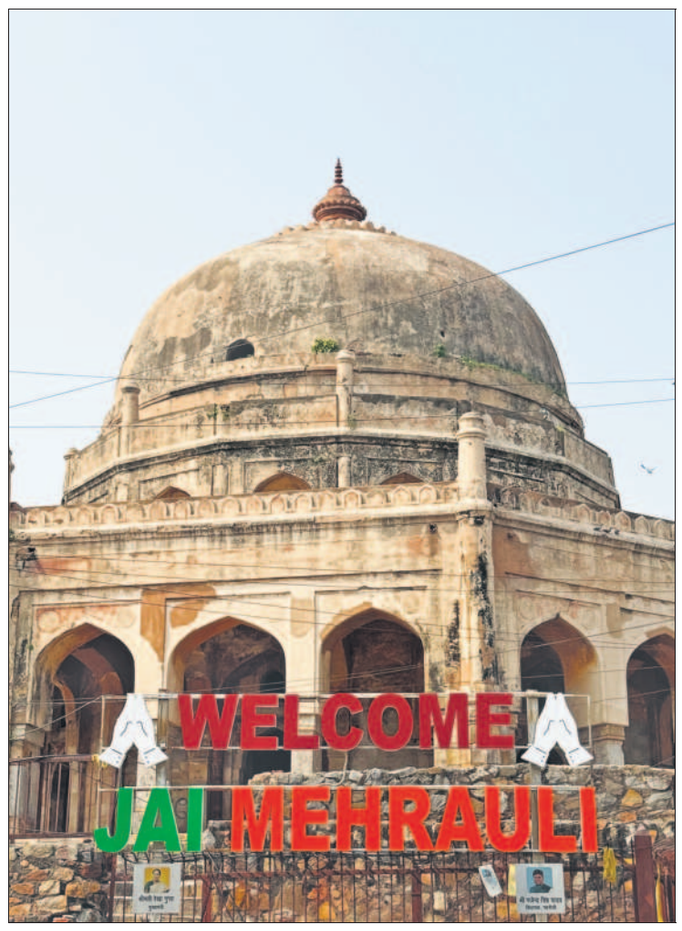
Vive la Mehrauli

Winter preview of a historic neighbourhood

PUBLIC INTEREST

Adam Khan's tomb rose above Mehrauli's bus adda, its façade visible against the sky. Then, a few weeks ago, a large sign appeared before it. "WELCOME," it said, followed by "JAI MEHRAULI." The dome rose above the greeting, while the arches appeared behind the red, green and saffron letters—see photo. The monument had been given a new role of formally welcoming everyone to the neighbourhood.

Mehrauli has a new store by fashion designer Sabyasachi Mukherjee. It also has so many monuments that a citizen might pass one while looking for another. The area is vast, and one sprawling part of it is called Mehrauli Archaeological Park. But outside the park, too, monuments are scattered through the neighbourhood's streets and bazars. Winter is the best time to explore them. Many were already old when Shah Jahan began building what is now called Old Delhi. The tall and lanky Qutub Minar, of course, is the most visible of them all.



Within the Qutub Minar complex stands the exquisitely beautiful Mughal Masjid. Small and spare, it has three domes, two slender minarets and a teeny-weeny walled garden. Built in late Mughal times, when Mehrauli was a summer getaway for the Red Fort royalty, it is sadly closed to visitors.

Elsewhere in Mehrauli is the Sufi shrine of Hazrat Khwaja Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki, the neighbourhood's patron saint. Close by stands Baba Banda Singh Bahadur Gurudwara. Its terrace overlooks Shahidi Gate, marking the spot where the Sikh leader was martyred, along with other Sikhs, including his young son.

Nearby, Zafar Mahal's passages lead through chambers, stairs and dingy dark stone structures. Sunlight shifts across niches in the roofless portions. Above, carved pillars frame the neighbourhood's water tankis. Planes can be heard and seen overhead. Delhi experts are often sighted leading walks through Mehrauli. Once, a historian concluded a tour at Zafar Mahal, reading poetry by Bahadur Shah Zafar beside the empty burial space intended for him. The last Mughal emperor, also a poet, wanted to be buried here, but lies in distant Rangoon.

The Mehrauli bazar happens to hold one of Delhi's most beautiful graveyards, although burials no longer take place here. Sacred to Delhi's transgender citizens, the courtyard at Hijron ka Khanqah receives visiting groups who pray, sing and share food.

Back at the Mehrauli bus adda, the tomb behind the Jai Mehrauli sign dates to around 1562. The monument looks serene. The man it commemorates met a far less serene end. On Emperor Akbar's orders, Adam Khan was hurled from a parapet, then carried back up by his black-robed executioners and thrown down again, when finally he died. The bit about the black robes, it must be confessed, comes from the Hrithik Roshan-starrer musical Jodhaa Akbar. A clip of the morbid scene is available on YouTube.

Whatever, the tomb's thick walls enclose passageways, giving it the popular identity of a bhool bhullaiya, a labyrinth where one might easily lose one's way. Between us, dear reader, the claim is exaggerated.

READ: For more stories by Mayank Austen Soofi, scan the QR code

HINDUSTAN TIMES CONSUMER CONNECT INITIATIVE

The Festive Edge
LEADERS' LENS

As part of HT Media's Festive Edge initiative, Leaders' Lens brings together industry perspectives on the consumer shifts, market trends and brand priorities shaping the festive season.

AMIT GOYAL,
Managing Director, India Sotheby's International Realty

What is the biggest change you've seen in how Indians are shopping this festive season compared with last?
The festive season has begun on an encouraging note for online retail, but luxury real estate plays by different rules. While auspicious dates and developer incentives do spur buying, these are considered, high-value decisions, not impulse purchases. This year, after a strong five-year upcycle, ultra-luxury housing is entering a more measured phase. Buyers are taking longer to decide and sellers are becoming more realistic on pricing, creating greater room for negotiation. The RBI's recent repo rate hike to 5.50% could also add to the caution by raising borrowing costs. This festive season, we expect buyers to remain selective, cautious and sharply focused on value.

Where does a festive purchase actually get decided today: the showroom floor, a phone screen, a creator's video, or a conversation at home?
The decision to buy a luxury home begins long before a site visit. Increasingly, discovery happens across digital and social platforms, as much as through print. Detailed features, striking visuals and virtual walkthroughs help buyers explore properties, assess their potential and shortlist what merits a closer look. Print adds depth and credibility, while digital platforms enable discovery, engagement and enquiries. Together, they help connect the right homes with the right buyers. The final decision, however, rests on much more than advertising: it calls for informed advice, trust and a nuanced understanding of a family's needs. At the $1 million (₹10 crore) and above price point, which we specialise in, a site visit is essential. Experiencing the property firsthand is critical, and that's what we always advise our clients.

What are people willing to spend more on this festive season, and where are they holding back?
In real estate, affluent buyers will stretch for what is scarce - a prime address, a generous land parcel, a legacy property or a truly exceptional holiday/second home. But value goes beyond just location and exclusivity. It also lies in the quality of construction, well-curated communities, thoughtfully designed amenities and connectivity to key business and lifestyle hubs. Buyers are increasingly weighing the overall living experience against the price tag and a credible developer, fair pricing and strong capital appreciation potential remain essential. A combination of these factors makes a property worth the premium.

Festive season buries the customer in offers: screens, scrolls, forwards and clicks. When you have something you need people to actually believe, where do you say it, and why there?
When it comes to real estate, buyers invest in an asset that they expect to hold on for years, an exclusive address when it comes to a resale property, or a reputed developer, architect, interior etc. for first buys, transparency and credibility, all matters. Ultimately, it is the brand's reputation built over years and not a season that influences a buyer's decisions. Also, the track record offers buyers the confidence to make these financial commitments easily.

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The difference eight hours can make

Haze seen at the India Gate at 7.19am (left), which eventually cleared by 2.54pm (right) on Tuesday. According to the data from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB), Tuesday's official AQI reading, taken at 4pm, was 197 – in the "moderate" category. However, it had deteriorated to the "poor" category again by 10pm, when it was 208. SANCHIT KHANNA/HT PHOTOS

HC declines to stay probe into scribe's 'casteist' remarks

Shruti Kakkar
shruti.kakkar@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Tuesday declined to stay the investigation into two journalists accused of making casteist remarks against assistant commissioner of police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat.

The journalists are also accused of publicly humiliating the police officer and obstructing him from discharging his official duties during a protest in the national Capital on October 3.

A bench of Justice Mini Pushkarna observed that the investigation could not be stayed without first examining the status report filed by the Delhi Police, since the matter required consideration.

"Unless and until I have their (Delhi police) status report, the investigation cannot be stayed. Investigation may continue. Let me issue notice. I'm not passing any order except issuing notice. I am not saying anything... ," the court said.

The court, however, issued notice in the petition filed by the two journalists, including a woman who had accused ACP Bhagat of sexual harassment, seeking quashing of the FIR registered by the Delhi Police.

The FIR, a copy of which has been accessed by HT, charges the journalist and two others under sections 221 (obstructing a public servant), 356(2) (defamation), and 3(5) (joint liability) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), alongside provisions under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

The court also refused to pass an order restraining police from taking coercive action against the male journalist.

"I don't have the powers of the Supreme Court. It can pass such orders," the court said.

This was after senior advocate Tanvir Mir, representing the two journalists, urged the court to stay the probe, saying the FIR was a "revengeful" and retaliatory measure to coerce the woman journalist into giving up her complaint at Parliament Street Police Station.

The controversy dates to October 3 this year, when the female journalist said she was taking videos of the detention of an activist, when ACP Bhagat allegedly touched her inappropriately and pushed her.

Bhagat denied the allegations.

The police forwarded her complaint to the crime branch for an "impartial inquiry".

The matter will be next heard on November 16.

CAQM sets up its command centre 'Pavan' in Delhi

Jasjeev Gandhiok
jasjeev.gandhiok@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) in NCR has set up an in-house integrated command and control centre (ICCC) to monitor polluting activities across Delhi-NCR on a real-time basis, and the same will be operationalised soon, officials aware of the matter said.

The facility, Pavan (The Platform for Air quality Vigilance and Analytics for NCR), will receive live feeds from construction sites and landfill sites across the region, get real-time stubble burning data through multiple satellite and tracker data, observe 108 operational continuous ambient air quality monitoring stations (CAAQMS), monitor live complaints from government air pollution apps, receive data from brick kilns and track implementation of state action plans.

Officials said states can be issued data and notice of violations on a daily basis for corrective action, besides tracking long-term trends. Ahead of operationalising it completely, Union environment minister Bhupender Yadav will visit the centre on October 30 to assess the preparations made and carry out a review.

"We will gather feedback from the minister after showing him the control centre. Based on this, the necessary changes can be made, ahead of making the facility fully operational," an official said. The facility has been set up on the 16th floor of the STC building at Janpath, where CAQM works out of.

During a visit on Tuesday, HT spotted an integrated dashboard, with a team of five CAQM officials looking at multiple feeds on separate screens from landfill sites and construction sites. Simultaneously, the dashboard displayed data from mechanised road sweepers (MRS), comparing the pre-mandated routes set for each MRS and analysing the actual distance and area covered through its GPS coordinates.

The CAAQMS dashboard, meanwhile, allows teams to track the 10 most-polluted stations across NCR at any given time, allowing localised action if needed. Data will help during periodic reviews and the dashboard will be made accessible to states as well, the official said.

Mercury drops to 15.3°C; rain likely in next 2 days

Saloni Bhatia
saloni.bhatia@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Mercury levels continued to decrease as Delhi recorded its coldest day of the month for the second day on the trot, clocking a minimum temperature of 15.3 degrees Celsius (°C), according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), which has forecast rain, thunderstorms and gusty winds for October 29 and 30.

As per IMD data, the minimum was 1.9 degrees below normal, and almost a degree lower than the minimum of 16.2°C recorded the day before. The maximum temperature was 31.5°C, with not much variation from normal or the maximum recorded the day before.

AIR WE BREATHE

Meteorologist Navdeep Dahiya said that the likely interaction of Cyclone Arnab's outer bands with an approaching western disturbance can bring multiple spells of moderate to heavy showers or thunderstorms in Delhi-NCR on Thursday and the first half of Friday. "There is a possibility of heavy rains also on Thursday while there could be light to moderate rainfall in the first half of Friday. This will lead to better air quality as well as dip in daytime temperature," he said.

While Delhi continued to record a "moderate" air quality index (AQI), of 197, on the Central Pollution Control Board's (CPCB's) 24-hour daily average at 4pm, live data at 9pm showed that it had deteriorated to 206, categorised as "poor".

At 9pm on Tuesday, CPCB listed fine particulate matter (PM2.5) as the main pollutant at 40 of Delhi's 55 air quality stations and PM10 at 12 stations. Officials said that the forecast rain and gusty winds could influence the dispersion of pollutants, although the extent of any improvement will depend on the intensity of rainfall and prevailing wind conditions. Meanwhile, according to NASA's satellite data, 65 farm fires were recorded in Punjab and Haryana on Tuesday (Punjab 61, Haryana 4), a day after it recorded 69 fires, and took the count to 702.

To be sure, the numbers are likely underreported, given that most stubble fires take place in the evening, after the satellite has passed through the region, at around 1.30pm, to avoid detection and penalties.

Rain reprieve on the cards Thursday-Friday

The weather office has forecast a generally cloudy sky on October 29, with very light to light rainfall likely at several locations during the afternoon and evening. Thunderstorms, lightning and strong surface winds, reaching speeds of 30-40 kmph, are also likely.

For October 30, the IMD has forecast a partly cloudy to generally cloudy sky, with a possibility of very light rainfall accompanied by thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds at many places from morning to forenoon. The maximum temperature on October 30 is likely to remain between 25°C and 27°C, while the minimum is expected to settle between 17°C and 19°C.

CHALLANS ISSUED TO 4,572 VEHICLES WITH NO PUC

NEW DELHI: The Delhi transport department issued 4,572 challans to vehicles without valid pollution under control (PUC) certificates and impounded 145 buses between October 11 and 25 as part of a crackdown on vehicular pollution, government data showed on Tuesday.

During the same period, the department took action against 48 vehicles emitting visible smoke, 15 vehicles carrying building material and impounded 558 overloaded vehicles. The enforcement drive was carried out in accordance with directions issued by the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM), the department said. A total of 39 teams have been deployed round the clock at 13 major border points and toll plazas to check violations.

The action comes amid concerns over vehicular emissions as the Capital's air quality is expected to deteriorate with the onset of winter. HTC

Govt mulls affordable public hygiene centres

Paras Singh
paras@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi government plans to set up "Suvidha centres" in low-income neighbourhoods, modelled on Mumbai's common utility centres, offering subsidised laundry, bathing and toilet facilities, along with clean drinking water, officials said on Tuesday.

The first pilot is under construction at Ekta Camp in south Delhi's RK Puram, with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) collaborating with the Union housing and urban affairs ministry and corporate partners through corporate social responsibility (CSR) funding.

A senior MCD official said Hindustan Unilever Ltd (HUL) is constructing the facility, spread over around 160 square metres. It will have 46 toilet stalls, four shower units, eight washing machines and a water ATM. Construction is expected to be completed within three months.

Users will be charged ₹3 per toilet visit, ₹70 for a full laundry cycle and ₹1 per litre of reverse-osmosis-filtered water.

'Cong given permission to protest at Ramlila Maidan'

Karn Pratap Singh
karn.singh@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Tuesday reiterated that permission had been granted for the Congress rally at Ramlila Maidan on November 1, denying allegations that the organisers had been stopped from preparing for the event.

Around 3,000 Delhi Police personnel will be deployed in and around the venue, which will be divided into eight regions and 14 zones under the security plan, senior police officers said. Each region will be headed by an officer of deputy commissioner of police (DCP) or additional DCP rank, while an assistant commissioner of police (ACP)-rank officer will oversee each zone.

They will be assisted by at least 25 inspectors and personnel ranging from sub-inspectors to constables, officials said.

Police said security and traffic arrangements were being put in place and preparations.

"We have not withdrawn the permission for the Congress rally. The Ramlila Maidan has been booked for the organisers from October 25 to November 3. There is no change in the permission that we granted on October 17," a senior police officer said, requesting anonymity.

The clarification came after Congress leader KC Venugopal alleged in a social media post on Tuesday that Delhi Police had stopped party leaders from preparing the venue despite the organisers having the requisite permissions. Police have also installed nearly 150 CCTV cameras in and around the venue for round-the-clock surveillance, an officer said, adding that personnel from armed paramilitary forces will also be deployed.

SC seeks Rahul Gandhi's reply on plea alleging Oct 12 violence

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday sought a response from Rahul Gandhi and others on a plea which alleged the Congress leader pushed a pregnant journalist during a march to the apex court on October 12.

The plea was mentioned before a bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi, which issued notice to those named. Senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia, who mentioned the matter, said a female journalist was manhandled in the court premises.

"The push was delivered openly, in a crowded place, in the presence of security personnel, journalists and other persons, despite her express pleas, and was not a mere jostle of the crowd", the plea submitted. The application sought directions seeking an FIR against Gandhi and others, besides seeking compensation. PTI

BNSS Section 163 in JMI, gates closed as stand-off continues

Gargi Shukla and Karn Pratap Singh
htreporters@hindustantimes

NEW DELHI: Restrictions under section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) came into effect on Tuesday outside Jamia Millia Islamia (JMI) university, prohibiting assemblies and gatherings, as all alternative entries into the university were shut. The development comes a day after an agreement between students and the administration failed to end the nearly two-week-long stand-off.

Nearly 100 men and women students were occupying the Gulistan-e-Ghalib building despite a warning from the university administration a day earlier. "Around 8am, 35 women staff went to meet women students to convince them to leave the building. But they refused," said a JMI spokesperson.

Around 4pm, a 30-minute protest took place as the students managed to walk outside from the Ghalib Lawn to Gate no.7, a distance of few steps. The students were dispersed by JMI security guards. All major gates, including Gate No. 7, the closest to the protest site at Gate no. 18, were closed and carried posters from the Delhi Police that stated that section 163 was in force and public gatherings and demonstrations were strictly prohibited in the area. The restrictions were also announced repeatedly over loudspeakers through the day.

Security personnel and police deployed at the campus amid protests by students at JMI university on Tuesday. SANJEEV VERMA/HT

DCP (southeast) Vineet Kumar has confirmed that prohibitory orders had been imposed around Jamia Millia Islamia, adding that nobody was detained on Tuesday.

However, the students, who have been demanding the reinstatement of the student union which has not been convened since 2006, said they would still continue their protest till all their demands were met.

"The administration has been silent on our key demands—date-wise schedule of the union election, representation of student in constitution making committee, suspension of online classes, the reopening of canteens and the library, a timeline for the approval of the student body's constitution, and the resignation of the chief proctor," said 22-year-old Master's student, adding, "The hunger strike will continue, and the protest will continue."

To be sure, on Monday, the administration agreed to one of the key demands of the students, announcing that it would resume student union elections after two decades. However, this failed to resolve the stand-off with students saying the administration had not issued a definite timeline for the polls.

Meanwhile, speaking after inaugurating a Central Board of Secondary Education's (CBSE) Experience Centre at the board's headquarters in Dwarka, Union education minister Pralhad Joshi said, "No one should try to create a law and order problem. This is what I can appeal. The Jamia administrators are looking after the things and taking care of the matter."

DELHI POLICE REVAMPS WEBSITE, ADDS EMERGENCY CONTACT OPTION

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has launched its new and revamped official website, introducing a more user-friendly interface with quick access to emergency contact numbers, interactive videos on cybercrime awareness, among others, officials aware of the matter said.

According to a police officer aware of the matter, the redesigned website, available at delhipolice.gov.in, aims to make information and public services easier to access, bringing key resources to the forefront instead of requiring visitors to navigate through multiple pages.

One of the prominent additions is a widget for emergency numbers. "By placing these numbers prominently on the website, the portal seeks to reduce the time users spend searching for contact information" the officer said.

The website also features interactive videos on cybercrime, the officer added. HTC

CIVIL AVIATION MINISTRY REVIEWS FOG PREPAREDNESS AHEAD OF WINTER

NEW DELHI: The civil aviation ministry on Tuesday held the its first meeting ahead of the upcoming winter season to review fog preparedness and coordination among stakeholders.

The meeting was headed by civil aviation secretary Samir Kumar Sinha and attended by the director general of directorate general of civil aviation (DGCA) Vir Vikram Yadav, Airports Authority of India (AAI) chairman Puneet Kansal, senior officials from the Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS), Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), India Meteorological Department (IMD), along with representatives of Delhi airport and other fog-affected airports and airlines.

The IMD officials stated that the fog season is expected to run from December 15 this year to February 15, 2027.

"The meeting focused on ensuring smooth airport operations and minimising inconvenience to passengers during fog-related disruptions," a statement said. NEHA LM TRIPATHI

{ ANUPAM SUD } NATIONAL GALLERY OF MODERN ART

Revisiting Delhi's forgotten printmaking history, an artist's legacy

Anupam Sud's printing press, built locally and designed by her professor, displayed at the Delhi Silpi Chakra. RAJ K RAJ /HT PHOTO

Dhamini Ratnam
dhamini.ratnam@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: The premises of the Delhi Silpi Chakra, an arts society founded in 1949, have not been opened in years and a fine patina of dust covers the floors.

Paintings still hang on its walls, and many lie stacked up against them. Darkness envelops a side room until the balcony door is forced open and sunlight streams in, illuminating a printing press in the centre of the room.

The machine once belonged to 82-year-old Anupam Sud. Built locally and designed by her professor and mentor Jagmohan Chopra, it is one of the few presses that helped shape Delhi's nearly forgotten printmaking legacy.

Sud is herself a formative part of the Capital's cultural history. After graduating from Delhi Polytechnic (later the College of Art) in 1967, she studied printmaking at the Slade School of Art in London in the early '70s, and upon her return, even joined the Delhi Silpi Chakra.

Last week, a grand retrospective opened at the National Gallery of Modern Art (NGMA) which showcases the breadth of Sud's oeuvre. Besides her prints, it also includes her sketches, paintings, watercolours, and sculptures.

The month-long exhibition, presented by the Dhoomimal Gallery and the NGMA, has been conceptualised by Amanpreet Singh, a long-time collector of Sud's works.

"Through this retrospective, Anupam Sud's work needs to be looked at as a microcosm of the evolution of Indian art since Independence. Her works of each decade, even though they are reflective of her personal journey as an artist, also in some way reflect what was catching the attention of the common Indian at that time," Singh said.

Printmaking, then and now, is a resource-intensive practice — requiring acid, copper and zinc plates, felt, rollers, and printing presses — as well as a physically demanding one.

"I remember asking Jagmohan Chopra, why were we taught printmaking if there was no infrastructure outside the college to pursue it?" Sud said.

Chopra responded by doing two things. One, he formed a collective called Group 8 in 1968. And two, he set up a makeshift printmaking studio at his home that Sud and other members of the group would use.

"He made several trips to Turkman Gate to get the machine made," Sud said.

"[While studying] in England, I saw the aquatint box for the first time and I sent detailed drawings to him. When I returned, we got a carpenter to make the box and it turned out beautifully. Up until then we would use cloth potli to dust powder on a plate, but the aquatint box mechanised the process," Sud said.

An aquatint box is used in intaglio printing and lets fine particles of rosin powder fall onto the zinc or copper plate, which in turn helps create the print's texture.

Sud's journey as a printmaker went hand in hand with her teaching career; she joined the College of Art in 1975 as a lecturer in the printmaking department.

"When I joined the college, most of the infrastructure was lying in disarray and in disuse. I got them repaired and we were given three studios, one each for lithography, etching, and linocut and woodcut," she said.

Though printmaking in India began in the 19th century, it truly came into its own in the mid-20th century, as artists across mediums experimented with different printmaking techniques.

Krishna Reddy, who is one of the country's most well-known printmakers, achieved great finesse in Paris, working with William Stanley Hayter's Atelier 17. Back home, Santiniketan and later, MS Baroda University proved to be printmaking havens.

Sud belongs to a lineage of artists who elevated printmaking into a practice with political and philosophical meaning.

GOOD GOVERNANCE, CULTURAL HERITAGE AND INCLUSIVE DEVELOPMENT IN UTTAR PRADESH

The objective of good governance in Uttar Pradesh is to ensure the prompt resolution of public grievances, preserve religious and cultural heritage, and extend the benefits of development to every section of society. An effective public grievance redressal system is providing relief to citizens, while improved facilities at religious centres such as Ayodhya and Kashi are adding a new dimension to faith and pilgrimage. Meanwhile, pension schemes, scholarships, marriage grants, free training and welfare initiatives for persons with disabilities are strengthening social security and self-reliance. In this way, good governance is improving administrative systems, restoring due recognition to culture and making development opportunities accessible to more people.

RELIGIOUS AFFAIRS: BETTER FACILITIES AT PILGRIMAGE CENTRES AND RECOGNITION OF HERITAGE

- Financial Assistance for the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra: Permanent residents of Uttar Pradesh are eligible for a grant of ₹1 lakh upon completing the pilgrimage once in their lifetime.
- Encouraging the Sindhu Darshan Yatra: Pilgrims who successfully complete the journey receive financial assistance of ₹20,000.
- Development of Facilities for Devotees in Ayodhya: Beautification of the remaining vacant land along both sides of Ram Path and the construction of a floating public bathing facility in the Saryu River have been completed.
- Improved Access to the Ram Temple: Construction of the 12.940-kilometre-long, four-lane main access road to Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple in Ayodhya Dham has been completed.
- Public Facilities at Religious Sites: A plan has been made to construct 35 public toilets and utility facilities at various locations within the Ayodhya Municipal Corporation area.
- Development of Bhajan Sandhya Venues: Bhajan Sandhya venues are being developed in Prayagraj and Gorakhpur.
- Promotion of Vedic Knowledge in Kashi: The Centre for Vedic Science has been established at Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi.
- Infrastructure Development in Ayodhya: Five basic infrastructure development projects were completed during the financial year 2025-26.
- Kashi Vishwanath Dham Corridor: An important development initiative aimed at connecting religious heritage with better facilities and organised access.

SOCIAL WELFARE: OPPORTUNITIES FOR EDUCATION, SECURITY AND SELF-RELIANCE

- Support for Competitive Examination Preparation: Under the Chief Minister Abhyudaya Scheme, 23,801 candidates received free training during the financial year 2025-26.
- In 2026-27, training is being provided to 19,287 candidates so far. Under the scheme, more than 1,166 candidates have been selected in various competitive examinations.
- Social Security through Old-Age and Farmers' Pensions: As of September 8, 2026, pensions were provided to 65,29,500 pensioners at the rate of ₹1,000 per month.
- Financial Assistance to Families: Under the National Family Benefit Scheme, financial assistance totalling ₹409.365 crore was provided to 1,36,455 beneficiaries during the financial year 2025-26.
- Education for Children from Vulnerable Sections: A total of 103 Jai Prakash Narayan Sarvodaya Schools are operational across the state, with 38,338 students enrolled in 2026-27.
- Support to Families through Mass Marriage: Under the Chief Minister Mass Marriage Scheme, the assistance amount per couple has been increased from ₹51,000 to ₹1 lakh. A total of 76,522 couples were married in 2025-26, while 17,761 couples have been married so far in 2026-27.

FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE AND SOCIAL SECURITY: SUPPORT FOR NEEDY FAMILIES

- Support for the Marriage of Daughters from Backward Classes: During the financial year 2025-26, a total of ₹232 crore was transferred to the bank accounts of 116,000 beneficiaries.
- Regular Assistance through Disability Pensions: A total of 12,23,295 persons with disabilities in the state have been provided maintenance grants or pensions at the rate of ₹1,000 per month.
- Leprosy Pension: Pensions were distributed to 13,667 beneficiaries at the rate of ₹3,000 per month.
- Identification of Persons with Disabilities and Access to Schemes: A total of 20,86,504 persons with disabilities have registered on the UDID portal, and 17,51,000 identity cards have been issued.
- Promotion of Self-Employment: Under the Shop Construction and Operation Scheme, the target for 2026-27 is to benefit 1,060 persons with disabilities.
- Making Life Easier through Assistive Devices: Under the Artificial Limbs and Assistive Devices Scheme, the target for 2026-27 is to benefit 27,300 persons with disabilities.

PUBLIC GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL: TIMELY RESOLUTION OF COMPLAINTS, A HALLMARK OF GOOD GOVERNANCE

- Direct Interaction through Janata Darshan: Janata Darshan sessions held at the Chief Minister's official residence provide an opportunity to hear the concerns of aggrieved citizens and complainants and ensure effective resolution of their grievances.
- Resolution of Crores of Complaints through IGRS: As of September 16, 2026, timely resolution had been ensured for 7,05,64,503 out of the 7,15,19,567 references received.
- Regular Hearings at Tehsils and Police Stations: Sampoorna Samadhan Diwas is organised on the first and third Saturdays of every month, while Thana Diwas is held on the second and fourth Saturdays.
- Action on Complaints through Helpline 1076: The Chief Minister's Helpline provides a mechanism for the prompt resolution of public grievances.

KAAM DAMDAAR - DOUBLE ENGINE SARKAR

HINDUSTAN TIMES MEDIA MARKETING INITIATIVE

9.97 million names deleted in Karnataka final electoral roll

Arun Dev and Nishant Ranjan
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU/NEW DELHI: Karnataka released its final electoral roll on Tuesday, dropping 9.97 million names after the special intensive revision, with the state capital Bengaluru accounting for the highest percentage of deletions and the coastal district of Udupi accounting for the lowest.

The final electoral roll contains 45,455,689 general electors, compared to 55,432,314 on the rolls as of June 16, when SIR began, marking a reduction of 9,976,625. Including 44,322 service electors, the final statewide total stands at 45,500,011.

Karnataka's deletion of 18% of the pre-SIR roll is the highest among major states.

Chief electoral officer V Anbukkumar said that after completion of the verification and disposal of claims and objections, as well as the disposal of notices, 1,008,038 electors were added, 188,324 deleted, and 896,519 modifications were made to the draft electoral roll in accordance with laws and instructions of the Election Commission of India.

"We issued notices to approximately 43.8 lakh electors and conducted hearings. During these proceedings, electoral registration officers (EROs) and assistant electoral registration officers (AEROs) found certain individuals ineligible. Following the prescribed inquiry and the issuance of reasoned orders, 61,960 names were identified for deletion," he said.

Of the 188,324 deletions, 1,091 were of deceased electors, 184 were of absent electors, 762 were of those already enrolled or with duplicate entries, and 124,327 were related to shifts of residence, resulting in the automatic generation of Form 7, he said.

By adding voters between the draft and final rolls, Karnataka has followed the broader trend of all states and UTs seeing an increase between the strength of the draft and final SIR roll, except for West Bengal and Goa.

A district-wise analysis showed that the Bengaluru region accounted for a large share of electoral deletions. Four urban districts in Bengaluru — Bangalore Urban, BBMP (South), BBMP (North) and BBMP (Central) — accounted for a total of 4.5 million deletions between the pre-SIR and final roll. This is 45% of the total deletions in the state. These four districts had a share of just 19% in the state's total pre-SIR elector count. Their elector share in the final roll has fallen to 13% now.

The note issued by the CEO showed that the ratio of electors to projected population in the three BBMP districts – North, Central and South, at 53.4%, 51.1% and 45.8% respectively – was the lowest in the state and significantly lower than the 66.1% for the state.

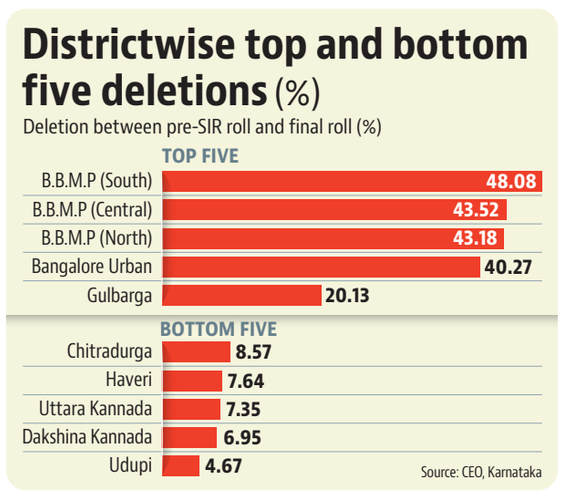
These four districts were the only ones that saw more than 40% deletion of electors between the pre-SIR and final electoral roll. In ten districts, the deletion was less than 10%, the number being the lowest (4.7%) in Udupi in the coastal Karnataka region. Dakshina Kannada, which has the highest population share of Muslims in the state, saw the second lowest (6.9%) deletions.

Women outnumbered men in the final roll, where 22,583,107 were male, 22,914,063 were female and 2,841 categorised as other. An age-wise breakup showed that the largest number, 10.26 million, was in the 30-39 category.

The CEO said between June 16 and October 26, the authorities received 1,062,336 Form 6 applications, 4,872 Form 6A applications, 229,235 Form 7 applications and approximately 1.327 million Form 8 applications, taking the total number of applications received to approximately 2.6 million.

He said that, except for around 4,000 applications submitted offline, the rest were filed online. He said roughly 303,000 applications were rejected, 2 million accepted and 255,000 were pending.

Referring to media reports that officials generated around 60,000 Form 7 applications to delete voters, the CEO clarified that there was no provision for bulk generation of Form 7. "Every such form must be generated in the name of the competent officer after the prescribed inquiry and the passing of a speaking order.



Only 1.4% with notices marked ineligible; highest in Bengaluru

Arun Dev
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: Bengaluru accounted for nearly half of the 61,867 people declared ineligible by electoral officers after notices issued in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise were resolved through hearings, data released by the Election Commission showed.

Those declared ineligible amounted to about 1.4% of those who were issued notices after the draft electoral list was published in August. Notices were issued to 4,382,824 people across Karnataka and hearings held in all the cases, according to the Chief Electoral Officer's final report. Of these, 4,320,957 electors were retained in the final roll after verification and 61,867 excluded.

These people were removed from the electoral roll through Form 7s generated by the electoral officers who marked them as ineligible, Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) V Anbukkumar said.

The final roll published on Tuesday saw the removal of 9.97 million voters. Bengaluru had the highest number of overall deletions too.

In the notice and hearings process, the region accounted for 30,924 exclusions. Bommanahalli recorded 4,136 exclusions, the highest among the state's 224 Assembly constituencies, followed by KR Pura with 3,081 and Mahadevapura with 2,870.

The exclusions rate differed between constituencies.

In Bommanahalli, 4,136 of the 102,361 people issued notices were marked ineligible, a rate of about 4%. KR Pura recorded 3,081 exclusions among 176,909 notices, while Mahadevapura had 2,870 among 171,623. Both constituencies had exclusion rates of about 1.7%.

{ AMID SIR ROW } COURT SAYS WILL EXAMINE RECORDS

SC declines to direct ECI to preserve files

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday refrained from directing the Election Commission of India (ECI) to preserve its files, internal notings and communications in the controversy over alleged unilateral decisions concerning the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, even as it assured petitioners that it would examine the records.

A bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana adjourned the hearing on a batch of petitions challenging the functioning of the poll panel and allegations that chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar took key decisions without the concurrence of the other two election commissioners.

The court allowed the petitioners time to respond to a counter-affidavit filed by ECI on Monday, which maintained that all decisions relating to SIR were taken unanimously.

When senior advocates Abhishek Manu Singhvi and Menaka Guruswamy sought an order directing the poll panel to preserve all files, file notings and communications, solicitor general Tushar Mehta and senior advocate Maninder Singh, appearing for ECI, opposed the request. "The request is unfair. We are talking about a constitutional body," they submitted.

Singhvi said the petitioners were seeking only an "innocuous order". The bench responded: "We are aware of everything. Do not worry, we will examine."

The court, however, did not expressly direct ECI to preserve the records. It tentatively posted the matter for November 17, giving the petitioners, including senior counsel Vikas Singh who appeared for lead petitioner Rakesh Kumar Singh, time to file their rejoinders to the poll panel's affidavit.

The court tentatively posted the matter for November 17.

The hearing also saw the court issue notice on a fresh petition filed by Rajya Sabha MP Dola Sen, represented by Guruswamy, challenging aspects of ECI's functioning, including alleged changes to the online Form 6 used for voter enrolment. The petition also takes issue with a press note issued by the poll panel stating that the Supreme Court had authorised the alleged changes.

"It pertains to functioning of ECI including tampering with online Form 6 and EC releasing a press note saying that your lordships have authorised such tampering," Guruswamy told the bench. "We will examine," responded the court. Guruswamy urged the court to issue notice, arguing that ECI's latest affidavit accepted several of the petitioners' allegations. "Please see the audacity of the institution," she said, referring to the poll panel's defence of the changes to Form 6.

Singh, appearing for ECI, objected to what he described as "rhetoric intended for another purpose", saying it should not be permitted. The bench proceeded to issue notice and asked the petitioners to file their rejoinders, with the senior lawyers seeking time to respond to ECI's submissions.

The latest hearing follows ECI's joint counter-affidavit filed on Monday on behalf of the commission, Kumar and election commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi. The affidavit rejected allegations that the CEC acted unilaterally, asserting that the three orders governing SIR, issued on June 24, 2025, October 27, 2025, and May 14, 2026, were based on unanimous decisions and complied with Article 324 of the Constitution and Section 18 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023.

The commission also denied amending the statutory Form 6, arguing that the declaration required during SIR was a separate document prescribed through its orders and not part of the form laid down under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960. It said the declaration was modified to facilitate the linking of applicants or their relatives with earlier electoral rolls, potentially allowing applicants to avoid furnishing other supporting documents.

The Form 6 dispute had earlier prompted the Supreme Court to clarify that it had neither approved nor disapproved the alleged modification and that it wanted to examine the original records to establish what changes had been made and by whom.

The challenge has drawn on allegations that Sandhu and Joshi raised objections to decisions relating to the SIR and other aspects of electoral-roll management, and that disagreements within the commission were not reflected in the manner in which decisions were implemented.

EC orders transfer of officers in 5 states ahead of elections

Himanshi Dahiya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Tuesday directed the governments of Goa, Manipur, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand to transfer certain categories of officers connected to election work, marking a procedural step that usually paves the way for assembly elections.

All five states are scheduled to go to the polls in early 2027.

In a letter to the chief secretaries and chief electoral officers of the five states, ECI said officers posted in their home districts, those who have completed three years in a district in the last four years, or will do so by May 31, 2027, in the case of Uttar Pradesh, must be transferred.

The cut-off date for completing three years is March 31, 2027, for Goa, Manipur, Punjab and Uttarakhand, and May 31, 2027, for Uttar Pradesh.

"While calculating the period of three years, promotion to a post within the district is to be counted. However, the services rendered (during the last four years) in the 'state headquarters', even if located in the same revenue district, may not be accounted for in calculation of three years period in the present district," the poll panel said.

THE EXERCISE BECAME CONTENTIOUS IN BENGAL WHEN EC REPLACED OFFICIALS AFTER ANNOUNCING STATE ELECTIONS

Five years ago, this order was issued on October 13, 2021 and the assembly elections eventually announced on January 8 2022 and conducted between February 10 and March 27.

District officers such as District Election Officers (DEOs), Returning Officers (ROs), Additional District Magistrates (ADMs), Sub-Divisional Magistrates (SDMs), Tehsildars and Block Development Officers (BDOs); Divisional and Municipal Commissioners were covered under the order.

Police officers from Sub-Inspector up to Range Additional Directors General (ADGs) and Inspectors General (IGs), and excise and transport department officers of Sub-Inspector rank and above were also covered.

Posts earmarked for cadre officers must be held only by them, and the letter said there could be no exception.

The term of the 403-member Uttar Pradesh assembly ends on May 22, 2027. The terms of the 60-member Manipur, 40-member Goa, 117-member Punjab and 70-member Uttarakhand assemblies on March 13, March 14, March 16, and March 28 2027 respectively.

Staff engaged in the ongoing special summary revision of electoral rolls — which is underway in the five states between November 12 and January 4 — will be transferred only after the final publication of the rolls, in consultation with the CEO. Chief secretaries and DGPs must submit compliance reports by November 30.

Although routine, this exercise became contentious in West Bengal earlier this year when the commission replaced the chief secretary and DGP soon after announcing poll dates.

UP CEO apologises over social media post that triggered uproar

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh chief electoral officer (CEO) Navdeep Rinwa on Tuesday apologised for a sharp reply posted by his office's social media handle to an Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) lawmaker, who pointed out a bizarre name in a voter list. The CEO said that the tone and tenor of the communication were not in line with what is expected of the official handle.

A person familiar with the matter said the CEO was in-charge of the handle, and no internal changes have been made at his office.

In a post on X, Rinwa said the genuine outrage generated by the comments in the post has been duly noted. "We sincerely apologise to those who are surprised and upset by this. From now on, our communication will be polite and formal," he said.

On Monday, AAP's Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh drew the UP CEO's attention to an issue raised by party leader Rajesh Yadav concerning the bizarre name "Ram ne Yadav ko maara" (Ram killed Yadav) in the voter list for the legislative council election for the Allahabad-Jhansi graduates' constituency.

Navdeep Rinwa

"Why did Ram ultimately killed a 'Yadav' specifically? Why didn't Ram kill a Singh, Pathak, Asthana, Sharma, Rai, or Bisht? Is your computer deeply casteist? Are you pushing some party's agenda? @rajeshyadavaap's question was valid," Singh said in a post on X.

In response, Rinwa said that the voter list for the recent Legislative Council elections contained another similarly bizarre name: "Ram ne Sharma ko mara" (Ram killed Sharma).

"Computers/software are not casteist. ...we made a mistake, but fortunately, even during the mistake, there was no discrimination based on caste. We must also thank God that Ram did not kill any minority. Otherwise, in addition to being casteist, there would also be an accusation of being communal," he said.

Congress working committee (CWC) member and party's national spokesperson Supriya Shrinate asked who was running the Uttar Pradesh CEO's social media account.

"Anyway, you folks have no special credibility left to save. The little bit of confusion that exists - this handle is clearing it up all by itself!" she said.

{ 12TH BRICS PARLIAMENTARY FORUM CONCLUDES }

Solutions to global issues only forged through dialogue: Birla

Pragati Chawla
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum concluded in New Delhi on Tuesday with the adoption of a joint declaration backing reform of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC), calling for zero tolerance for terrorism and greater representation of the Global South in decision-making on the world stage. Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla also handed over the forum's chairship to China for the next Brics summit in 2027.

"Permanent solutions to global challenges can only be forged through dialogue, not war; in peace, not conflict; and in collaboration, rather than competition," Birla said in his address. He further called for a global framework based on respect for national sovereignty, peaceful resolution of disputes and equitable development opportunities.

The forum, held on October 26 and 27, brought together presiding officers and parliamentary representatives from Brics member countries and partner nations, with a focus on strengthening parliamentary institutions, the use of artificial intelligence and digital technologies and sustainability.

The joint declaration reaffirmed the principles of the United Nations Charter and called for comprehensive UN reform, including the Security Council, to make the international system "more just, equitable, democratic, representative, effective, and efficient". "We look forward to strengthening Brics interaction within international parliamentary fora, including the Inter-Parliamentary Union, to amplify the voice of the Global South," the declaration said.

Om Birla

On counter-terrorism, the declaration strongly condemned the Pahalgam attack that took place on April 22, 2025 in Jammu & Kashmir, and took 26 civilian lives. It further called for action against cross-border movement of terrorists, terror financing and safe havens.

The declaration also highlighted cooperation on emerging technologies including AI and proposed a digital public infrastructure repository for Brics countries. "We emphasise the need to strengthen the digital sovereignty of Brics member countries by protecting data privacy and security of personal information as well as by building resilient national technological ecosystems," it added.

On climate change, member countries called for stronger mitigation and adaptation efforts. the declaration advocated for stronger efforts to implement the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and its Sustainable Development Goals, while emphasising the "principle of common but differentiated responsibilities" in addressing climate change.

Member nations also expressed concern over escalating tensions in the Middle East and West Asia, urging restraint, protection of civilians and dialogue towards lasting peace. "We reaffirm our unwavering support for the peaceful resolution of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict based on the two-state solution, with the two States living side by side, in peace and security..." the declaration further said.

Emphasising the role of legislatures, Birla said parliaments must evolve beyond law-making to become more transparent, effective and citizen-centric institutions. "Global peace truly means security, respect, justice, and the assurance of a better future for everyone," the Lok Sabha Speaker said.

IPS OFFICER SANJEEV GANDHI TRANSFERRED FOR 7TH TIME THIS YR

Shailee Dogra
letters@hindustantimes.com

SHIMLA: Deputy inspector general (DIG) Sanjeev Kumar Gandhi was appointed as the managing director of the Himachal Pradesh General Industries Corporation Ltd. on Tuesday, his seventh posting this year.

Gandhi, a 2012 batch officer promoted to the Indian Police Service (IPS) from the state police service, succeeds Bhupender Kumar, HPAS (2009), who has been relieved of the charge. The transfer order was issued by chief secretary Kamlesh Kumar Pant on the recommendations of the Civil Services Board. Gandhi moves to HPGIC from his previous assignment as MD of the Himachal Backward Classes Finance and Development Corporation in Kangra.

Once considered close to chief minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu, Gandhi faces two FIRs over alleged financial misappropriation during his tenure as superintendent of police (SP), Shimla, between 2023 and February 7, 2026. The officer has denied the charges.

ED unearths 'drugs-for-goods' method to pay drug suppliers from Myanmar

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has unearthed a new method used by drug syndicates to pay suppliers in Myanmar by buying fuel, food, medicines, footwear and clothing in India and sending them across the border, officials said on Tuesday. The findings emerged during the probe into the October 23 crackdown under Operation Trident, in which multiple agencies raided 38 locations across Assam, Mizoram and Manipur.

U'khand govt tables bill to penalise minority institutions

GAIRSAIN: Uttarakhand government on Tuesday tabled the Uttarakhand Minority Education Act (Amendment) Bill, 2026, in the state legislative assembly, incorporating penal provisions including property lockouts, fines up to ₹5 lakh, and registration of first information reports (FIRs) against minority institutions found imparting religious education in violation of the norms. The bill seeks to replace the Uttarakhand Minority Education (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026), promulgated earlier this year to amend the principal Act of 2025.

Union panel rejects proposal to relocate Uttarakhand HC

HALDWANI: The Regional Empowered Committee (REC) of the Union ministry of environment, forest and climate change has rejected a proposal to relocate the Uttarakhand High Court from Nainital to Belbaba in Haldwani, citing the failure to adequately explore alternative non-forest land for the project. The proposed move involved diverting 30 hectares of reserved forest land in the Lamachaur area under the Tarai Central Forest Division and felling 123 trees. The panel stressed that the project was not site-specific.

SC pushes for national framework on compulsory rural service by doctors

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday regretted the "policy deficit" in evolving a national consensus on compulsory rural service by medical students, indicating that it may lay down constitutional principles to guide states in framing regulations to ensure doctors serve the country's underserved rural population.

A bench of justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe said that the issue went beyond the validity of a Karnataka government notification requiring medical graduates to undertake one year of compulsory public service, stressing that the policy would have a bearing on the future of healthcare delivery in India.

The court asked the Centre to clarify whether it intended to formulate a national policy and whom it proposed to consult before taking a decision.

THE SUPREME COURT ASKED THE CENTRE TO CLARIFY WHETHER IT INTENDED TO FORMULATE A NATIONAL POLICY

The bench said it could lay down guiding principles based on the constitutional obligation to protect the right to health, leaving it to states to work out the appropriate regulatory framework in consultation with the relevant medical authorities.

"What is suggested is not a mandate. As a matter of principle, are the policy makers and constitutional requirements in sync with principle that rural service across India for our doctors is a necessary measure or not for betterment of our health and national health? That is the short issue," observed the bench.

The court said that the government needed to reflect on the issue at the policy-making level.

"In times to come, where access to hospitals will virtually be access to hospitals run by private institutions, moving away from catering to the needs of the rural areas is something to be assessed as a matter of constitutional principle," said the bench.

The observations came after additional solicitor general Aishwarya Bhati told the bench that while postgraduate medical students were subject to compulsory service requirements on a rotational basis, there was no corresponding national requirement at the undergraduate level.

Senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, assisting the court as amicus curiae, suggested that the court lay down appropriate guidelines to address the legislative gaps. At this, the bench said: "We will formulate the constitutional requirement of it just as a guiding principle. The formulations will be by the state in consultation with the National Medical Commission."

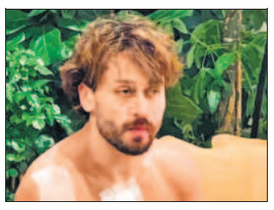
The court posted the matter for hearing next week.

The case arises from a challenge to the Karnataka Compulsory Service Training by Candidates Completed Medical Courses Act, 2012, and the rules framed under it in 2015.

SSB CHIEF SET TO HOLD ADDITIONAL CHARGE OF ITBP

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Tuesday assigned SSB director general Sanjay Singhal the additional charge of ITBP DG upon his superannuation, according to an official order.

The order issued by a home ministry official said, "The undersigned is directed to refer to the subject mentioned above and convey the approval of competent authority for assignment of additional charge of the post of Director General, Indo-Tibetan Border Police(ITBP) to Shri Sanjay Singhal, IPS(UP:1993), Director General, Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB) upon superannuation of Shri Shatrujeet Singh Kapoor, IPS(HY:1990) on 31.10.2026 and till the appointment of a regular incumbent or until further orders, whichever is earlier." The current ITBP chief, Shatrujeet Kapur is superannuating on October 31. HTC



Tiger Shroff

MUMBAI POLICE INVOKE MCOCA IN TIGER SHROFF SHOOTING CASE

Vinay Dalvi
vinay.dalvi@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Mumbai police crime branch has invoked the stringent Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) in the case related to the firing on actor Tiger Shroff. Section 3 of the Act, pertaining to organised crime, was added after obtaining approval from the competent authority, said Rajtilak Roushan, deputy commissioner of police, Mumbai crime branch.

The original FIR was registered on October 19, a day after the incident, under sections 109(1) (attempt to murder) and 3(5) (common intention) of BNS, along with relevant sections of the Arms Act.

Shroff was shot at in Juhu on October 18 by two assailants, who fled from the spot with a getaway biker waiting there. The trio – Phool Singh, Rehan Ansari and Hrithik Mahato – was arrested on October 19 from aboard a Jaipur-bound train at Kota railway station. The following day, the Delhi police special cell arrested four alleged weapons suppliers – Radha Verma, Babita Rao, Kunal Jaminsingh, and Sumit Saroliya. Three more accused – Sarpanch Khatak alias Ankit, Sameer Khatri, and Jatin Panchal – were arrested from Sonipat, for allegedly providing logistical help and financing. Subsequently, Pranjal Thakral was arrested from Indore, taking the total number of arrests in the case to 11. "Our investigations are still ongoing and further arrests are likely," said a police officer.

Anil Pandit, an alleged operative of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang who claimed responsibility for the attack, is the prime accused in the case. He is absconding and believed to be hiding in foreign country. The attack was executed for establishing financial and territorial dominance, police said.

Notice asking Imran Khan to leave India put on hold by HC

Karuna Nidhi
karuna.nidhi@hindustantimes.com

Imran Khan

MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court on Tuesday placed the "Leave India Notice" issued to actor Imran Khan on hold until November 2, after the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) sought more time and assured the court that the US citizen would not be asked to exit the country by the original October 28 deadline.

FRRO requested an adjournment because solicitor general Tushar Mehta, who was supposed to argue the matter, was unavailable to appear in court on Tuesday.

A division bench of chief justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and justice Advait Sethna then posted the matter for hearing on November 2 after additional solicitor general Anil Singh assured the court that no coercive action would be taken against Khan for the time being. "We are giving assurance as we are only seeking time," he said.

The court was hearing a petition filed by Khan, an Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholder, challenging FRRO's Leave India Notice issued to him on October 14.

The notice followed his presence at a youth-led protest near August Kranti Maidan in Mumbai on October 10, demanding the resignation of chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral roll irregularities. The notice invoked sections of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, which empower authorities to restrict the movement or presence of foreign nationals in India.

Khan has, however, denied violating the rules, saying no agitation was underway when he reached the spot and that he did not cross the police barricades to enter the protest site. He said he was apprehended after media personnel surrounded him while he was returning to his vehicle. He also contended that the notice did not specify the provision he had allegedly breached.

The actor has argued that OCI cardholders belong to a distinct statutory category and that the action against him was disproportionate, considering he has lived in India for more than four decades.

2 killed in Bengal police encounters

HT Correspondents
letters@hindustantimes.com

KOLKATA/BERHAMPORE: Two people, accused in separate cases, have been killed during police encounters in a single day in West Bengal, with the police alleging that both tried to snatch firearms from officers and tried to flee after firing at them during crime reconstruction.

ONE OF THE DECEASED WAS BOOKED FOR RAPE AND MURDER OF A MINOR, WHILE THE OTHER WAS CHARGED WITH THE MURDER OF A BJP WORKER

While one accused Prahlad Das (23), was arrested on Sunday for the alleged rape and murder of a minor in North 24 Parganas district, the other Samiul Sheikh (40), was arrested in connection with the murder of a BJP worker in Murshidabad.

Das's arrest came on Sunday hours after the body of a 17-year-old girl—who went missing on Saturday—was recovered. Police took him to the crime scene in Gaighata at around 2.50 am on Tuesday, officers said, adding that Das attacked the police when they were returning. "Das had confessed to the crime and was taken to the spot for reconstructing the crime. While the team was returning, he snatched the service revolver of a sub-inspector and fired three rounds at the police. Two policemen were injured. Police fired four rounds in self-defence, and Das was injured. He died at a hospital," said a police officer on condition of anonymity.

The deceased girl's parents lauded the police personnel for their action. "We are happy with the police action, but we will never get our daughter back," the teenager's mother said.

Reacting to the Gaighata incident, senior BJP leader and state rural development minister Dilip Ghosh said, "Nobody is above the law. If someone takes the law into his own hands, this would be the consequence."

In the second case, a BJP worker Sujit Mondal had gone missing on August 28. Three people, including Sheikh, were arrested. On September 3, the trio led the police to a spot on the canal's bank from where a limb was recovered. DNA analysis revealed that it belonged to Mondal's body.

Police said that on Tuesday, when Sheikh was taken to a spot near Dhuliyan market, he snatched a firearm from one of the policemen and tried to flee. The cops shot him. He was rushed to the hospital where he was declared dead by doctors.

Reacting to the killings, Anirban Banerjee, spokesperson of the Mamata-AITC, told the media, "If they (BJP) think that encounter is the solution let them introduce a bill in the assembly and pass it."

Meanwhile, state BJP chief Samik Bhattacharya said, "The situation that forced the police to fire at the accused in both cases cannot be termed as encounters," Bhattacharya said.

In 2025, Suvendu Adhikari, during his stint as the Leader of the Opposition in the legislative assembly, said, "If the BJP comes to power, these rapists won't be sent to the courts. They will be deposited (arrested) in the morning and spent (encountered) in the afternoon. We will follow the path shown by Yogi Adityanath (Uttar Pradesh CM) and Himanta Biswa Sarma (CM of Assam)," he had said.

Mob kills 70-year-old woman, daughter over witchcraft suspicions

Debashish Sarkar
letters@hindustantimes.com

JAMSHEDPUR: A 70-year-old woman and her 24-year-old daughter were killed within a fortnight by a group of people who accused them of "witchcraft", and their bodies were dumped in a forest after being set on fire in West Singhbhum district in Jharkhand, police said on Tuesday.

According to police, they have detained some suspects, including the elderly woman's stepson Tribhuvan Birua. Police are also investigating whether the 24-year-old woman was gang-raped before being killed.

"We are verifying the details of the case after getting information. Some suspects, including the main accused Tribhuvan Birua, have been detained and are being interrogated. Preliminary investigation has found that the Tribhuvan had a land dispute with the 70-year-old woman. The accused and his associates alleged that both women were practising witchcraft. All the angles are being investigated, including the he possibility of the stepsister being gang-raped before getting killed," Dilip Sai Majhi, Manjhari PS officer-in-charge, said, adding that a search is underway for both the bodies or their remains which is crucial for forensic evidence.

According to initial information, the 70-year-old was working in their farmland near Torlo Dam when she entered into a fight with Tribhuvan over a trivial issue. "Tribhuvan and his associates killed her when she was returning from the farmland, burnt her dead body and dumped it in the nearby jungles," a villager said.

According to police, a local villager, Buli Birua, was injured during a clash with the assailants. He is being treated at Mahatma Gandhi Memorial Medical College Hospital.

CBI QUESTIONS JOURNO IN PAURI RECEPTIONIST CASE

Neeraj Chauhan
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Tuesday questioned Ashutosh Negi, an Uttarakhand-based journalist and petitioner in Ankita Bhandari murder case, people aware of the matter said.

Negi, editor of Jago Uttarakhand , who was asked to appear before CBI in Delhi on Tuesday, termed the summons as "harassment". "Instead of questioning the VIPs involved, CBI is questioning the people who want justice in Ankita Bhandari's murder," he told HT, while adding that he had arrived in Delhi and will reach CBI headquarters on Tuesday morning.

CBI, in its summon to Negi, said that "there are reasonable grounds to question you to ascertain facts and circumstances from you".

Negi had been demanding a CBI probe into the case since 2022. He was also arrested in 2024 for his reporting on the murder investigation. He was granted bail later.

GIRL'S KIN PARADED BY KOLKATA POLICE DAY AFTER YOUTH, FATHER STRIPPED

KOLKATA: The Kolkata Police on Tuesday paraded three men who allegedly held an 18-year-old man, his father and his friend at gunpoint and forced them to walk naked on Sunday in the Sarsuna area of south-east Kolkata, opposition leaders in West Bengal claimed, terming it an "uncivilised practice".

Mamata All India Trinamool Congress MLA Kunal Ghosh alleged that the police paraded the accused with their upper bodies bare. "Parading these men on a public road with bare upper bodies is an uncivilised practice. It is not sanctioned by law," Ghosh said.

Communist Party of India (Marxist) state secretary Md Salim, too, criticised the police. "The state and Kolkata police were always known for crime detection, not for feudal practices," Salim said.

A police officer described it as a precautionary measure. "It was a crowded place and they could have made an attempt to escape from custody. It is extremely difficult for anyone without a shirt to avoid being spotted from a distance," he said. HTC

Jan Suraaj functionary found dead in Ranchi

Raj Kumar
letters@hindustantimes.com

RANCHI: The body of 21-year-old Devpalik Gupta, digital communication manager of Jan Suraaj Party, who had gone missing during a train journey to Patna, was recovered in forest in Ranchi district on Tuesday, a senior police officer said.

Ranchi senior superintendent of police Rakesh Ranjan said an investigation has been launched. "Probe has been started to ascertain the reason behind his death," Ranjan said when asked whether the incident is a murder, suicide or accident.

Gupta, a native of Kushinagar district in Uttar Pradesh, was an alumnus of the Indian Institute of Mass Communication, Delhi.

Gautam Kumar, a friend and colleague of Gupta, told PTI that they boarded the Ranchi-Patna Janshatabdi Express at the Ranchi railway station on Monday afternoon and the train departed around 2:25 pm.

Ten minutes later, while the train was passing between Ranchi and Muri Junction, Devpalik told him that he was going to the pantry to fetch some food.

DEVPALIK GUPTA'S BODY WAS RECOVERED FROM A FOREST IN RANCHI DISTRICT

When the train stopped at Muri Junction, Gupta and others travelling with Devpalik lodged a complaint with the Government Railway Police. "When he could not be contacted and did not reach his destination, his family and party leaders began a search. On Tuesday, his body was found in bushes in the forest area near Barwadag under Angara police station, close to Muri," a police officer said.

On receiving information, Angara police reached the spot, took the body into custody and sent it to RIMS, Ranchi for post-mortem examination.

"Gupta's demise is heart-wrenching and an irreparable loss for us. This is an extremely painful moment for the Jan Suraaj family. We are all aggrieved," Jan Suraaj Party said in a statement.

(With PTI inputs)

4 KERALAM COPS SUSPENDED FOR LAPSES IN MERC CRASH PROBE

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: Four Keralam police officers were suspended on Tuesday for alleged lapses in the investigation into the Mercedes-Benz car crash in Kochi, home minister Ramesh Chennithala announced in the state assembly.

The home minister had admitted in the assembly that police lapses in the case had led to the accused being granted bail by the magistrate.

All four officers were attached to the Cheranalloor police station, where the FIR was registered in connection with the October 25 accident. The suspended officers were identified as CI Shyam Kumar KS, SHO Vishwajith VS, Grade SI Manoj KT and ACPO Arun Joshi.

The alleged lapses included failing to apply stringent provisions against the minor accused on the day of the incident and forcing a member of the victim's family to delete from his phone a photograph of the minor accused, said an officer, on the condition of anonymity.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Government of Madhya Pradesh
PARYAVARAN VANIKI VANMANDAL BHOPAL

Online percentage rate bids for the following works are invited from registered contractors and firms of repute fulfilling registration criteria:

S. No. /Pkg/ Code	Name of Work	District	Probable Amount of Contract (Rs. in lakh)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (In Rupees)	Cost of Bid Document (In Rupees)	Period of Completion (in Months)
1	Development of Boundary wall at, Shahpura Pahadi -Bhag 1 and Bhag 2, Bhopal M.P	Bhopal	Rs. 675.38 Lakh	Rs. 20,26,140/-	Rs. 6000/-	12 (Twelve) Months Including Rainy Season.

1. All details relating to the Bid Document(s) can be viewed and downloaded free of cost on the website.
2. Bid Document can be purchased after making online payment of portal fees through Credit/Debit/Cash Card/ Internet Banking.
3. At the time of submission of the Bid the eligible bidder shall be required to:
   i) pay the cost of Bid Document;
   ii) deposit the Earnest Money;
   iii) Submit a check list; and
   iv) Submit an Affidavit.
   Details can be seen in the Bid Data Sheet
4. **ELIGIBILITY FOR BIDDERS:**
   (a) At the time of submission of the Bid the bidder should have valid registration with the Government of Madhya Pradesh, Public Works Department. However, such bidders who are not registered with the Government of Madhya Pradesh and are eligible for registration can also submit their bids after having applied for registration with appropriate authority.
   (b) The bidder would be required to have valid registration at the time of signing of the Contract.
   (c) Failure to sign the contract by the selected bidder, for whatsoever reason, shall result in forfeiture of the Earnest Money Deposit.
5. **Pre-qualification:** Prequalification conditions, wherever applicable, are given in the Bid Data Sheet.
6. **Special Eligibility:** Special Eligibility Conditions, if any, are given in the Bid Data Sheet.
7. The Bid Document can be purchased only online from D**ated 27.10.2026 Time 06.00 pm to Dated 17.11.2026 upto Time 06.00 pm**
8. Amendments to would be published any, NIT, if on website **https://www.mptenders.gov.in/** only, and not in newspaper.

DFO
Paryavaran Vaniki
Vanmandal, Bhopal M.P

G-20581/26

REC POWER DEVELOPMENT AND CONSULTANCY LIMITED
(A wholly owned subsidiary of REC Ltd.)

GLOBAL INVITATION (Through e-bidding Only)
FOR SELECTION OF TRANSMISSION SERVICE PROVIDER THROUGH TARIFF BASED COMPETITIVE BIDDING (TBCB) PROCESS ON BUILD, OWN, OPERATE AND TRANSFER (BOOT) BASIS FOR 01 (ONE) INTRA – STATE TRANSMISSION PROJECT

REC Power Development and Consultancy Limited, New Delhi, India (a wholly owned subsidiary of REC Limited, a Maharatna Central Public Sector Undertaking) invites proposal for setting up of the below mentioned transmission project through TBCB process on Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) basis following single stage two envelope process of "Request for Proposal (RFP)". Interested bidders may refer to the Request for Proposal (RFP) notifications and RFP documents available on our websites **www.recpdcl.in** & **www.recindia.nic.in** w.e.f. 28.10.2026.
The bidders may obtain the RFP documents on all working days between 1030 hours (IST) to 1600 hours (IST) from 28.10.2026 to one day prior to bid submission date on payment of non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/-(Rupees Five Lakh Only) or US$ 7000 (US Dollars Seven Thousand Only) + 18% GST as per details provided in the RFP document available on the websites **www.recpdcl.in** & **www.recindia.nic.in**. The Request for Proposal (RFP) documents can also be downloaded from our websites **www.recpdcl.in** & **www.recindia.nic.in**, however, in such cases interested parties can submit Response to RFP only on submission of non-refundable fee of Rs. 5,00,000/-(Rupees Five Lakh Only) or US$ 7000 (US Dollars Seven Thousand Only) + 18% GST as per details provided in the RFP document. The survey report & clarifications to RFP documents shall be issued to those bidders, who have obtained/purchased RFP documents by paying requisite fee. The important timelines in this regard are as follows:

Sr. No.	Name of Project	Last Date for seeking clarifications	Last Date for submission of Response to RFP	Details of Opening of Response to RFP
1.	Evacuation of Power from 3x800MW Thermal Power Plant, Nabinagar (Stage-II), Aurangabad	17.11.2026	30.12.2026 up to 1500 Hrs (IST)	30.12.2026 at 1530 Hrs (IST)

All corrigenda, addenda, amendments, time extensions, etc. to the RFP will be hosted on our websites **www.recpdcl.in** & **www.recindia.nic.in**. Bidders should regularly visit our websites to keep themselves updated.
Note: RECPDCL reserves the right to cancel or modify the process without assigning any reason and without any liability. This is not an offer.

Chief Executive Officer
REC Power Development and Consultancy Ltd.
Core-4, SCOPE Complex, 7, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003, India

Bid Process Coordinator: REC Power Development and Consultancy Limited
An Initiative of: Government of Bihar
Initiative Partner: Bihar State Power Transmission Company Limited

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Home Department, Govt. of NCT of Delhi
First Floor, Tis Hazari Courts Complex, Delhi-110054
Tel: 011-23986945, 011-23914282

RECRUITMENT NOTICE

Directorate of Prosecution, GNCT of Delhi requires 32 eligible Additional Public Prosecutors on deputation basis for a period of 03 (three) Years extendable by 02 (two) more years after review, in accordance with the Recruitment Rules notified on 02.04.2026, for the post of Additional Public Prosecutor at remuneration equal to the minimum of Level 11 (Rs. 67,700-2,08,700) of Pay Matrix as per 7th CPC.

FOR DETAILS PLEASE VISIT ON WEBSITE AT: https://prosecution.delhi.gov.in/ or https://delhi.gov.in/

(DIRECTOR)
DIRECTOR OF PROSECUTION, GNCTD

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0265/26-27

कार्यालय, निदेशक, होम्योपैथी, उ0प्र0/सदस्य सचिव, यू0पी0 आयुष यू0जी0 काउंसिलिंग बोर्ड–2026, इन्दिरा भवन, आठवाँ तल, अशोक मार्ग, लखनऊ

संख्या–नि0हो0/224/26/4648 लखनऊ : दिनांक 27 अक्टूबर, 2026

–: विज्ञप्ति :–

यू0पी0 आयुष यू0जी0 काउंसिलिंग–2026 के द्वितीय चक्र की काउंसिलिंग की समय–सारणी।

शैक्षणिक सत्र 2026–27 हेतु उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य के राजकीय/निजी क्षेत्र के आयुर्वेदिक, यूनानी एवं होम्योपैथिक मेडिकल कालेजों/निजी क्षेत्र के विश्वविद्यालयों/अल्पसंख्यक संस्थानों के यू0जी0 पाठ्यक्रमों (बी0ए0एम0एस0, बी0यू0एम0एस0 एवं बी0एच0एम0एस0) में प्रवेश हेतु द्वितीय चक्र की काउंसिलिंग की समय–सारणी निम्नवत् है:–

द्वितीय काउन्सिलिंग चक्र

क0स0	विवरण	दिनॉक/समय	कुल दिवस
1	ऑनलाईन पंजीकरण एवं अभिलेख अपलोड करने की तिथि	दिनॉक 29/10/2026 को मध्याह्न 12:00 बजे से दिनॉक 31/10/2026 को अपराह्न 01:00 बजे तक	03
2	धरोहर धनराशि जमा करने की तिथि	दिनॉक 29/10/2026 को मध्याह्न 12:00 बजे से दिनॉक 31/10/2026 को अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक	03
3	ऑनलाईन अभिलेखों का सत्यापन	दिनॉक 29/10/2026 से दिनांक 31/10/2026 को अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक	03
4	पंजीकृत अभ्यर्थियों की मेरिट सूची (State Merit List) का प्रकाशन	दिनॉक 31/10/2026 को सायं 06:00 बजे तक	-
5	ऑनलाईन च्वाईस फिलिंग (वरीयता विकल्प) भरने एवं सीट लॉक करने की तिथि	दिनॉक 31/10/2026 को मेरिट सूची के प्रकाशन के उपरान्त से दिनॉक 02/11/2026 को मध्याह्न 12:00 बजे तक	03
6	अनंतिम सीट आवंटन सूची/सूचियों का प्रकाशन	दिनॉक 02/11/2026 को सायं 05:00 बजे तक	-
7	नोडल सेन्टर पर अभ्यर्थियों के मूल अभिलेखों का सत्यापन	दिनॉक 04/11/2026 से दिनॉक 06/11/2026 तक (प्रातः 09:00 बजे से सायं 05:00 बजे तक)	03
8	आवंटन पत्र डाउनलोड करने एवं आवंटित संस्था में प्रवेश की अन्तिम तिथि	दिनॉक 04/11/2026 से दिनॉक 10/11/2026 को सायं 05:00 बजे तक (अवकाश दिनांक 08.11.2026 व दिनांक 09.11.2026 को छोड़कर)	05

नोट–
- प्रथम चक्र में प्रवेशित अभ्यर्थी, पुनरावंटन के लिये पुनः च्वाईस फिलिंग कर सकते है।
- अभिलेखों के भौतिक सत्यापन, के लिये नोडल सेन्टर–राजकीय नेशनल होम्योपैथिक मेडिकल कालेज, हैनीमेन चौराहा, विराज खण्ड–1, गोमती नगर, लखनऊ निर्धारित है। अद्यतन एवं विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये काउंसिलिंग की अधिकृत वेबसाइट–www.upayushcounseling.upsdc.gov.in पर उपलब्ध यू0पी0 आयुष यू0जी0 काउंसिलिंग–2026 का शासनादेश, विवरण–पुस्तिका (ब्रोशर) तथा महत्वपूर्ण निर्देशों का अवलोकन करें।

(प्रो0 प्रमोद कुमार सिंह)
निदेशक, होम्योपैथी
उ0प्र0/सदस्य सचिव।

UP-259637, Dt. 27.10.2026
Website : www.upgov.nic.in

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, KAITHAL	BEAUTIFICATION/RENOVATION OF MINI. SECRETARIAT BUILDING AT KAITHAL IN DISTRICT KAITHAL	CLOSING DATE 04.11.2026	931.17 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896320998 pwd-eepd-kaithal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, KARNAL	STRENGTHENING WITH 50MM DBM PLUS 30MM BC ON RAIPUR TO LADWA ROAD (ROAD ID 7391) LENGTH 11.330 KM IN NILOKHERI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27). + 1 WORKS	24.10.2026 13.11.2026	1252.81 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, JIND	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 3 NO. ROADS IN SAFIDON CONSTITUENCY IN JIND DISTT. (HON`BLE C.M. ANNOUNCEMENT CODE NO. 29887, 29888 AND 29891). 1. RETOLI TO AALANJOGI KHERA ROAD (ROAD ID 12500) 2. RODH TO LINK ROAD OF DERA BALBIR SINGH TO ASSANDH ROAD (ROAD ID 12502) 3. SARFABAD TO RANA KHERI ROAD (ROAD ID 12504)	CLOSING DATE 31.10.2026	170.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8398098075 pwdeepdjind@gmail.com
4	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR/STG. OF 02 NO. ROADS UNDER FATEHABAD CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP-3) 1. PROVIDING BM PLUS PC ON FATEHABAD TO MAJRA ROAD KM. 0.65 TO 5.55 (ROAD ID 5587) 2. STRENGTHENING ON BISLA MAJRA ROAD TO DHANGER KM. 0.00 TO 4.17 (ROAD ID 9045)	23.10.2026 02.11.2026	470.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM TOHANA DHARSUL RATIA TO STATE BORDER ROAD (RATIA TO STATE BORDER) (MDR-101) KM 34.15 TO 57.98 (ID NO. 5468) IN FATEHABAD DISTT. UNDER NABARD SCHEME (WITHOUT GST)	23.10.2026 16.11.2026	1858.62 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, SIRSA	RANIA TOWN:- REPLACEMENT/UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT`S AND ELECTRIC ITEMS I.E. AIR BLOWER, FLOW METER, ONLINE ANALYZER, PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION OF SCADA AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENTS THERETO AT 6 MLD STP RANIA TOWN, DISTT. SIRSA	22.10.2026 29.10.2026	55.52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666221925 ee2sirsa@gmail.com
7	HORTICULTURE C.S.T.F. LADWA, KURUKSHETRA	TO PROVIDE MANPOWER FOR ROUTINE DAILY TASKS IN FRUIT PLANT NURSERY AND ORCHARDS	21.10.2026 12.11.2026	1 LACS	hortharyana.gov.in	7988103898 cstfladwa@gmail.com
8	CIVIL HOSPITAL, PANCHKULA	OUTSOURCING OF PEST AND RODENT SERVICES	27.10.2026 14.11.2026	EMD 50000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2562199 establishmentpmo1@gmail.com
9	CIVIL HOSPITAL, PANCHKULA	PARKING SERVICES	27.10.2026 14.11.2026	EMD 50000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2562199 establishmentpmo1@gmail.com
10	DIRECTOR GENERAL, HORTICULTURE, DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANCHKULA	CONSTRUCTION OF HYDROPONIC DEMONSTRATION UNIT AT VARIOUS CENTRES GGNS OF HORTICULTURE DEPARTMENT HARYANA	28.10.2026 27.11.2026	EMD 2 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9465081197 HDOPN12@GMAIL.COM
11	HORTICULTURE, IHDC, HODAL(PALWAL)	REGARDING PUBLIC NOTICE FOR E-TENDER (GOODS & SERVICES) "RATE CONTRACT FOR MENIAL WORKS FOR VEGETABLES SEEDLING PRODUCTION AND OTHER CENTRE WORKS ON JOB ROLE BASIS" AT IHDC, HODAL (PALWAL) FOR THE YEAR 2026-27.	29.10.2026 09.11.2026	20,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7015157607 ddhihdchodal@gmail.com
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	CONSTRUCTION OF BALANCE WORK OF ESCAPE REGULATOR-CUM-DRAINAGE CROSSING AT KM 21.200 OF AUGMENTATION CANAL. + 2 WORKS	24.10.2026 06.11.2026	1851.32 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
13	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	BALANCE WORK OF REMODELING OF AUGMENTATION CANAL FROM REACH RD KM 58.665 TO 70.000. + 2 WORKS	24.10.2026 06.11.2026	1034.92 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2255291 knldivn335@gmail.com

RO NO 11/2027/260/50544/I/19/7

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.etenders.hry.nic.in

India set to corner Pak on Azhar issue at FATF meet

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India is set to corner Pakistan at the plenary meeting of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) beginning on October 28 over Islamabad's failure to crack down on the activities of UN-designated terrorist and Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) chief Masood Azhar, people familiar with the matter said.

The Indian side's case hinges on the Taliban regime's recent denial of Pakistan's claim that Azhar is currently in Afghanistan, the people said on condition of anonymity.

While Pakistan has taken some steps to curb the activities of other UN-designated terrorists, including Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) chief Hafiz Saeed, there is no evidence of similar action against Azhar, they added.

Over the past week, the Indian side has quietly sounded out diplomats from partner countries and key members of the FATF to gain support for its move that is expected to figure at the FATF plenary meeting to be held in Paris during October 28-30, the people said.

Masood Azhar

This will be the first FATF plenary meeting under the presidency of Giles Thomson of the United Kingdom, and delegates from across the financial watchdog's global network of more than 200 jurisdictions and observer organisations will gather in Paris to discuss evolving threats to global financial integrity and security. The FATF is set to review Pakistan's anti-terror efforts at the plenary meeting.

The Indian side has focused on Azhar, wanted by New Delhi for several terror attacks such as the 2001 Parliament strike, the 2016 Pathankot airbase assault and the 2019 Pulwama bombing, after the Taliban regime dismissed the contention of Pakistani officials that the JeM founder has been in Afghanistan since 2019.

In September, Taliban spokesperson Zia Ahmad Thakal denied that Azhar was in Afghanistan, or that Pakistan has sent any formal communication regarding the JeM chief's presence in Afghanistan. He also reiterated the Taliban's policy of not allowing Afghan territory to be used against any country.

India too urged Pakistan last month to act against sanctioned terrorists based on its soil instead of resorting to "gimmicks" such as a "phoney announcement" of a bounty for Azhar. Pakistan has maintained a bounty of Pakistani Rs 7 million on Azhar for several years.

Azhar was freed by India with two other terrorists in exchange for the passengers on flight IC 814, which was hijacked from Kathmandu to Kandahar in December 1999. He is listed among the most-wanted terrorists in the "Red Book" of Pakistan's Federal Investigation Agency's (FIA). Azhar was also designated as a global terrorist by the UN Security Council in May 2019 after China removed a block to his listing.

Several of Azhar's relatives were killed during an Indian strike on the JeM's main base at Bahawalpur in May 2025 in retaliation for the Pahalgam terror attack.

Pakistan was placed on the FATF's "grey list" of countries subject to enhanced monitoring during 2018-2022 for its failure to counter terror financing, particularly fund-raising and illegal financial transactions by JeM and LeT, and systemic deficiencies in its anti-money laundering framework. It was also cited for its weak implementation of financial sanctions on UN-designated terrorists, and limited terror prosecutions and convictions.

The pressure from FATF and Western countries forced Pakistan to take several steps against some terror leaders, especially those from LeT.

Pakistan was allowed to exit from the "grey list" on the condition that the Asia Pacific Group (APG), a regional affiliate of the FATF, would continue reviewing its performance on certain specific points, including its ongoing efforts to arrest Azhar in connection with his terror financing conviction in 2021.

SC questions govt over medicine overpricing

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday questioned the Centre over its failure to bring all medicines under price control, asking why economic interests should weigh over citizens' lives and why pharmaceutical companies should be allowed to charge high prices for essential drugs.

Reserving its order on two petitions challenging high medicine prices, a bench of justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta questioned the wide gap between the maximum retail price (MRP) and the price to retailer (PTR). "Do not treat it as commerce but treat it as what concerns the lives of citizens. Is this a matter where the government's economic policy should weigh over the lives of citizens," the bench said.

The Centre informed the court about its decision to cap trade margins on 137 anti-cancer drugs at 30% of the MRP, expected to save patients around ₹2,500 crore annually. The court, however, pointed out that the decision came only after its intervention.

"What stops you from taking control over the entire medicines. What is the rationale behind leaving some medicines outside the scheduled drugs category that puts it outside the Drug Price Control Order (DPCO)?" the bench said.

The court reserved its order on two petitions challenging high medicine prices.

Additional solicitor general Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Centre, said the government did not support excessive trade margins but wanted to protect investment and competition.

"The price of drugs when seen globally are the cheapest in India. The government does not leave the sector unregulated. At the same time, complete control cannot be the solution," she said.

The bench said patients had no bargaining power and were forced to bear the burden of high prices. It cited an instance in which a medicine distributor offered to procure an anti-cancer drug directly from the manufacturer for ₹1,100 for his wife's treatment, but a private hospital charged him ₹1.30 lakh.

"Policy seems to benefit corporates even as the public suffers. We can give you 100 other examples of drugs and devices which are heavily priced. You can simply bring them under the trade margin of 16%," it said.

The court also criticised the Centre's affidavit for not addressing three parliamentary committee reports on drug pricing. "Your affidavit is silent on them (reports) because it is not very convenient to you," it said.

ASG Bhati informed the court that the government has ensured to make generic drugs available to people through the PM Jan Aushadi Kendras and that the government calibrates prices of non-scheduled drugs.

The pleas were by lawyer Kishan Chand Jain and doctor Sanjay Kulshreshtha. One of them noted that the annual turnover of Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Kendras was ₹2,200 crore, around 1% of the industry's annual turnover.

Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi appearing for a body of private hospitals said the private health sector became relevant as the state was not found to be up to the mark. He said that if the court feels that the margin of money is pocketed by hospitals, a panel can be formed to seek the truth.

Drugs are regulated as an essential commodity under Section 3 of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955 and the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013 (DPCO) is issued by the Centre in exercise of the powers conferred under this provision.

HC SETS CONDITION FOR NON-HINDUS TO ENTER TN'S AGAMIC TEMPLES

Ayesha Arvind
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: The Madras High Court has said that non-Hindus cannot enter 'Agamic' temples in Tamil Nadu without affirming their reverence for the presiding deity and giving an undertaking agreeing to follow the customs and practices of the temple.

In an order passed on October 30, a bench of Justices GR Swaminathan and P Murugan said that non-Hindus who fail to furnish such an undertaking affirming their reverence for the temple's deity cannot enter the temple.

"If any Non-Hindu claims to visit particular deity in the temple, then the respondents shall obtain undertaking from the said Non-Hindu that he is having faith in the deity and he would follow the customs and practices of Hindu religion and also abide by the Temple customs and on such undertaking the said Non-Hindu may be allowed to visit the temple," the court said.

The high court took exception to what it described as "Chamchagiri" and "optics" surrounding temple entry, observing that temple customs and usages could not be made to yield to such considerations.

"We hold that usages and customs of the temple cannot kneel down before such display of Chamchagiri and optics," it said, adding that the issue required an "authoritative pronouncement."

"That is why, we deem it necessary to render an authoritative pronouncement," it said.

The court was hearing a PIL by Thangam Venkatesh of Madurai, seeking directions to prevent non-Hindus from entering temple mandapams and proceeding beyond the flagstaff, and to ensure strict enforcement of existing temple-entry rules.

India invites Pakistan to SCO event in Delhi

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India has invited all 10 countries of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), including Pakistan, for the bloc's inaugural Civilisational Dialogue Forum to be held in Delhi from November 20-22, officials aware of the matter said on Tuesday.

Pakistan last attended the SCO's foreign ministers' meeting in Goa in May 2023.

All SCO members have been invited for the dialogue and the multilateral initiative has nothing to do with bilateral relations with Pakistan, the officials said, adding that the development should be viewed in the broader context. Pakistan's national heritage and culture minister Aurangzeb Khan Khichi has been invited, HT learns.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi proposed the dialogue at the SCO leaders' Summit in Tianjin last year. External affairs minister S Jaishankar visited Pakistan in October 2024 for the SCO Council Heads of Government meeting, becoming the first Indian foreign minister to visit Pakistan in nine years.

Organised jointly by the ministries of culture and external affairs, the SCO event's invitation to Pakistan comes nearly 18 months after Operation Sindoor, the four-day military confrontation triggered by the Pahalgam terror attack that killed 26 people. Between the launch of the operation in the early hours of May 7 and the ceasefire on May 10 evening, Indian forces bombed nine terror camps in Pakistan and PoK, killing at least 100 terrorists, and the Indian Air Force struck targets at 13 Pakistani airbases and military installations.

India recently hit out at Pakistan over backing terror during an SCO meeting.

On October 20, defence minister Rajnath Singh called for joint action to dismantle terrorism, asserting that there can be no justification for the scourge or double standards in tackling it, in a pointed message delivered in the presence of Pakistan's deputy PM and defence minister Ishaq Dar at the 25th meeting of SCO council of heads of government at Dushanbe in Tajikistan.

SC ISSUES NOTICE IN PLEA SEEKING FIR AGAINST RAHUL

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday issued notice on an application seeking registration of an FIR against leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi for pushing and injuring a woman journalist inside the Supreme Court precincts during a march by Opposition leaders on October 12. The matter has been posted for hearing on November 3.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant passed the order after the application was mentioned by senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia.

The court had earlier issued notice on the petition which seeks directions against Rahul Gandhi, Congress leader Mallikarjun Kharge, Indian National Congress and other leaders over the march.

The bench issued notice and tagged the matter along with the main plea on November 3.

Top court stresses need to strike balance between freedom of press and privacy

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday stressed the need to strike a balance between citizens' right to privacy and the media's freedom to investigate and report, as it issued notice on a petition by the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA) challenging provisions of the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023, and the rules framed under it in 2025.

A bench, comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, also issued notice on the association's interim prayer for a stay on the operation of the challenged provisions. The court will hear the matter on November 17.

"You are the best person to suggest to the Union and us how you will ensure there is no misuse," the bench told senior advocate Madhavi Divan, appearing for the DNPA, as the bench underlined that the privacy rights of ordinary citizens would have to be protected

PETITIONER DNPA REPRESENTS 21 NEWS PUBLISHERS, INCLUDING MEDIA ORGANISATIONS ASSOCIATED WITH THE ADANI AND AMBANI GROUPS

alongside the media's constitutional freedoms.

"There will be rights of innocent citizens and then there is your right. A balance has to be struck," CJI Kant said.

Divan told the bench that the petition was the first comprehensive challenge by what she described as "legacy media", representing conventional news publishers. She argued that the law could fundamentally alter the way journalism is practised by requiring news organisations to obtain consent before collecting or processing personal information for reporting.

"News has to be new...what is the point if I have to ask for permission and consent?" she asked, warning that the framework could effectively introduce pre-censorship and leave newsrooms unable to pursue stories involving public officials and government offices.

"Newsrooms will shut down...regime of pre-censorship...what's news otherwise?" said Divan, adding that publishers were already subject to regulatory mechanisms, including the Press Council of India.

If a report was inaccurate, she said, the publisher should face the consequences rather than be required to obtain prior permission before publication.

The bench reiterated that the competing rights would have to be reconciled. When Divan asked how journalists could report under the proposed framework, the court suggested the association might also explain how it would ensure that reporting did not infringe the rights of individuals.

The plea is important because it challenges not merely the general framework to protect digital personal data, but also the absence of a specific exemption for journalistic work. The DNPA represents 21 news publishers, including media firms associated with the Adani and Ambani groups, as well as several prominent newspaper and television networks. HT is also part of the DNPA.

At the heart of the challenge is Section 44(3) of the DPDP Act, which amended Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005. The association contends that the amendment removes the earlier public-interest disclosure safeguard for personal information and could restrict access to records relevant to public accountability.

The plea argues that the data protection framework fails to distinguish journalism in public interest from other forms of processing personal data.

Without such a distinction, reporters could face demands for consent, withdrawal of consent and erasure of personal information even when the information is relevant to investigations into corruption, corporate wrongdoing or misconduct by public officials, it contends.

M.P. NEWSPAPER OWNER GETS 10 LIFE TERMS FOR RAPING 5 MINORS

Shruti Tomar
shruti.tomar@hindustantimes.com

BHOPAL: A special court under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (Pocso) Act in Bhopal has sentenced a 78-year-old owner of a Bhopal-based vernacular newspaper to 10 separate consecutive life terms for the rape and sexual assault of five girls.

The punishment includes eight terms of imprisonment until death and two life imprisonment terms.

Special judge Kumadini Singh on Tuesday also imposed a fine of ₹77.64 lakh on Pyare Miyan. His accomplice, Rabia Bi, was sentenced to 20 years' imprisonment. The conviction added to a series of four life sentences already handed down to Pyare Miyan in similar cases.

Public prosecutor PN Singh Rajput said the accused had been targeting vulnerable girls since 2014 by luring them with promises of domestic work and a monthly salary of ₹10,000.

"Rabia Bi would bring the girls to him, after which they were subjected to sexual abuse at different times and locations," Rajput said.

According to the prosecution, Pyare Miyan won the trust of victims' families by asking the girls to call him *abbu* (father)".

The case surfaced on the night of July 11, 2020, when police found several girls in an intoxicated condition in the Ratibad area in Bhopal. During counselling, the victims alleged that they had been invited to a flat in Vishnu Hi-Tech City, Shahpura, on July 10 and 11 on the pretext of a birthday celebration. They alleged that they were served alcohol and sexually assaulted.

Prahlad Joshi

'WE HAVE BECOME MARKSVAADIS': EDU MIN FLAGS MARKS OBSESSION

Sanjay Maurya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Union education minister Prahlad Joshi on Tuesday used the launch of the Central Board of Secondary Education's (CBSE) Experience Centre at its New Delhi headquarters to criticise an alleged culture of *marksvaadis* obsessed with examination scores and rote learning, which he said was hurting the self-confidence of students.

He also linked the associated pressure with student suicides.

"Today, most of our time is spent figuring out how to memorise things and score marks. Parents, too, feel that somehow, by whatever means, children must get marks. I often say that, in a way, we have all become *marksvaadis*," Joshi said.

"Whenever the results are announced, there are reports of students taking their own lives. Why has this weak mindset developed among us? Because our entire focus is on somehow filling children's minds with information and ensuring that they pass competitive examinations," he said.

Spanning 6,000 square feet, the centre has 12 zones and 21 exhibits designed to introduce students to India's educational heritage, emerging technologies, career choices and environmental interconnectedness through interactive experiences, archives and films.

'Bound to be tamasha when book comes out'

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi on Tuesday said there is bound to be some 'tamasha' when her memoir comes out next month. In her second post on social media platform, X, after she joined it last week, Gandhi put out another sneak peek video on her upcoming memoir "Belonging: A Journey of Love" that is releasing on November 10.

"There's bound to be some tamasha [spectacle] when this book comes out. After all, others have spent decades telling my 'story', now it's my turn," she said in her post.

The memoir is scheduled for publication by HarperCollins India, following a breakdown in the earlier publishing arrangement with Penguin Random House India (PRHI).

The book reportedly chronicles Gandhi's journey from her childhood in post-war Italy to her move to India and marriage

Sonia Gandhi

to former prime minister Rajiv Gandhi. It is also expected to cover the major tragedies that transformed the Gandhi family.

PRHI denied allegations that it had refused to publish Sonia Gandhi's memoir over editorial changes, saying the claim "does not accurately reflect the circumstances". The publisher said fact-checking and editorial recommendations were part of its normal process and that it had remained "willing and keen" to publish the book.

"...Some may change their view about me. Some people's view may become worse but that is what it is. There is bound to be a tamasha (spectacle)," she said.

Protect development just like lives: Mishra

NEW DELHI: Principal secretary to the Prime Minister PK Mishra on Tuesday urged the world to protect development as fiercely as it protects lives, warning that climate change, fast urbanisation, infrastructure expansion and environmental degradation are creating "cascading consequences" that no single department or country can manage alone.

"The next decade must demonstrate the ability to protect not only lives but also the assets, infrastructure and development that communities build," Mishra said at a meeting of senior officials on disaster risk reduction.

Naga group to stage rally against SoO in Manipur on Oct 31

NEW DELHI: United Naga Council(UNC), a Naga body in Manipur, has decided to hold rallies across all Naga districts on October 31, coinciding with the proposed protest rallies in valley regions by the Meitei community. It came as the Naga body joined hands with Meitei groups over the demand for abrogation of Suspension of Operations (SoO) Pact with Kuki militants, and replacement of Assam Rifles with a border force such as BSF.

Centre lowers annual pass cost for local NH commuters

NEW DELHI: The Centre has amended the National Highways Fee (Determination of Rates and Collection) Rules, allowing eligible private vehicle owners to opt for a concessional local pass for toll plazas instead of the existing monthly one, a recent notification said. The new rules state residents within 20 km of a NH toll plaza can opt for annual passes for ₹1,500 at rural toll plazas and ₹3,000 at urban ones from Sunday.

Child with gene defect allowed to go to CWC

Vishnu Varma
letters@hindustantimes.com

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: The Kerala high court has permitted a couple to hand over their child, after delivery, to the Child Welfare Committee (CWC), after a scan indicated that the foetus suffered from a genetic condition called skeletal dysplasia.

The petitioners—a 28-year-old woman and her 38-year-old husband—initially approached the high court seeking termination of her pregnancy at 33 weeks of gestation after the finding of the foetus' condition.

Subsequently, a medical board instituted by the bench of justice Harisankar V Menon to examine the woman, filed a report stating that there was no need to terminate the pregnancy due to the abnormality.

"Pre-term termination will add to the morbidity of the present unborn foetus. In view of absence of genetic testing, developmental delay cannot be predicted. Even if terminated, the baby should be resuscitated to full extent and handed over to child welfare services if the parents are not willing to take care of the child," the report submitted in court suggested.

Following the report, the counsel for the petitioners told the court that they do not intend to terminate the pregnancy.

Skeletal dysplasia defines a group of around 400 conditions affecting bone growth, neurological function and cartilage growth. Abnormal growth in the spine and skull can result in affected people's short stature.

Def min inks 5-year AI MoU with Sarvam

Rahul Singh and Sejal Sharma
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Bengaluru-based Sarvam has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS), Ministry of Defence, to work together on artificial intelligence (AI) projects across the army, navy and air force. The company announced the agreement in a press release on Tuesday.

The five-year MoU sets up an umbrella framework for AI projects across the three Services. It also covers the joint, tri-service and integrated organisations that come under HQ IDS. The areas of collaboration include AI applications, research, knowledge management, training and decision support.

HQ IDS described the agreement as a significant step towards strengthening sovereign AI capabilities for India's defence forces.

"The partnership will focus on building secure, sovereign and scalable AI capabilities, with strong emphasis on data sovereignty and ensuring responsible AI-based solutions," it said in a post on X.

Under the MoU, Sarvam will design, develop and deploy AI applications for the operational, training and decision-support needs of the three Services, and will provide follow-on technical support. The work will cover several projects across all three Services, with HQ IDS facilitating the engagement.

According to Sarvam, the Services will get access to the same foundation models, agentic infrastructure, and geospatial and perception systems. Lessons learnt from one Service's projects can then feed into the next. The company said the focus will be on decision support, and on target acquisition and data fusion across the sensor-to-shooter loop.

Human oversight will be retained on operational decisions, it added. The AI layer, it said, will be built in India and deployed on sovereign infrastructure.

The work will be carried out by Chanakya, Sarvam's firewalled division focused on national security and defence. Chanakya will use Sarvam's AI stack, including foundation models such as Sarvam 105B. The company said the two sides will take up projects, including building an AI fabric that connects the elements of India's defence capabilities.

"Sarvam exists to build AI in India, for India," said Pratyush Kumar, co-founder of Sarvam, as per the press release. "We hold ourselves to the highest standards in this work."

17 convicts overpower guards to escape TN jail, 13 recaptured

S Vijay Karthik
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHENNAI: Out of 17 convicts who broke out of a jail in Theni district in Tamil Nadu late on Monday, 13 were recaptured through intensive combing operations on Tuesday, police officers said.

The group allegedly overpowered guards and escaped after one of them feigned an epileptic seizure in the prison's third block, said officers.

Only four convicts remain absconding, they added.

The group of 17 included people convicted for offences including murder, robbery and drug-related offences.

"It appears that the prisoners escaped by a putting a drama as if one of them was unwell and suffering from fits or epilepsy. They overpowered the prison guards and escaped," said IGP South Zone Vijayendra S Bidari.

Police personnel with the 13 convicts after their recapture on Tuesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Police formed 17 special teams to trace the convicts, and also coordinated joint operations with counterparts in Keralam and set up temporary check posts near state borders in Idukki, Madurai and Dindigul.

Officers said drones played a key role in the operations.

The state opposition, meanwhile, threw jibes at the state government over the incident. Former chief minister AND DMK chief MK Stalin referenced popular American television shows *Breaking Bad* and *Prison Break* to quip about the jailbreak. "Following the trend of *Breaking Bad*, it seems *Prison Break* has now begun in Tamil Nadu! I had assumed that only those released on bail were left unmonitored; it turns out this administration is so incompetent that it even allows prisoners—who are supposedly behind bars—to escape," he wrote on X,

AIADMK chief Edappadi K Palaniswami termed the incident as a "rude shock".

Multiple life terms cannot run one after another: Apex court

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday held that courts cannot direct multiple life terms for different offences in a single trial to run consecutively, ruling that the sentences must instead be superimposed over each other to ensure that remission or commutation granted in one does not automatically extend to the other.

A bench of justices KV Viswanathan and Arun Palli set aside a direction requiring a man convicted of rape and murder of a 12-year-old girl to serve two life sentences consecutively, noting such a direction was contrary to the settled legal position laid down by a Constitution bench in 2016.

"While multiple sentences for imprisonment for life can be awarded for multiple murders or other offences punishable with imprisonment for life, the life sentences so awarded cannot be directed to run consecutively," said the court, reiterating the principle laid down in Muthuramalingam Vs State (2016).

The bench clarified that the sentences must be superimposed

THE TOP COURT RULING ENSURES REMISSION OR COMMUTATION GRANTED IN ONE SENTENCE DOESN'T AUTOMATICALLY EXTEND TO THE OTHER

over each other, meaning that any remission or commutation granted by the competent authority in respect of one sentence would not automatically result in remission of the sentence imposed for the other offence.

The ruling came in the appeal filed by Raju Shantaram Koli, who was convicted in 2013 by a Thane sessions court for the 2010 rape and murder of a 12-year-old girl. He was sentenced to life imprisonment for murder under Section 302 of the Indian Penal Code and another life term for rape under Section 376, with the trial court directing the sentences to run consecutively rather than concurrently. The Bombay high court upheld the direction in 2016.

In a judgment authored by Justice Viswanathan, the Supreme Court held that the legal position on consecutive life sentences had already been settled by the Constitution bench in Muthuramalingam, which had explained that life imprisonment ordinarily extends to the remainder of the convict's natural life unless the sentence is commuted or remitted by the competent authority.

The Constitution bench had reasoned that requiring a person to undergo two consecutive life sentences would be anomalous because a person has only one life to live. It had also clarified that awarding multiple life sentences for separate offences is legally permissible, but directing them to run consecutively is not.

"The award of multiple sentences of imprisonment for life so that such sentences are superimposed over one another is entirely different from directing such sentence to run consecutively," the earlier judgment had held.

Applying that principle, the bench partly allowed Koli's appeal and set aside the direction that the two life sentences should run one after the other.

Centre seeks US deportation of man whose passport is with SC

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Union government has approached US authorities seeking the deportation of a man who managed to leave the country despite his passport being deposited with the Supreme Court, which is pursuing contempt proceedings against him in a child custody dispute.

A bench of justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi in an order released on Monday recorded a communication from the Centre confirming that the Central Bureau of Investigation's Interpol unit had written to the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) seeking the deportation of Manish Chhokar, and expressed satisfaction with the steps taken to secure his presence in India.

The court adjourned the matter by four weeks, allowing the government more time to pursue the process. "In view of the steps taken by the Union of India to secure the presence of the respondent of which we are satisfied," it said.

The development follows a series of steps initiated by the Supreme Court after Chhokar, a US Green Card holder, allegedly left India in January 2025 despite his Indian passport being in the court's custody and without its permission. The court had issued a non-bailable warrant against him and subsequently directed CBI to investigate how he managed to leave the country. The agency registered a case against him in March 2025.

The latest order records that the CBI's National Central Bureau in New Delhi sent a communication dated September 30, 2026, to the FBI at the US Embassy in New Delhi, seeking Chhokar's deportation. The communication was enclosed with a letter dated October 13 addressed to the Legal Consultant in the MEA and placed before the court by the Centre's counsel.

The court had earlier explored the options available to the government to secure Chhokar's return. In an order dated August 26, 2025, it recorded the Centre's assessment that extradition from the US might not be feasible because contempt of court, by itself, was not an extraditable offence under the applicable framework.

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai
E-mail - maha.mmgpa2023@gmail.com
MMGPA, 1st Floor, Arogya Bhavan, St. George's Hospital Compound, Mumbai - 400 001.

TENDER NOTICE **Date: 26.10.2026**

Chief Executive Officer, Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai invites tender in two Envelope system from the eligible bidders for the following items for purchase of Medicines.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Name of Item (s)	Prebid Meeting	Period of Sale, download & Submission of bid	Bid Opening
1.	E-324	Tablet Capsules	Dt. 29-10-2026 At 02.00 PM.	Dt. 26-10-2026 At 17.00 PM to Dt. 16-11-2026 Upto 17.00 PM.	Dt. 17-11-2026 At 17.00 PM.

1. For detailed information, the interested bidders may visit the **Website https://mahatenders.gov.in.**
2. The Chief Executive Officer reserves the right to increase or decrease the quantity to be purchased and also reserves the right to cancel all the tenders without giving any reason to.
3. This advertisement should be published in a newspaper in size 3"x3".

For e-tendering help/ information, please contact.
Website :- https://mahatenders.gov.in
E-mail- maha.mmgpa2023@gmail.com

Signature/-
General Manager (Technical),
Maharashtra Medical Goods Procurement Authority, Mumbai

DGIPR/2026-27/ ROC 3428

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्रथम तल, कॉमर्शियल कॉम्प्लेक्स, पी–2, सैक्टर–1, ग्रेटर नौएडा, जनपद गौतमबुद्धनगर–201308 (उ.प्र.)
Toll Free No. 18001808296 वेबसाइट: www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

पत्रांक : वाई.ई.ए. / भूलेख / 243 / 2026 दिनांक : 27.10.2026

सार्वजनिक सूचना

निम्नलिखित भूमि यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा आपसी सहमति के आधार पर काश्तकारों से क्रय किया जाना प्रस्तावित है। यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे प्राधिकरण की सेक्टर–06 के अन्तर्गत आने वाले ग्राम आकलपुर, नगला शाहपुर, भीकनपुर, कानपुर, मुढरह तथा इस्माइल नगर उर्फ भौयरा की क्रय की जानी वाली भूमि के खसरा नम्बरान का विवरण निम्नवत है :–

क्र.सं.	ग्राम का नाम	सेक्टर–06 के अन्तर्गत आ रहे खसरा नम्बरान
1.	आकलपुर	249, 250, 251, 252, 254, 255, 256, 257, 258, 260, 269, 283, 285, 290, 291, 311, 313, 314, 317, 318, 320, 321, 322, 323, 324, 325, 326, 327, 328, 329, 330, 331, 332, 333, 336, 337, 338, 339, 341, 342, 343, 344, 346, 348, 349, 350, 351, 353, 354, 355, 357, 358, 359, 360, 361, 362, 363, 364, 365, 366, 367, 370, 371, 372
2.	नगला शाहपुर	1, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 11, 13, 14, 15, 17, 18, 19, 21, 22, 24, 25, 27, 28, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 56, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 73, 74, 75, 76, 78, 79, 81, 82, 83, 85, 87, 88, 95, 96, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 109, 111, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 122, 130, 132, 133, 134, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 149, 150, 151, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 183
3.	भीकनपुर	43, 45, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 144, 145, 148, 149, 150, 151, 153, 154, 156, 157, 160, 161, 165, 166, 167, 170, 171, 174, 175, 177, 178, 179, 181, 182, 183, 184, 186, 187, 188, 189, 345
4.	कानपुर	1, 2, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 57, 59, 62, 63, 64, 65, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 75, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 84, 87, 88, 89, 90, 92, 93, 94, 96, 97, 98, 101, 102, 103, 105, 106, 108, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 143, 144, 146, 148, 149, 150, 151, 152, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 212, 213, 214
5.	मुढरह	265, 493, 494, 495, 497, 499, 500, 501, 503, 504
6.	इस्माइल नगर उर्फ भौयरा	22, 23, 25, 26, 29, 30

उपरोक्त भूमि क्रय किए जाने में यदि किसी व्यक्ति को कोई आपत्ति है तो वह लिखित रूप में 15 दिन के अन्दर अपर मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण को अपनी आपत्ति प्रस्तुत कर सकता है।

उप जिलाधिकारी, यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिसूचित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लॉन के अतिरिक्त प्लॉटिंग / हाउसिंग। कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध है। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीदफरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनाइजर के भ्रामक विज्ञापनों से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP/ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1.	HSAMB YAMUNANAGAR	CONSTRUCTION OF VARIOUS LINK ROADS IN THE NOTIFIED AREA OF MARKET COMMITTEE RADAUR IN RADAUR CONSTITUENCY (GROUP-1) ROAD ID 12763, 12765, 12767, 12770 AND 12774 IN DISTT. YAMUNANAGAR + 1 WORKS.	CLOSING DATE 05.11.2026	7,54,14,492/-	https:// etenders. hry.nic.in	9270010001 xenynr. hsamb2023@ gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO NO. 13/2027/40/50515/I/19/7

NORTHERN RAILWAY
PUBLIC NOTICE

On the occasion of "DIWALI' festival on 08.11.2026 (Sunday) all the Computerized Passenger Reservation offices in Delhi Area will remain closed in the evening shift (14:00 hrs - 20:00 hrs) whereas skeleton service will be available up to 18.00 hrs at **IRCA Reservation Complex, Delhi/PRS & Hazrat Nizammuddin/PRS.** The reservation offices at Parliament House, Press Club of India, **Railway Board, Supreme Court, High Court and Jawahar Lal Nehru University** will remain closed for the whole day.

3739/2026 **Dy. Chief Commercial Manager/IT**

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD CORP/AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	HVPNL	E.NIT NO.- 16 /XEN TS DIV HVPNL HISAR/2026-2027 DATED 08.10.2026 TENDER REF. NO./E-TENDER ID:2026_HBC_552885_1 2026511853E6 7A4E 4890 80AB 5F7D52B6C646967HVP	"DATE OF BID OPENING - 08.10.2026 FROM 1500 HR LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 04.11.2026 (1500 HRS)."	www.hvpn. org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	NIT NO. 34/CWD-2/VOL-XXI/HVPN/2026-27 DATED: 09.10.2026 (ONLINE TENDER ID NO. 2026_HBC_553143_1)	"DATE OF OPENING BID 23.10.2026 (1100 HRS) LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 04.11.2026 (1300 HRS) (SOCIETIES & CONTRACTORS)"	www.hvpn. org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
3	HVPNL	NIT NO. 35/CWD-2/VOL-XXI/HVPN/2026-27 DATED: 09.10.2026 (ONLINE TENDER ID NO. 2026_HBC_553185_1)	"DATE OF OPENING BID 23.10.2026 (1100 HRS) LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 04.11.2026 (1300 HRS) (SOCIETIES & CONTRACTORS)"	www.hvpn. org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
4	HVPNL	QDP-1510 (NIT NO. 1390 DATED 08.09.2026)	THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 13.11.2026 UP TO 1700 HRS	www.hvpn. org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
5	HVPNL	2026522EEB93 OA1D 4CBB BB38 TENDER 58E58416E45B1056HVP/ TENDER ID: 2026_HBC_552153_1/ETENDER ENQUIRY NO. 1005202613-29-36/ HARYANA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED DEPT/HRY. DATED 05.10.2026.	"CORRIGENDUM NO. 02, THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 10.11.2026 (1300 HRS)"	www.hvpn. org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

RO NO 13/2027/100/50538/I/19/7 **FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in**

भारत सरकार
कारपोरेट कार्य मंत्रालय
त्वरित कॉर्पोरेट समापन प्रसंस्करण केंद्र (सी-पेस)
आई.आई.सी.ए. बिल्डिंग, 7वी मंजिल,
प्लाट **P-6, 7, 8,** से.-5, आई.एम.टी. मानेसर,
गुडगाँव, हरियाणा-122050
Email: roc.cpace@mca.gov.in

सत्यमेव जयते

Government of India
Ministry of Corporate Affairs
Centre for Processing Accelerated Corporate Exit (C-PACE)
IICA Building, 7th Floor,
Plot P-6, 7, 8, Sector-5, IMT Manesar,
Gurgaon, Haryana - 122050
Email: roc.cpace@mca.gov.in

FORM No. STK -- 6

PUBLIC NOTICE

[Pursuant to sub-section (2) and sub-section (4) of section 248 of the Companies Act, 2013 and rule 7 of the Companies (Removal of Names of Companies from the Register of Companies) Rules, 2016]

Public: ROC/C-PACE/STK-2/248(2)/2026-27/1644 **Date: 14.10.2026**

Reference:

In the matter of striking off or removal of names of **(139)** companies in the **Delhi** state under section 248 of the Companies Act, 2013 in respect of:

S. No.	Work Item	CIN	Company Name
1	AC6017186	U74110DL2012PTC235816	AVYUKTA WORLDWIDE TRADE PRIVATE LIMITED
2	AC6004680	U74999DL2017PTC312628	INDICGLOBAL MULTILANGUAGE PRIVATE LIMITED
3	AC5987300	U17299DL2019PTC344545	AAVEVAA EXPORTS PRIVATE LIMITED
4	AC5976006	U70100DL2012PTC236272	SRI SATYASAINATH REAL PROJECTS PRIVATE LIMITED
5	AC5784778	U46102DL2023PTC414858	HANUMANT ADDITIVES AND CHEMICALS PRIVATE LIMITED
6	AC5564453	U63090DL2022PTC407738	AERO SAV PRIVATE LIMITED
7	AC5981421	U74999DL2018PTC328227	JUV TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
8	AC5594503	U74950DL2001PTC110147	AMORPHOS PACKAGING PRIVATE LIMITED
9	AC5887890	U74999DL2017PTC322150	NATIVISM TECHNOCRATS PRIVATE LIMITED
10	AC5981059	U46909DL2024PTC437259	GENUITY GLOBAL TRADE PRIVATE LIMITED
11	AC6008538	U82300DL2026PTC469439	AUREZIA PRIVATE LIMITED
12	AC5959426	U72900DL2008PTC184896	MOBIPPL TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
13	AC5965587	U40104DL2016PTC292713	AMAR ENERGY PRIVATE LIMITED
14	AC5957146	U31401DL2014PTC273129	CONTINENTAL ELECTROWIRES PRIVATE LIMITED
15	AC6010505	U74999DL2018PTC334304	OPUS PERSONNEL PRIVATE LIMITED
16	AC5485609	U51399DL2000PTC107713	LAKRIS IMPEX PRIVATE LIMITED.
17	AC5730309	U51494DL2015PTC277189	SAHASRA PRODUCTS AND SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
18	AC5957255	U45200DL2017PTC318841	CHARIOT INFRATOOLTECH PRIVATE LIMITED
19	AC5975449	U34300DL2022PTC401664	ONELIFE ENVIROGREEN TECH PRIVATE LIMITED
20	AC5175987	U34300DL2022PTC398225	E-ASHWA AUTOMOTIVE (UTKAL) PRIVATE LIMITED
21	AC5983408	U51909DL2021PTC388436	PYRAMID ELECTRONICS GREENERGY PRIVATE LIMITED
22	AC5923856	U68100DL2024PTC437408	AASU G URBAN KEY DEVELOPER PRIVATE LIMITED
23	AC5983892	U52190DL2016PTC301198	NBUY ONLINE PRIVATE LIMITED
24	AC5974510	U51397DL2019PTC344709	SARAKEM HEALTHCARE PRIVATE LIMITED
25	AC5461557	U29305DL2020PTC370988	AP ELEVATORS PRIVATE LIMITED
26	AC5416857	U85500DL2024PTC437763	QUESTPRO UNIQGLOBE SOLUTION PRIVATE LIMITED
27	AC5943971	U72900DL2022PTC393976	PORCHBEAM PRIVATE LIMITED
28	AC5993140	U74899DL1991PTC044557	D.D. LUMBERS PRIVATE LIMITED
29	AC5915531	U74999DL2016PTC306021	SHREE MADHAV SECURITY AND FACILITY PRIVATE LIMITED
30	AC5921936	U62099DL2025PTC442468	DEZIRE TECHLAB PRIVATE LIMITED
31	AC5888134	U51909DL2014PTC264357	DASGRIV DECOR PRIVATE LIMITED
32	AC5906705	U72900DL2016PTC300214	BIZTEK ADVISORS PRIVATE LIMITED
33	AC5928508	U74999DL2018PTC340063	BSLS CONSULTANTS PRIVATE LIMITED
34	AC5837446	U74999DL2018PTC331226	PRR COMMUNICATION PRIVATE LIMITED
35	AC5895392	U35105DL2025PTC453531	AAKASH SUN ENERGY PRIVATE LIMITED
36	AC5886819	U74999DL2017PTC311017	GROWSURE RETAIL PRIVATE LIMITED
37	AC5845512	U74899DL1965PTC004393	DELHI EXPRESS TRAVELS PRIVATE LIMITED
38	AC5520210	U45209DL2017PTC319380	PROWESS INFRATECH PRIVATE LIMITED
39	AC5763894	U68200DL2023PTC419964	JI&JI REAL ESTATE PRIVATE LIMITED
40	AC5781860	U72900DL2020PTC371118	SURBHITECH TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
41	AC5736166	U24100DL2020PTC365144	KAHNOR INDUSTRIES PRIVATE LIMITED
42	AC5934419	U36998DL2008PTC182791	TIGHTFIT FASTNERS PRIVATE LIMITED
43	AC5735594	U74999DL2015PTC275838	STAR TRIPLEPLAY NETWORK PRIVATE LIMITED
44	AC5736952	U74920DL2004PTC126871	MARINEFIELD SECURITY SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
45	AC5717881	U72900DL2017PTC324581	SKEWER TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
46	AC5701083	U55101DL2016PTC299145	PAY COST INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED
47	AC5720051	U74999DL2015PTC288301	NANODX HEALTHCARE PRIVATE LIMITED
48	AC5719342	U74999DL2017PTC326170	RM INDIA HOUSEKEEPING PRIVATE LIMITED
49	AC5712062	U74999DL2020PTC372003	CREDAERO PRIVATE LIMITED
50	AC5710040	U74999DL2015FTC280615	MRSK CONSULTANCY SERVICES (INDIA) PRIVATE LIMITED
51	AC5659464	U27202DL2025PTC447409	EASTMAN ELECTRONICS MANUFACTURING PRIVATE LIMITED
52	AC5704949	U72900DL2016OPC298919	NIRMAAN TECHNOLOGY (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED
53	AC5661775	U27900DL2025PTC448223	EASTMAN SOLAR TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
54	AC5680758	U45500DL2017PTC313464	YUGROOP INFRA BUILDCON PRIVATE LIMITED
55	AC5742412	U93000DL2019PTC344568	INNOVATIVE CASHFLOW ADVISORY PRIVATE LIMITED
56	AC5651050	U63090DL2017PTC319319	TRADITIONAL VIAJES PRIVATE LIMITED
57	AC5660239	U00000DL1986PTC026232	FENGRS GEO SCIENCE PRIVATE LTD
58	AC5557105	U74899DL1988PTC030654	PENGUIN CHITS PRIVATE LIMITED
59	AC5701562	U55101DL2022PTC401651	NMOBYD PRIVATE LIMITED
60	AC5680029	U15203DL2010PTC205619	BALAJI PANEER PRIVATE LIMITED
61	AC5522895	U82910DL2024PTC435487	FOUL DECK PRIVATE LIMITED
62	AC5572883	U74999DL2018PTC330649	KRRENT IT SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
63	AC5876309	U51909DL2016PTC304112	MERCE LENS PRIVATE LIMITED
64	AC5281643	U74999DL2016PTC307921	BANIYA'S SQUARE RETAILS PRIVATE LIMITED
65	AC5611131	U17200DL2009PTC197062	KARLEE IMPEX PRIVATE LIMITED
66	AC5701382	U51101DL2015PTC282062	NANO LINKS RENEWABLE ENERGY PRIVATE LIMITED
67	AC5594397	U51909DL2021PTC389386	ADVAIT IMPEX PRIVATE LIMITED
68	AC5576899	U50300DL2022PTC396074	SWARANRAJ AUTOMOTIVE SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED
69	AC6009471	U62020DL2024PTC433771	SEYOM ENTERPRISES PRIVATE LIMITED
70	AC5781909	U74999DL2018PTC340426	SAMIYA TOURISM PRIVATE LIMITED
71	AC6016077	U45200DL2007PTC159885	SATYAM SHIVAM SUNDRAM BUILDERS PRIVATE LIMITED
72	AC6010016	U74999DL2018PLC334178	ALL INDIA TECHNICAL CONSULTANCY CORPORATION LIMITED
73	AC6010010	U72200DL2022PTC399517	AMALAKI SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED
74	AC6001633	U72900DL2012PTC230598	HYPERLINK TECHNOLOGY PRIVATE LIMITED
75	AC5960949	U72900DL2019PTC356970	LEVERCODE INFOTECH PRIVATE LIMITED
76	AC5996702	U27320DL2023PTC416680	WANA INDUSTRIES PRIVATE LIMITED
77	AC5965427	U52609DL2022PTC399437	OXCEE TRADING PRIVATE LIMITED
78	AC6003736	U80904DL2023PTC409802	MATHSLOYAL PRIVATE LIMITED
79	AC5928938	U74900DL2015PTC288622	VENDITARE TECH PRIVATE LIMITED
80	AC5914621	U85500DL2025PTC453354	FITTRADERS ACADEMY PRIVATE LIMITED
81	AC5736267	U74999DL2014PTC268269	BISWAKARMA RETAIL & SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
82	AC5913818	U70102DL2012PTC232042	MANOX INFRA PRIVATE LIMITED
83	AC5882048	U62091DL2024PTC428340	RBOT VENTURES PRIVATE LIMITED
84	AC5883784	U66120DL2023PTC421552	NISI ABUNDANT PRIVATE LIMITED
85	AC5864943	U74899DL1982PTC014097	PERFECT ROTARY OFFSET PVT LTD
86	AC5890729	U74999DL2014PTC271423	FERRY CONSULTANCY SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
87	AC5680490	U63999DL2024PTC437273	KALPCON TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
88	AC5985648	U74999DL2022PTC392427	SAARATAA FINTECH PRIVATE LIMITED
89	AC5889540	U72900DL2016PTC308973	TECHOFORCE ESERVE PRIVATE LIMITED
90	AC5807294	U46411DL2024PTC435515	SAATHI CRAFTED ESSENCE PRIVATE LIMITED
91	AC5656568	U51909DL2013PTC254263	GRIPPER INTERNATIONAL EXIM PRIVATE LIMITED
92	AC5733209	U96020DL2024PTC431389	TANUBHI BEAUTY CARE PRIVATE LIMITED
93	AC5744568	U52100DL2018PTC339619	BHUKKAD NETWORKS PRIVATE LIMITED
94	AC5765156	U74899DL1996PTC075487	MAVERICK ELECTRONICS PRIVATE LIMITED
95	AC5713004	U72900DL2022PTC401303	STINT INFOTECH PRIVATE LIMITED
96	AC5732984	U74999DL2017PTC319454	BOOMINGOZ ENTERPRISE PRIVATE LIMITED
97	AC5734263	U51909DL2004PTC129260	HARI DESIGNS PRIVATE LIMITED
98	AC5702259	U74999DL2017PTC313890	NRS CHARIOT TECH PRIVATE LIMITED
99	AC5728508	U47411DL2025PTC440923	E ARE J BHARAT PRIVATE LIMITED
100	AC5632742	U35106DL2025PTC448042	WYN RENEWABLES PROJECT 9 PRIVATE LIMITED
101	AC5712376	U74999DL2015PTC280609	TEAM INVICTUS SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
102	AC5935280	U50404DL2020PTC374894	KAR SURGEON STUDIO PRIVATE LIMITED
103	AC5661489	U74999DL2018PTC331685	SWASTIK HI-TECH INNOVATION PRIVATE LIMITED
104	AC5669450	U74950DL2007PTC159531	SHREE BANKE BIHARI PACKAGING PRIVATE LIMITED
105	AC5662635	U74999DL2000PTC104966	RAJ BUILDING PRODUCTS PRIVATE LIMITED
106	AC5689845	U74999DL2020PTC369649	BPM ENTERPRISES PRIVATE LIMITED
107	AC5735107	U80902DL2019PTC357111	CRAFTSMAN WORKS PRIVATE LIMITED
108	AC5593747	U74999DL2016PTC301088	EVEXIA HEALTHCARE PRIVATE LIMITED
109	AC5653147	U80904DL2010PTC199004	TEJPUNJ EDUCATIONAL SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
110	AC5804322	U72900DL2022PTC406006	ESPERON DIGITAL PRIVATE LIMITED
111	AC5557315	U17299DL2016PTC300729	EW ENTERPRISES PRIVATE LIMITED
112	AC5804634	U70100DL2014PTC265003	HEMANYA BUILDERS PRIVATE LIMITED
113	AC5573575	U51909DL2016PTC304085	TIGER DIESEL AND SPARE PARTS PRIVATE LIMITED
114	AC5633028	U35106DL2025PTC448036	WYN RENEWABLES PROJECT 8 PRIVATE LIMITED
115	AC5942954	U72100DL1999PTC097790	OPERANT COMMUNICATIONS SYSTEMS PRIVATE LIMITED
116	AC5969580	U17309DL2016PTC305190	KIRI FASHIONS PRIVATE LIMITED
117	AC5975132	U74999DL2021OPC381199	SHARE WHERE SOLUTION (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED
118	AC5954421	U74999DL2019PTC352264	SEVEN STONES STORE PRIVATE LIMITED
119	AC5952222	U70109DL2019PTC353895	GREEN AAKS PROJECTS PRIVATE LIMITED
120	AC5953051	U55100DL2011PTC217000	NOODLES AND MORE RESTAURANTS PRIVATE LIMITED
121	AC5922429	U67100DL2022PTC403648	GOUP FINTECH SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
122	AC5923748	U74999DL2020FTC372420	FUTURE INDIA KITCHEN PRIVATE LIMITED
123	AC5921765	U70100DL2017PTC312641	EAST INDIA ENGICON SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED
124	AC5916121	U74999DL2022PTC406142	JSV SECURITY SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
125	AC5899154	U45209DL2012PTC241449	TOWN HEIGHTS BUILDCON PRIVATE LIMITED
126	AC5924416	U70102DL2015PTC276639	GLOCAL REALORS PRIVATE LIMITED
127	AC5928556	U68100DL1997PLC084284	MANU TENETS INDIA LIMITED
128	AC5748884	U72900DL2017PTC324700	WAYOUT TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
129	AC5909538	U45400DL2014PTC274310	KRISHNA-ROSHAN INFRASTRUCTURE PRIVATE LIMITED
130	AC5928150	U01111DL2022PTC407005	THREE RIVER AGRO SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED
131	AC5702123	U74120DL2015PTC284986	FIVE K CONSULTING PRIVATE LIMITED
132	AC5893393	U74999DL2018PTC333232	RASI INNOVATION PRIVATE LIMITED
133	AC5859882	U74140DL2015PTC287369	ADEQUATE BUSINESS SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED
134	AC5668598	U21093DL2021PTC386762	VITARA VENTURES PRIVATE LIMITED
135	AC5669773	U55101DL2024PTC429235	ALKA ESHA ESTATES PRIVATE LIMITED
136	AC5812582	U93000DL2017OPC317112	SHLEYROYAL IMAGINEERING INDIA (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED
137	AC5864583	U47721DL2025PTC449858	GAUNAC WELLNESS PRIVATE LIMITED
138	AC5744549	U18109DL2020PTC365770	ANU AAKRITI CREATIONS PRIVATE LIMITED
139	AC5931062	U56301DL2026PTC463465	AAMANTRAN FINE DINING PRIVATE LIMITED

(2) Notice is hereby given that the Registrar of Companies had received applications from the above-mentioned companies under section 248(2) of the Companies Act, 2013 for removal of its/their name (s) from the register of companies either on the ground that they have failed to commence business within one year of their incorporation or on the ground that the company(ies) is/are not carrying on any business or operation for a period of two immediately preceding financial years and has/have not made any application (s) within such period for obtaining the status of a dormant company under section 455 of the Companies Act, 2013 or the company(ies) have obtained the status of dormant company/subscribers to the memorandum have not paid the subscription which they had undertaken to pay at the time of incorporation of a company and a declaration to this effect has not been filed within one hundred and eighty days of its incorporation under subsection (1) of section 10A/ have not been carrying on any business or operations, as revealed after the physical verification carried out under sub-section (9) of section 12, but it/they do not wish to continue its/their registration as companies and have, therefore, requested for removal/strike off of its/their names from the register of companies.

(3) Accordingly, the Registrar of Companies proposes to remove or strike off the names of the above-mentioned companies from the Register of Companies.

(4) Any person objecting to the proposed removal or striking off name of the companies from the register of companies may send his or her objection to the office address mentioned here above within thirty days from the date of publication of this notice.

Raunak Agrawal
Deputy Registrar
Centre for Processing Accelerated Corporate Exit

CBC 07123/11/0703/2627

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

CYCLONE ARNAB

kmph. Widespread rainfall was forecast across Andhra Pradesh on Wednesday. Extremely heavy rainfall was likely in some districts, according to the weather department. The combination of heavy rain and strong winds was likely to damage trees, electricity infrastructure, temporary structures and buildings in vulnerable areas.

Jain appealed to people to remain alert, avoid unnecessary travel and stay indoors in safe locations. He warned people against standing near trees, large hoardings and dilapidated buildings, which could collapse or be uprooted in strong winds.

On Wednesday, extremely heavy rainfall is forecast in Visakhapatnam, Anakapalli, Alluri Sitarama Raju, Polavaram, Kakinada, Konaseema, East Godavari, West Godavari, Eluru, NTR and Krishna districts.

Authorities cautioned that rainfall intensity and the geographical spread of the impact will depend on the cyclone's movement and the conditions prevailing during landfall.

Eight state and seven nations teams and seven national disaster response force teams have been deployed in Andhra Pradesh. An additional three SDRF teams and five NDRF teams are available for deployment, if required. The Andhra Pradesh government on Monday night released ₹ 27 crore for cyclone-related preparedness and relief operations, and officials briefed chief minister N Chandrababu Naidu on the precautionary measures and the overall preparedness to manage the cyclone.

Residents in vulnerable coastal and low-lying areas have been urged to take precautionary measures and remain in safe locations.

Officials said people can seek a faster response to cyclone-related problems through the Mana Mitra WhatsApp number: 9552300009.

The cyclone is expected to have a significant impact across 16 districts, covering 2,460 revenue villages and 92 urban areas in Andhra Pradesh.

Authorities have identified 1,763 cyclone shelters and established 2,907 control rooms at district and mandal levels. A total of 3,185 nodal officers have been appointed to coordinate relief and emergency response.

Beaches have been closed to the public, while movement on coastal roads has been suspended. Cabinet Secretary T V Somanathan, who chaired the NCMC meeting on Monday to review preparedness for the cyclone, directed central agencies and state governments to prioritise saving lives, minimise damage to property and infrastructure, and ensure the swift restoration of essential services in the event of disruptions.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has also warned of possible impacts in Telangana, south and central Chhattisgarh, eastern Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.

The Army, Navy, Air Force and Indian Coast Guard have kept rescue and relief teams, ships and aircraft ready for deployment. The Coast Guard has escorted vessels and boats to jetties or shore and alerted others to return, officials said. The National Disaster Management Authority and the IMD were monitoring the situation and coordinating with states and central agencies.

Odisha prepares for cyclone

In Odisha, which lies to the northeast of Andhra Pradesh, bounded by it along its southern border, orange alert has been sounded, indicating disruptions, heavy to very heavy rainfall and potential hazards, in Puri, Ganjam, Gajapati, Rayagada, Koraput and Malkangiri districts. Personnel from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), Odisha Disaster Rapid Action Force (ODRAF) and fire services have also been put on alert.

In Ganjam, public access to all beaches, including tourist destinations, has been prohibited while 135 cyclone shelters and 1,600 temporary accommodation centres have been readied for evacuations. The Odisha government ordered closure of schools in Rayagada, Koraput, Nabarangpur, Ganjam and Puri from Tuesday. The Odisha Public Service Commission rescheduled the civil services examination to October 31 and November 5.

CHEETAH SHOT DEAD

on Tuesday morning," she added.

Chief wildlife warden Samita Rajora said the matter was "very sensitive".

"The matter is very sensitive, so a special task force comprising forest and police officers will probe it," she said.

"Following expert consultation, the male cheetah cub was shifted to the Jabalpur university for detailed investigation and intensive treatment. A subsequent CT scan revealed multiple foreign bodies causing damage to his internal organs, musculoskeletal system and nervous system. Despite surgical intervention and sustained efforts by the veterinary team, it could not be saved," Rajora added.

KNG22 was born to Nirva in February 2025.

A local forest official who asked not to be named said that two cheetahs, including KNG22, entered a house on the outskirts of Bamori village in Morena and killed two calves tethered in the courtyard.

"The cries of the calves woke up Somlavir Singh and his wife, who were sleeping in a makeshift shelter nearby. They raised an alarm and alerted other villagers. The cub was found injured later in the day in the forests of Pahargarh range. The cheetah might have been shot by a village resident. A probe is underway," the official added.

This is the first reported attack on a cheetah since the species' reintroduction in India. Under India's cheetah reintroduction programme, eight cheetahs were brought from Namibia in September 2022, followed by 20 from South Africa in February 2023.

Earlier this year, nine more cheetahs were translocated from Botswana.

So far, 58 cubs have been born in Kuno, of which 40 have survived. At present, 52 cheetahs are in Kuno National Park and its surrounding landscape. Four cheetahs are in Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary and two have been shifted to the Virangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve in Damoh district.

The area has been considered one of the most favourable habitats for free-ranging cheetahs.

Wildlife activist Ajay Dubey demanded a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe, alleging that the incident exposed gaps in the forest department's security arrangements .

"It is a serious issue that despite monitoring by 18 teams, a cheetah was shot and left injured. It happened just three months after a poaching gang of leopards was caught in the area. CBI should probe the matter as it involves an international wildlife project," he added.

DELHI S.I.R.

crepancies, had 1,934,243 million people facing the prospect of being struck off over name mismatches, typos, age gaps between parents and applicants, and number of children. Among these, 1,896,675 or 98.05% cases were resolved and kept for inclusion in the final electoral roll, the CEO said.

The second group, no-mapping, comprised 1,379,789 electors who couldn't show sufficiently strong linkages to a name appearing in the 2002 rolls, the base for SIR. Among these, 89.13% or 1,229,901 cases were resolved and kept for inclusion in the final electoral roll, the CEO said.

"There were over 1.9 million cases pertaining to logical discrepancies. Of these, 98% have been resolved. The cases pertaining to non-mapping are also being resolved," a senior poll official said, also on condition of anonymity.

This category of 3.3 million people — which included chief minister Rekha Gupta, former chief minister Arvind Kejriwal, former deputy prime minister LK Advani, external affairs minister S Jaishankar, and election commissioner SS Sandhu — represented a major sticking point with SIR.

After notices were sent following the release of the draft roll, protests broke out as ordinary citizens reported hardships and problems attending hearings over insignificant clerical errors.

Battling mounting criticism, ECI announced sweeping changes in the SIR procedure on September 26, saying voters issued notices "for being unmapped and logical discrepancies" will no longer need to appear for a personal hearing before the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO). Booth Level Officers (BLOs) would visit such voters at home to collect documents, which will be uploaded to the ECINet portal "for decision by the ERO", the poll body said.

A hearing would be held "only in exceptional circumstances, as decided by the ERO," and "preferably" be conducted online, the poll panel said. The commission said "any adult member of the family can be authorised by the elector to attend the hearing on their behalf, if required."

Till then, applicants had to physically appear before EROs on a prescribed date and time to furnish their papers. The facility of home visits was largely limited to the controversial category of VIP voters.

"Further, in light of ECI latest instructions dated 29.9.2026, EROs and AEROs have collected documents and 18,96,675 (98.05%) cases have been resolved and parked for final roll. It is informed that remaining cases of logical discrepancy shall be disposed of shortly. It is further informed that as per ECI guidelines, the notices are to be disposed of by 30.11.2026," the press note said.

The CEO also said it held more than 100,000 special camp sessions across all 14,947 polling stations in the city between September 20 and October 25, in addition to camps held in colleges and universities.

In these sessions, the CEO received 38,849 forms in total. Of these, 27,510 were Form 6 applications for inclusion of names in the electoral roll, 610 were Form 7 applications related to objections against the proposed inclusion of a name, and 10,729 were Form 8 applications for shifting of residence, correction of entries, replacement of voter identity cards and marking of persons with disabilities.

The data showed that 388,429 forms were received since the publication of the draft electoral roll on August 31. This included 267,441 Form 6 applications, 20,074 Form 7 applications and 100,914 Form 8 applications.

The claims and objections period ends on October 30. The CEO's office urged residents to check their names in the draft roll and submit the relevant forms if their names were missing or their details required correction.

SIR began in Delhi on June 30. At the time, the roll comprised 14,510,299 people. The draft electoral roll, published on August 31, contained 9,753,577 electors, dropping nearly 4.76 million people or 32.8% of the pre-SIR roll.

The CEO said booth-level officers were also conducting door-to-door visits to identify eligible voters left out of the draft roll and assist them with enrolment. "ERO/AERO shall not delete any entry/name from the draft electoral roll without giving a fair and reasonable opportunity to the person concerned without opportunity to be heard," the press note said.

BJP scores early victories in MLC polls in UP, Bihar, K'taka

HT Correspondents
letters@hindustantimes.com

LUCKNOW/PATNA/MUMBAI/BENGALURU: Counting of votes was underway on Tuesday for 28 legislative council seats across Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Maharashtra and Karnataka. Voting was held for both Graduates and Teachers constituencies on October 23. Since the votes were cast by ballot, final results were available only for some of the seats.

In Uttar Pradesh, where five Graduates and six Teachers seats went for the polls, BJP's Dinesh Goyal and Shrichand Sharma won the two Meerut seats while the party nominee Dhruv Kumar Tripathi was leading in Gorakhpur, according to the trends and results available till 10pm on Wednesday. BJP's Umesh Dwivedi was leading over Samajwadi Party's Sushil Kumar in the Lucknow Division Teachers' constituency.

Counting of votes underway at a centre in Nagpur. ANI

Samajwadi Party's Lal Bihari Yadav and Akash Agarwal were leading in Varanasi and Agra respectively, according to the trends.

In Bihar where eight seats went to the polls, the ruling NDA is ahead in four seats with the BJP leading in three and the JD(U) in one. BJP's Narendra Prasad Singh has won the Tirhut seat and party candidate Sarvesh Kumar won the Darbhanga Graduates' MLC seat. The party also looked set to win in Patna.

In Kosi, the BJP is leading by 920 votes, while a BJP rebel is ahead in Saran. The Jan Suraaj Party has won the Darbhanga Teachers' constituency, defeating the JD(U) candidate.

In Maharashtra, of the five seats that went to polls, the ruling Mahayuti was leading in the Pune and Amravati teachers' constituencies and the Nagpur graduates' constituency, while the MVA was ahead in the Aurangabad and Pune graduates' constituencies, according to the available trends.

In Karnataka, the BJP-JD(S) alliance candidate AP Ranganath won the Bengaluru Teachers Constituency and BJP's SV Sankanur was ahead of this Congress rival Mohan Limbikai in the West Graduates' constituency.

Mumbai int'l airport network snag: 18 flights delayed, three cancelled

HT Correspondents
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI/MUMBAI: A network failure at Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (CSMIA) on Tuesday evening forced the airport and airlines to process passengers by hand at one of the busiest times of the day, as nearly half the flights due out between 7pm and 9pm left an hour or more late, with some by over two hours.

Of the 44 passenger flights scheduled to leave in that window, 18 took off an hour or more late and three were cancelled, according to Flightradar24 data analysed by HT. Two more were still on the ground at 10.37pm, nearly two hours after their scheduled departure.

The problem began at around 7.05pm, and all processes were switched to manual mode as laid down in protocol, airport officials said. Check-in counters kept working, though slowly, and both IndiGo and Air India flights were affected.

PROBLEM BEGAN AROUND 7.05PM, AND PROCESSES WERE SWITCHED TO MANUAL MODE, AS LAID DOWN IN PROTOCOL, OFFICIALS SAID

In a statement, the Adani Enterprises-controlled CSMIA spokesperson said: "Mumbai Airport experienced a temporary network disruption on Tuesday evening, and teams implemented manual processing measures to minimise inconvenience to passengers and maintain continuity of essential airport operations. So far there has been no impact on airport and flight operations due to this."

Airport's own officials contradicted that account. Speaking on condition of anonymity, they acknowledged that the system was down for about an hour.

The recovery was patchy. At 9.36pm, two and a half hours after the failure began, an official said the system was still fluctuating, though it was moving towards normal.

The automated e-gates at the terminal entrance stopped working, and personnel of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), which guards the airport, had to clear passengers one at a time, people aware of the matter said. A photograph obtained by HT shows passengers waiting near the e-gates while they were out of service. A senior CISF officer said personnel were also trying to pacify angry passengers frustrated by the slow processes.

An airline official, who asked not to be named, said there had been no cancellations or diversions, and flights were delayed by about 40 minutes to an hour on average because check-in and gate procedures were carried out by hand. The disruption had some cascading effect on flights even after the system was restored, the official said.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No. Dy. CE/C/AGC/TN/2026/11 Dated: 26.10.2026
E-Tender Notice
Deputy Chief Engineer(Construction), North Central Railway, Agra Cantt for and on behalf of the President of India invites in **SINGLE PACKET SYSTEM** open tender on prescribed forms online **(E-Tendering).** Tender offer can be submitted on line up to **15.00 hours** of **20.11.2026,** on website **http://www.ireps.gov.in.** The details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: E-Tender Notice No. CEN00AGC1126	**Approx Cost:** Rs. 1.17 Cr. (App.)
Description of work: Maintenance of GC line DHO-GIS section (Km 1290/0-1309/0) section of jurisdiction of SSE/PW/DHO.	
Earnest Money in Rs.: 2,34,100/-	**Completion Period:** 06 Months
Date of opening: 20.11.2026	**Validity:** 60 days

Note:- For complete details and submission of tender please see Indian Railway's website **htpp://www.ireps.gov.in.** **2445/26(K)**
North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)
HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of ESP Spares of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1	**Tender Enquiry No. 211/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018305** **"Procurement of ESP Spares of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"** at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.**
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
GATP-108/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16547

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar, (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in
E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **http://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.
(A)
1. **25/GM(E/M)Sr.M(E/M)-IV/2026-27**, Re-Development of YRF Park infront of Sector 15A as Raj UPVAN (Electrification Work), Noida. Cost Rs. 118.32 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date: 10.11.2026 at 5:00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: 11.11.2026 at 11:00 AM.
General Manager (E&M) Noida
CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

Punjab State AIDS Control Society
Level IV, Prayaas Building, Sector 38-B, Chandigarh
Ph No. 0172-2636802, Fax No. 0172-2636791
E-mail: punjabsacs@gmail.com
Notice Reference No. PSACS/Proc/2026-27/147 **Chandigarh Dated: 27.10.2026**
NOTICE INVITING QUOTATIONS for NSS
The Punjab State AIDS Control Society invites quotations for the Procurement of hospital consumables, diagnostic kits (TPHA Kits), waste management & chemicals, printed stationery, stationery items etc. for NSS 2027 as per details enumerated in request for quotations available on the website **https://punjabsacs.punjab.gov.in/**
Closing Date and Time for submission of quotations: 06.11.2026 by 11.00 A.M. in the Office of procurement division, PSACS
Date of Opening of opening of Quotations: 06.11.2026 at 11.30 A.M. in the Office of procurement division, PSACS.
For detailed information, interested bidders are advised to visit the official website: **https://punjabsacs.punjab.gov.in/**
Note: Any Addendum/Corrigendum(s) to the notice shall be published on the above website only and shall be considered as valid notice to all the interested bidders. No separate communication shall be issued to any bidder in this regard.
Sd/-
PROJECT DIRECTOR
RO NO. 1951/12/2026/27/16546 PSACS

उ.प्र. राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
कार्यालय महाप्रबन्धक (सि0), ए–1/4, लखनपुर, कानपुर
ई–निविदा सूचना
एतद्द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है, कि विभिन्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अन्तर्गत विकास/अनुरक्षण/उच्चीकरण कार्यों हेतु सरकारी विभागों/सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों/नगर निकायों में कार्यरत फर्मो/ठेकेदारों से ई–निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसको अपलोड करने की समयसीमा निम्नवत् है–
क्रमांक 1 पर अंकित कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 28.10.2026 को पूर्वान्ह 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 04.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती हैं, जिन्हें दिनांक 04.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 5:30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अल्पकालिक)
निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल शपथपत्रों की मूल प्रतियों निविदा प्रपत्रों में उल्लिखित दिनांक तक कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकेंगी। ई–निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत् है:–

क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की लागत रू0 (लाख में)
1	Construction of Boundary wall and foot path of park (Only Civil Work) for I.A. Site-B, Surajpur Distt. G.B. Nagar.	168.97

नोटः– निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित दरें अंकित करें। जी0एस0टी0 अलग से देय होगा।
निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की **website: https://beta.upsidamarketplace.com** पर स्थित ई–लिंक एवं यूपीएलसी की **website: http://etender.up.nic.in** पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के **वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक (सिविल) के श्री दीपक सोनकर मोबाइल नं0 9044197166** पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।
महाप्रबन्धक(सि0)
उ0प्र0रा0औ0वि0प्रा0,कानपुर

DIRECTORATE OF TOURISM
GOVERNMENT OF UTTAR PRADESH
PRADESH PARYATAN BHAWAN, C-13, VIPIN KHAND, GOMTI
TENDER - NOTICE
E-BID REFERENCE: CTB/Rural Tourism2
Dated-28/10/2026
"Selection of an Agency for Development, Designing, Printing and Supply of Coffee Table Book on Rural Tourism Across Uttar Pradesh"
The Directorate of Tourism, Government of Uttar Pradesh invites sealed technical and financial proposals for the **"Selection of an Agency for Development, Designing, Printing and Supply of Coffee Table Book on Rural Tourism Across Uttar Pradesh".**
Interested parties may download bid documents from e-tender website http://etender.up.nic.in and submit their proposals with requisite documents on the above e-tender portal before 17/11/2026, 16:00 hours.
The submitted proposals will be open **at 18/11/2026, 12:00 hours** at DoT office, Paryatan Bhawan 4th Floor, C-13, Vipin Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow-226010 Uttar Pradesh, India.
DoT reserves the right to reject any or all the proposals without assigning any reason thereof. For any queries, please respond on email: **publication.upt@gmail.com** on or before the scheduled pre-bid meeting. All subsequent notifications, changes and amendments will be posted only on the website-http://etender.up.nic.in. DoT reserves the right to cancel this invitation and /or invite fresh Bid with or without amendments to this invitation, without liability or any obligation.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
The Sr.DME/Diesel, Northern Railway, Diesel Loco Shed, Tughlakabad for and on behalf of President of India invites e-tenders for the following work. The tender will be accepted online only in the prescribed tender document.

Subject	Description
Name of Work	**Comprehensive Repair/Renewal of 1750 LPM Compressor of Electric locomotives during IOH schedule**
Place of work	Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-110044
Completion Period	02 Years
Approximate cost of work	**Rs.1,40,02,680.63/-** including GST (Rs. One Crore Forty Lakh Two Thousand Six Hundred Eighty and sixty Three Paisa Only)
Amount of Bid Security	**Rs. 2,80,100/-** (Rs. Two Lakh Eighty Thousand One Hundred only)
Technical Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document
Financial Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document
Description of Similar Nature of work	The approved definition of similar nature of work is "Successful completion of Manufacture/Repair/ Rehabilitation/AMC of Compressors of 1750 LPM or above"
Website to download and upload e-tender document	**www.ireps.gov.in**
Due date & time of uploading of Tender by tenderer	**17.11.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.**
Date & Time of Tender opening	**17.11.2026 after 12:00 Hrs.**
Validity of offer	60 days from opening of tender
Allocation	PH-21 (CAP)

Tender Document can be downloaded from Indian Railway website www.ireps.gov.in For details of work experience, scope of work and terms & conditions please see Tender document.
Tender Notice No: TKDD-RSP-1750CPOH-383539
Date: 24.10.2026 **3749/2026**
Serving Customers With A Smile

अजमेर विकास प्राधिकरण, अजमेर
योजना शाखा, विपिन खांडेल, अजमेर, Email :- ajmerada@gmail.com,
Website :- www.rajasthan.gov.in/ada, Tel.No. :- 0145-2627748-2627749
क्रमांक :- अविप्रा/प.2/तकनीकी/2026-27/राजकाज 25109114 दिनांक :- 22/10/2026
E-TENDER - 31/2026-27
Bids for Various Work amounting Rs. 1169-9 Lacs are invited from interested bidders for up to 16.11.2026 6:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on procurement portal **(http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in)** & **(http://sppp.raj.nic.in) http://www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/ada** departmental website.
UBN No. : AJD2627WLOB00165, AJD2627WSOB00166
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12497 Executive Engineer

भारतीय कपास निगम लिमिटेड
THE COTTON CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD
(भारत सरकार का उपक्रम)/(A Government of India Undertaking)
कपास भवन, प्लॉट नं. 3ए, सेक्टर–10, सीबीडी बेलापुर, नवी मुंबई–400614
Kapas Bhavan, Plot-No. 3A, Sector 10, CBD Belapur Navi, Mumbai-400 614
दूरभाष संख्या / **Telephone No. 27579217,** वेबसाइट/**Website: https://cotcorp.org.in**
निविदा सूचना/Tender Notice
The Corporation invites e-Tenders in two bids system having GeM/Tender GEM/2026/B/8204902 & GEM/2026/B/8205802 for Design, Development, Implementation, Operation, Maintenance and Support of 1) "Unified Digital Portal" and 2) "e-Marketplace Portal" under Mission for Cotton Productivity (Kapas Kanti). Detailed terms & conditions and tender documents be downloaded from our website **https://cotcorp.org.in/** and **https://gem.gov.in/**. The last date for submission of tender is 11.00 A.M. on 18.11.2026 & 11.00 A.M. on 19.11.2026 respectively.
Chief General Manager (IT)

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
चतुर्थ वृत्त, लोक निर्माण विभाग, रूद्रपुर (ऊधम सिंह नगर)
फोन– 9756930039, Email : sepwdusn@gmail.com
उत्तराखण्ड शासन
पत्रांक : 2516/23 एम–04/2026 दिनांक : 27.10.2026
राष्ट्रीय प्रतिस्पर्धात्मक ई–निविदा (E-Tendering)
महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तराखण्ड की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, चतुर्थ वृत्त, लो.नि.वि. रूद्रपुर (ऊधम सिंह नगर) द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यो हेतु ई–टेण्डरिंग द्वारा टू–बिड बिड सिस्टम के अन्तर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित सभी सूचनायें वेबसाईट http://www.uktenders.gov.in पर दिनांक 06.11.2026 से उपलब्ध होंगी।

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम	धरोहर धनराशि (लाख में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य (रु. में)	निविदा की वैधता (दिवस)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	ठेकेदार की श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	4	5	6
1.	मा. मुख्यमंत्री घोषणा संख्या 789/2026 के अन्तर्गत जनपद ऊधमसिंह नगर के विधानसभा क्षेत्र गदरपुर के अन्तर्गत झगड़पुर से चुनपुरी होते हुए आबादनगर तक पी.सी. द्वारा पुर्ननिर्माण का कार्य।	2.97	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	भारत सरकार / किसी भी राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी C एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत
2.	मा.मु.घो. सं. 802/2026 के अन्तर्गत विधानसभा क्षेत्र गदरपुर में नेतानगर से राधास्वामी सत्संग होते हुये अमरपुर तक बी.एम./एस.डी.बी.सी. द्वारा सुदृढ़ीकरण एवं आन्तरिक मार्गों का इन्टरलॉकिंग टाईल्स द्वारा निर्माण कार्य। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	10.07	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	भारत सरकार / किसी भी राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी A एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत
3.	संख्या माननीय मुख्यमंत्री घोषणा 805/2026 के अंतर्गत विधान सभा क्षेत्र गदरपुर में श्रीरामपुर से धीमरी ब्लॉक होते हुए चकीमोड तक रोड़ का निर्माण। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	9.40	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	भारत सरकार / किसी भी राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी A एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत
4.	मा. मुख्यमंत्री घोषणा संख्या 661 / 2025 के अंतर्गत जनपद ऊधमसिंह नगर के विधान सभा क्षेत्र गदरपुर के गूलरभोज क्षेत्र मे ग्राम तिलपुरी नंबर 1 के आंतरिक सी.सी. मार्गों एवं नाली निर्माण। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	2.59	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	भारत सरकार / किसी भी राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी C एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत
5.	मा. मुख्यमंत्री घोषणा संख्या 806/ 2026 के अन्तर्गत विधान सभा क्षेत्र धीमरी ब्लॉक से ग्राम श्रीलंका वाली रोड एंव प्रफुल्लनगर तक रोड का निर्माण कार्य। (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	2.56	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	भारत सरकार / किसी भी राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी C एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत
6.	मा. मुख्यमंत्री जी घोषणा संख्या 795/2026 के अंतर्गत जनपद उधम सिंह नगर के विधानसभा क्षेत्र गदरपुर के अन्तर्गत बाबनपुरि गाँव के अंदर से होते हुए गदरपुर मिलकखानम मार्ग तक ईंटरलोकिंग टाइल्स द्वारा मार्ग का निर्माण कार्य (स्वीकृति की प्रत्याशा में)	2.81	5000.00 + 18% GST	90 दिन	12 माह	भारत सरकार / किसी भी राज्य सरकार के विभाग एंव उपक्रम में मार्ग कार्य हेतु श्रेणी C एवं उच्चतर में पंजीकृत

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

YOUR MONEY

Hidden challenges of inheriting wealth

Tracing assets, legal formalities, family disputes and tax implications can complicate inheritance, especially without a will or nomination. Knowing how to navigate these challenges can save time, money and stress

Lisa Pallavi Barbora
letters@hindustantimes.com

PERSONAL FINANCE

MUMBAI: Inherited wealth is often referred to as a windfall gain, until you realise that it comes with transfer formalities, court visits, perhaps a tax incidence, repairs and the decision to sell or not.

If you are the sole inheritor and already have all the details of asset ownership, the process of claiming may be simple. But this isn't always the case. Data from RBI and The Ministry of Finance shows that at least ₹72,454 crore in bank deposits, ₹8,974 crore in insurance and ₹3,749 crore in mutual funds lie unclaimed.

What happens if you don't know of the assets where you are a legal heir and don't know where they are parked?

It's not just about unclaimed assets. Rather, even those that are willed to you need to be managed in a way that doesn't cost thousands of rupees to begin with and months in effort and time.

At the outset, it matters whether you are a nominee, if a well-defined will exists for transfer of assets or there is neither a will nor nomination. This status then defines the process of asset transfer. However, independent of the situation, as a legal heir who must claim assets, the responsibility is yours to complete the process.

What should you do?

First, find everything

If there is a will in place, the list of assets in the will is where you would begin. However, in its absence you have to dig through bank accounts, shares, mutual funds, deposits, provident fund and bonds or any other assets which can be identified in documents left behind by the deceased. Once found, you need to ascertain for each asset whether there is a nominee and proceed from there.

A legal heir can use the unclaimed assets portal (*www.unclaimedassetsportal.in/public/*) to find out if the deceased has any financial assets which are not known to them.

In case of physical assets like property you have to rely on looking through documents, ownership deeds and official land registries, whatever you can find.

Inheritors can get stuck in a quagmire of official documentation and processes if there is no will and no defined list of assets left behind by the deceased.

According to Jitendra Solanki, SEBI RIA and estate planning specialist, "The younger generation of inheritors is learning from experience. Recently, we worked with a sibling duo who have completed the process of helping their 84-year-old mother draft her will. Their father passed away a couple of years ago without one and they had to undergo tedious processes for asset transfers. Now they are being proactive so that the transition in future is smooth."

Claiming financial assets

For financial assets, nomination facility is available which is the first layer for asset transfer. In most cases, nominee is the custodian of funds who then must transfer them to the legal heir, except in case of a beneficial nominee in life insurance where the nominee is the owner of the funds received.

The financial institution will ask for a death certificate, do the required KYC for the documented nominee and then transfer assets into the nominee's account.

Once received, funds should be transferred to the legal heir as per the will. In the absence of a will, transfer happens as per succession law.

"The biggest problem we come across is when a nominee doesn't transfer assets to the legal heir and it becomes a family dispute. This can happen irrespective of the presence of the will," says Solanki.

If you are a legal heir but another family member is the sole nominee, even if there is a will which states that you should receive a share of the financial asset, the nominee may refuse. The way forward often ends in the courts. It's easier for the inheritor if the nomination and the legal heirs in the will are aligned.

In the absence of both a will and nomination, it becomes an intestate succession. Legal heirs must obtain a legal heir certificate proving their position or a succession certificate.

Asset distribution is then governed by the deceased's personal succession law, according to the religion followed.

This process can be long drawn out and could take a lot of time and effort. Transfer of financial assets with a valid and aligned nomination plus will is the smoothest and can happen in a matter of weeks.

Transfer of physical assets

This is where transition of assets, particularly in the absence of a will, gets complicated. There is no nomination for property so it's only the will or succession act that applies. Will can be an easier process but even then, there might be challenges. One may need to probate the will along with showing a legal heir certificate and succession certificate, and this can be a costly affair.

Family disputes invariably arise in case of property transfer. For one, a no-objection certificate must be signed by all legal heirs even if the property has been willed to a particular heir.

Sharing the troubles of a family they worked with, Solanki says, "The husband passed away leaving behind property that needed to be sold, but there was no will. He was succeeded by his wife and an adult, neuro-disabled son. She couldn't sell the property by herself as the court recognised her son as a legal heir too, but given his condition he was not able to sign any documents. In order to sell the property, his wife had to first become her son's legal guardian and only then could she go ahead."

Sometimes, there is no alternative and an inheritor must be prepared to face a long process which requires effort and money. It can be emotionally draining at a time which is already a difficult personal transition.

Don't rush to redeem assets

While we are only discussing the financial fallout of death, let's recognise that it's also a time of grief. Grief driven financial decision making might be too quick and lacking clarity. Allow yourself to feel the emotions of grief without having to make any rushed financial decisions.

Once assets are transferred, wait a few months before transacting. The pause may bring clarity on the way ahead. Selling assets can have a tax impact which you will have to bear.

According to CA Mayank Mohanka, partner, SM Mohanka and Associates, "Anything received in inheritance is excluded from the definition of 'transfer' and not liable to being taxed. But if there is a gain on subsequent sale of these assets, tax liability gets triggered. If you inherit and sell the asset, the cost of acquisition is not taken as zero. The previous owner's holding period is also taken into consideration to determine whether the gains qualify as long term or short term capital gains."

If you are selling house property, then reinvesting proceeds in a manner that is tax efficient is also important (refer to this Your Money article *www.hindustantimes.com/business/beyond-80c-smarter-ways-to-save-on-taxes-101789038743099.html*).

It's easier to hold on to financial assets. In case of property with multiple heirs or high maintenance costs, it may not make sense to wait.

Plus, along with assets, debts can also be inherited and you may need money to pay those off. Ultimately, the decision to sell or hold will also be dictated by the family dynamics and diversity of assets.

Filing returns

For any income accrued, pre-death, on the inherited assets, income tax return should be filed under the deceased's name. "The legal heir of the deceased is required to file the last return of the deceased, on their behalf — if the return filing threshold gets triggered — even if they haven't inherited the asset," says Mohanka.

However, any income that comes from inherited assets after death should be reflected in your income tax return.

Inheriting assets or wealth is rarely the hard part, the thousands of crores lying unclaimed across financial assets tells you that perhaps claiming assets and managing them is where families could lose both time and money.

Don't rush, but also don't freeze. It's important to find the assets, establish claim and then thoughtfully make any transactions or financial decisions with your inheritance.

Lisa Pallavi Barbora is a freelance writer and author of Money & Her

NAVIGATING THE INHERITANCE MAZE

TABLE 1

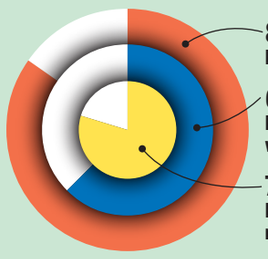
Intergenerational wealth expected to transition in India over the coming decade

$1.3-1.5 trillion

Source: India Family Office Playbook, Now, Next and Beyond - Julius Baer & EY

Without a basic plan in place, transfer of assets can cost both time and money

A survey of Indian households covering 1,218 individuals across at least 20 cities has found:



84.80% No will in place

62.50% No plans to create a will

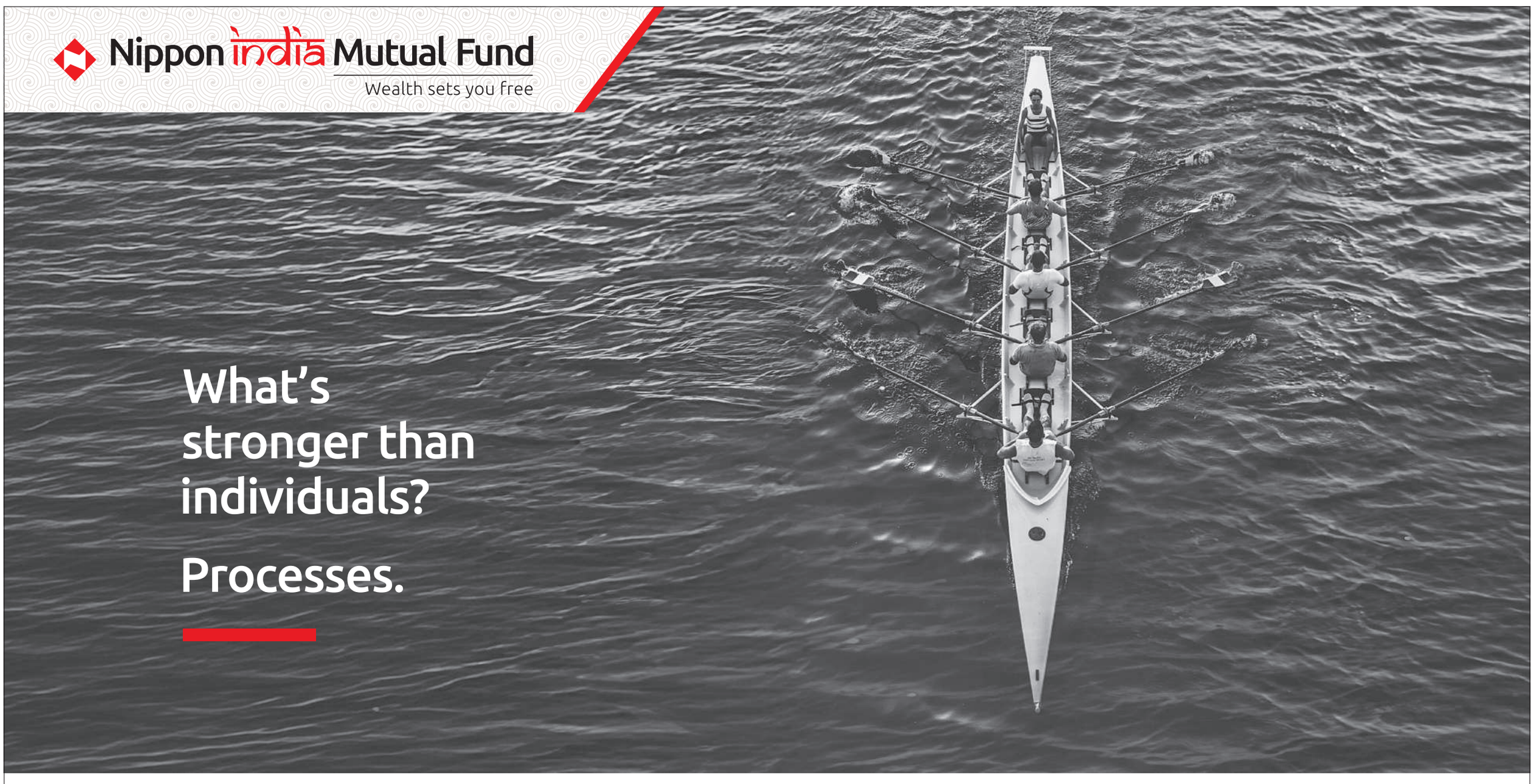
79.80% Expect to inherit, but no will of their own

Source: 1Finance

FOUR TAX RULES EVERY HEIR SHOULD KNOW

1. India has no inheritance tax, and receiving an inheritance is not taxed as a gift.
2. When you sell, the original owner's purchase cost is your cost.
3. The original owner's holding period counts towards long-term status for gains.
4. Rent, interest and dividends received from inherited assets after death, are taxable in the heir's hands.

Illustration: Malay Karmakar



Individuals may change, processes stay consistent.

Tried and tested processes are fundamental to an organisation's success, as they clearly define how things are done. That's why it is imperative to choose an investment manager backed by strong processes, not just by competent individuals.

Strong processes and risk management help you achieve your goals steadily and sustainably.

mf.nipponindiaim.com/EdgeOfKnowledge

Contact your Mutual Fund Distributor or Investment Advisor I Give us a missed call on **8000112244**

An investor education and awareness initiative of Nippon India Mutual Fund.

Helpful Information for Mutual Fund Investors: All Mutual Fund investors have to go through a one-time KYC (Know Your Customer) process. Investors should deal only with registered mutual funds, to be verified on SEBI website under 'Intermediaries/Market Infrastructure Institutions'. For redressal of your complaints, you may please visit https://scores.sebi.gov.in. For more info on KYC, change in various details and redressal of complaints, visit mf.nipponindiaim.com/investoreducation/what-to-know-when-investing

Nippon India Mutual Fund, MF/022/95/1

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

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The Hindustan Times
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{ OUR TAKE }

ECI must explain procedural lapses

ECI affidavit in SC clears the air on motives, but leaves key procedural changes in SIR unexplained

The Election Commission of India (ECI)'s affidavit in the Supreme Court highlights the consensus and unanimity behind the poll body's decisions, and argues that its intentions behind ordering both the special intensive revision (SIR) and several changes in the contentious exercise were honourable and in line with its constitutional remit. The reply, which goes some way towards clarifying the motives of the body, leaves key procedural changes unexplained.

On SIR, the affidavit says all decisions were taken unanimously by three election commissioners (ECs) and that suggestions, queries, or objections during deliberations didn't count as decisions. It clarifies that letters by two ECs to the cabinet secretary concerned an internal work order that was never implemented after another July 30 decision. On the question of motive, ECI presents a credible case. But it never answers procedural queries around who ordered the changes, whether objections raised by ECs were addressed, or how the constant tweaks in SIR procedure evolved.

On Form 6, the statutory application used for enrolling new voters, ECI said the additional declaration was a separate document, and not a modification of the requirements laid down under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960. But its admission that the way it appeared online "could be construed as though an amendment of Form 6 had been made" and that "certain steps taken by the officers" needed "to be corrected" raises more questions, especially against the backdrop of earlier ECI communication that said the "declaration attached to Form 6 for SIR has been upheld by the Hon'ble Supreme Court". This newspaper has reported that the declaration before the apex court was a different one. On West Bengal, ECI admitted that the state chief electoral officer (CEO) filed 1.6 million appeals before judicial tribunals to delete voters. But it doesn't answer who authorised these appeals or whether each case — already cleared by a judicial officer — was individually evaluated.

Motives are important (apart from being the focus of protests and legal challenges by the opposition parties). But equally important are procedures and deliberations that formulate them. For a gargantuan exercise such as SIR, procedural hardships can make the difference between holding the right to vote and losing it. Procedural violations can have real-world consequences, seen most tragically in Bengal where 2.71 million people were disenfranchised for simply running out of time. In recent weeks, ECI has done well in simplifying processes and relaxing onerous conditions for verification, but it cannot elide the questions raised by the harassment of millions of ordinary Indians, who deserve a fuller and more transparent explanation. As the custodian of the world's largest democracy, ECI must aspire to a higher standard and set the record straight.

India's supply-demand dilemma in fuel blending

On Monday, the Centre announced amendments to India's motor vehicle rules for the rollout of E100 cars which run entirely on ethanol. To be sure, there is nothing really drastic about the new rules as even the earlier rules allowed for E85 vehicles which use fuel with 85% ethanol blending. The announcement seeks to fill a gap in automobile market amid concerns about the compatibility of cars with blended fuel. The government has denied that such a problem exists. The new "flexi-fuel" vehicle category will give customers an option to consume blended fuel. So far, so good.

What our policy makers seem to be missing is the other side of the picture. It is not enough to tweak automobile norms to ensure that cars generating demand for ethanol-based fuel will now be produced in India. What is also needed is careful thought on whether India has the wherewithal to scale up its supply of ethanol for fuel use. Doing so will require diverting crops such as sugarcane, corn, or rice toward ethanol production for fuel blending. This entails diverting production currently used for food (sugarcane or rice) or feed (corn) within the country. The experience so far suggests that the diversion can potentially trigger a supply squeeze on food and feed use if demand for fuel use starts rising. The choice, whether or not we have thought about it carefully, can be between tolerating food inflation and saving foreign exchange spent on procuring imported crude oil.

To be sure, there is nothing fundamentally wrong with promoting the idea of fuel blending. But doing this well requires acing both the demand (cars) and supply (agricultural production) side issues.

Undoing a 50-year-old damage to federalism

The 42nd Amendment to the Constitution, passed in November 1976, remains the most durable instrument of centralisation

Fifty years on, the experiment of 1976 has failed: Centralisation has delivered neither excellence nor equity, and has left the states answerable for education without being in charge of it. REUTERS

Mukund P Unny

On November 2, 1976, the Lok Sabha passed the Constitution (42nd Amendment) Bill by 366 votes to four. Opposition leaders such as Morarji Desai, Charan Singh, Atal Bihari Vajpayee, and LK Advani had been jailed under the Emergency, and the House was sitting on a self-extended term. Indira Gandhi called the amendment "responsive to the aspirations of the people and reflects the realities of the present time and the future."

Remembered for adding "socialist" and "secular" to the Preamble, the "mini-Constitution" left a far less discussed mark on India's federal architecture. Today's Union-state disputes over the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET), vice-chancellor appointments, and delimitation — all trace back to 1976. The Janata government repaired the Emergency's damage to civil liberties but left its damage to federalism in place, making the 42nd Amendment the most durable instrument of centralisation in our Constitution.

Acting on the Swaran Singh Committee's recommendations, the amendment moved five subjects out of the State List. Education (Entry 11) was folded into Entry 25 of the Concurrent List. Forests and the protection of wild animals and birds became Entries 17A and 17B, weights and measures became Entry 33A, and the administration of justice and the constitution of courts below the High Courts became Entry 11A. Entry 2A of the Union List and Article 257A empowered the Union to deploy its armed forces in any state without its request. The allocation of seats in the Lok Sabha and the state assemblies was frozen on the basis of the 1971 Census. The states sought none of this, and the ratification required under the proviso to Article 368(2) came in a year when the Union had already dismissed the DMK government in Tamil Nadu under Article 356, on January 31, 1976.

The Janata Party went to the polls in 1977 promising to "restore the Constitution to the condition it was in before the Emergency". The 44th Amendment deleted Article 257A that empowered the Union to deploy armed forces in states for law and order maintenance. Yet no amendment returned education, forests, or the administration of justice to the states, and Entry 2A remains in the Union List to this day. The Sarkaria Commission later recommended consultation with the states on Concurrent List subjects but it has rarely happened.

Nowhere is the legacy of 1976 sharper than in education. Even before the transfer, Entry 66 of the Union List let Parliament coordinate and determine standards in higher education, which was all the uniformity the framers thought necessary. Moving the entire field to the Concurrent List turned a power of coordination into a power of control. In mature federations such as the US, Canada, Australia, and Germany, education remains with the states, but India has moved from a decentralised constitutional framework to a substantially centralised one. NEET has been a contentious issue right from its inception. States that build, fund, and staff their own medical colleges can no longer decide how students are selected for them, and must surrender a share of their seats to a national pool. The same logic now reaches university governance. Regulation 7.3 of the UGC Regulations 2018 requires a UGC nominee on the search committee for every vice-chancellor, and the Supreme Court held that the Regulations prevail over state university Acts. Subordinate legislation framed by an unelected body thus overrides laws passed by elected state legislatures. The conditional grant of PM-SHRI funds under the National Education Policy is another affront to educational federalism. Much of this centralisation has come not through further amendments but through regulations, conditional grants and executive diktats. BR Ambedkar had foreseen exactly this danger, warning the Constituent Assembly on November 4, 1948 that "it is perfectly possible to pervert the Constitution, without changing its form by merely changing the form of the administration and to make it inconsistent and opposed to the spirit of the Constitution." Fifty years on, the experiment of 1976 has failed: Centralisation has delivered neither excellence nor equity, and has left the states answerable for education without being in charge of it.

The other big problem that stems from the amendment law is its impact on delimitation. The delimitation freeze, meant to protect states that curbed population growth, is the one provision of 1976 that the states now want to keep. The 84th Amendment, 2001, extended it until the first census after 2026. With population enumeration for Census 2027 due to finish by March 1, 2027, that condition will soon be met, and the 106th Amendment, 2023, has tied women's reservation to the delimitation exercise. Ironically, a freeze enacted by a centralising amendment is now the southern states' last defence against losing their voice in Parliament. Will the Union consult the states before it redraws the map, or will the decision be made, as in 1976, by a brute majority?

As Nani Palkhivala put it, "The Centre is nothing but the states in their federal garb," and "a strong Union can only be a Union of strong states." The 50th anniversary is an occasion for the Union to place the Seventh Schedule changes of 1976 before the Inter-State Council under Article 263, and to consult the states before legislating on the subjects it took. Until then, the Emergency's blow to federalism will outlive all conversations about the Emergency itself.

Mukund P Unny is an advocate-on-record at the Supreme Court. The views expressed are personal

Artificial intelligence and the friction paradox

Those of us who learned to drive before smartphones will remember getting lost. A wrong turn meant stopping to ask a shopkeeper for directions and eventually finding the right road back, and knowing the city a little better for it. Today, Google Maps tells us where to turn, and we arrive knowing almost nothing about the roads we took. Researchers at McGill University found that heavy GPS users had poorer spatial memory when they had to find their way unaided. This trade, an easier time today for a weaker skill tomorrow, is not new. What is new is its scale. And, GPS merely does our navigating, but artificial intelligence (AI) offers to do our thinking and knowledge gathering. This is the friction paradox: The effort we are so eager to remove is often what makes us capable.

The clearest evidence of this comes from a classroom. Researchers at the University of Pennsylvania studied nearly 1,000 high-school students in Turkey learning mathematics. Those who practised with ChatGPT solved far more problems correctly. But in the exam, without the chatbot, they scored 17% worse than classmates who never used AI. Parents understand this instinctively; it is why we don't do our children's homework for them.

Ravi Venkatesan

Evidence shows that beginners gain the most from AI, and also lose the most. In a large study of customer-service agents, AI raised the productivity of the least experienced by about a third while barely helping veterans. Yet, an experienced agent can sense when a customer's patience is running out and recognise when the standard fix will not work, and escalate early, whereas a novice may not.

The efficient shortcut that is harmless for the expert can hollow out the novice. Socrates warned that writing would ruin memory, and teachers worried that calculators would erode mental arithmetic. We survived both. But a calculator does not need oversight. AI can confidently give wrong answers, and only human judgment catches them. That is the very skill we stop building when the machine does the work. In 2009, the autopilot on Air France Flight 447 switched off over the Atlantic after ice blocked its speed sensors. The pilots, who rarely flew manually at that altitude, made a series of errors, leading to the plane crashing and killing all 228 people on board. Automation removed daily practice, then handed control back to people at the moments that demand the most skill.

Medicine is already seeing this. Polish specialists who had grown used to an AI system for spotting early signs of bowel cancer found fewer such growths when working without it, their detection rate falling from about 28% to 22% within months.

Ask accomplished leaders what shaped them, and they invariably talk about overcoming big challenges such as the project that failed or the year everything went wrong. Warren Bennis called these experiences "crucibles"; overcoming hard challenges shapes character and builds capabilities and resilience. But hardship can break some people even as others grow stronger. The difference is in whether a person has already faced smaller hardships. The worry is that AI will remove the hundreds of small trials that prepare young people for bigger ones. Those small trials usually happen in a first job. India's IT services industry has been one of the world's largest apprenticeship systems, where young engineers from small towns wrote routine code, tested other people's software and slowly learned how real work gets done. That routine work is exactly what AI does best. Stanford economists found that since generative AI arrived, employment of 22-25-year-olds in the most exposed jobs has fallen about 13% relative to less exposed work, while older workers have been largely untouched. Each company that trims junior hiring is acting sensibly. If all of them do, where will the senior people of 2040 come from?

However, not all friction is worth keeping. The weeks that small entrepreneurs lose chasing licences and waiting on inspectors build nothing but frustration, and all of this should go. But the same entrepreneur pitching to a sceptical customer or investor, failing, and then figuring out why is becoming more capable. An AI tool that writes the entrepreneur the perfect pitch would make her first year easier and the later years worse. The test of good friction is whether an effort builds something in the person making it. If not, eliminate it. If yes, think hard before automating it, especially for beginners.

The Turkish study gives hope. Students given a chatbot designed as a tutor that offered hints rather than answers did about as well in the exam as those who hadn't used AI. The problem is not AI, but how it is set up. Schools should make students attempt a problem before the machine does, and judge learning by what they can do unaided. Boards should ask management, "If we hire fewer juniors, how are you going to grow our future leaders?" And AI companies should design AI as a tutor, not the machine churning out answers, for students and new workers.

The difficulty is that the savings from removing friction are visible at once, while the lost capability surfaces years later and nobody yet knows how to measure this. Unless we choose deliberately, the paradox can hollow out humanity. Our lives will get easier, and we will become less capable.

Evidence shows that beginners gain the most from AI, and also lose the most. The efficient shortcut that is harmless for the expert can hollow out the novice. REUTERS

Ravi Venkatesan is the former chairman of Microsoft India and founder of GAME Global Alliance for Mass Entrepreneurship). The views expressed are personal

{ FRIEDRICH MERZ } CHANCELLOR, GERMANY

We will be better equipped to build balanced relations with China if we ourselves are united, strong, resilient, innovative and competitive... Wise China policy begins at home

On building relations with Asian nations to counter China

Towards transparent welfare spending, with digital rupee

The Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana (PMGKAY) — with over 800 million beneficiaries — is the largest food security programme in the world. In most parts of the country, the Centre routes food grains to the beneficiary through the Fair Price Shop (FPS) network. But, in 2015-16, Chandigarh, Puducherry and the urban pockets of Dadra & Nagar Haveli chose to discharge the entitlement in cash, credited directly into the beneficiary's bank account, equivalent in value to the free foodgrain they would have otherwise drawn from FPS.

However, once cash leaves the government's books through Direct Benefits Transfer (DBT), it carries no trace of what it was actually utilised for, with no way for the government to confirm that it had been used for the intended purpose.

Sanjeev Chopra

This is the limitation that the Digital Rupee — RBI's Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) — has allowed the government to finally address. CBDC has been deployed to improve upon the DBT architecture. Unlike ordinary DBT, a CBDC token can be programmed to be redeemable only against food grains, with a defined validity window, and only against a wallet that is actively linked to an Aadhaar-verified household. The Digital Rupee leaves a continuous, auditable trail, from the Consolidated Fund of India (CFI) to the point of redemption.

This year, the three UTs migrated from the DBT model to CBDC-based disbursal. Because every wallet must be actively authenticated against an Aadhaar-linked beneficiary before a CBDC token can be credited, the migration has functioned as a continuous, non-intrusive confirmation that the entitlement is reaching and being utilised by an actual household each month.

With the adoption of CBDC, funds that would otherwise take time to clear through the banking system are credited to the beneficiary's digital wallet in real time, with each transaction recorded permanently against the CFI. For beneficiaries, this has meant fewer disputes over whether a transfer was actually made.

CBDC wallets have been enabled on feature phones as well, through SMS- and USSD-based channels, so a beneficiary needs only a basic handset to receive, hold and redeem the Digital Rupee. This keeps the facility within reach of the very households PMGKAY is meant to serve. In practice, redeeming or checking a CBDC token takes little more than confirming a transaction on the wallet, with the credit and a receipt appearing instantly, the same everyday familiarity that users of the UPI report more broadly has now been extended to the PDS.

If the above UTs demonstrate what CBDC can do for a cash-based transfer, Gujarat is demonstrating what it can do when food grains are distributed physically. The overwhelming majority of PMGKAY beneficiaries continue to receive their entitlement in kind, through FPS. It is the integration of digital tokens with this model that Gujarat was chosen to pilot.

The Gujarat pilot rests on two distinct innovations. The first is tokenisation: The subsidy value due against each transaction is issued not as pre-funded cash, but as a digital token — a purpose-bound, non-transferable claim on the CFI that exists only for the duration of that specific transaction and is extinguished the moment it is redeemed. The second is Just-in-Time (JIT) settlement: Rather than positioning funds across the supply chain months in advance against anticipated demand, tokens are generated and settled with the FPS dealer at the point of actual sale, matched precisely to the quantity of foodgrain actually lifted and sold. Tokenisation supplies the traceability, and JIT supplies the timing — they replace a system of advance, undifferentiated cash float with one of exact, auditable, transaction-linked settlement.

The CBDC token enables the beneficiaries to know their household's monthly entitlement of food grains and the subsidy borne by the Centre. Immediately upon completion, an online receipt is generated on the beneficiary's mobile detailing the transaction, ensuring complete transparency and accountability of the FPS dealer.

As the model moved toward a full state-wide rollout, it also flagged a further structural saving: CBDC-based settlement removes the need for parallel ePoS and eKYC infrastructure at the FPS level altogether. Once CBDC achieves 100% coverage in a State, the ePoS machine becomes redundant, since the token itself carries the authentication and the audit trail that ePoS devices are meant to provide.

Ten more states have already begun the next phase of CBDC rollout.

The Jan Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile architecture that underpins over 580 million bank accounts and the real-time payment rails that today carry roughly half of the world's UPI transaction volume have made a programmable rupee possible that can be placed directly in the hands of a ration cardholder or a FPS dealer. One Nation One Ration Card removed the geography of entitlement; CBDC is now removing its opacity.

Sanjeev Chopra is secretary, Food and Public Distribution, Government of India. The views expressed are personal

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Finally, Kane gets world recognition

The England captain pips Mbappe and Yamal to become the first English player in 25 years to win the coveted Ballon d'Or

Aditya Maheshwari
aditya.maheshwari@htdigital.in

NEW DELHI: Harry Kane is a story of perseverance and hard work. The 33-year-old is also a team player; as a child he was ready to even play in goal. He had to wait 15 years for his major trophy. And now, in his fourth season at Bayern Munich, he is a Ballon d'Or winner, one who has ended a 25-year wait for England. "It feels really, really like a dream," said Kane.

His journey nearly ended before it could begin. With dreams of being a professional footballer, Kane went for trials at Arsenal. He was rejected. Next stop: Tottenham Hotspur, Arsenal's North London rivals. Rejected again.

"He was chubby, not very athletic, and we got it wrong," Liam Brady, the former Ireland international who was Arsenal's academy coordinator at the time, admitted in a 2018 interview with "Corriere della Sera."

The Arsenal snub spurred him on. "I was only eight when they let me go, but every time we played them, I thought: 'Alright, we'll see who's right and who's wrong'," he wrote in The Players' Tribune. Kane has 16 career goals against Arsenal. Kane returned to Ridgeway Rovers before joining Watford's youth set-up. From there, he went for a six-week trial at Tottenham and was initially cast-off. The best way to get noticed by a club is to score against them and Kane did that. A hattrick for Watford against Tottenham forced a rethink and Kane was signed by them. He was 11.

It was the start of a relationship that survived a number of loan periods and lasted 19 years. Kane made his senior team debut against Heart of Midlothian in the Europa League in August 2011. His first Premier League appearance came one year later, against Newcastle. By the time Kane left for Bayern Munich in 2023 as Bundesliga's most expensive signing, he had scored 280 goals for Tottenham. No one has as many.

When he moved, Kane was also England's leading scorer overtaking Wayne Rooney's tally of 53. That tally has grown to 91 international goals and at 125 caps, Kane has equalled the England record with Peter Shilton.

But even after the goals and records, a major trophy continued to elude Kane. A runners-up medal from the 2019 Champions League where Tottenham lost to Liverpool was the closest he had come.

It was getting to him. Both sides of Manchester wanted him but it didn't work out and he joined Bayern Munich who needed a striker to replace Robert Lewandowski.

Kane settled into the role with little trouble. Scoring goals was never a problem for him, whether for club or country, and at Bayern, he finally began to experience team success. Serial Bundesliga winners Bayern were thwarted by Xavi Alonso's Bayer Leverkusen in Kane's first season but since then he has won the league in 2024-25 and 2025-26. "The club and Harry Kane have got together, grown together and achieved the highest aims together," said Bayern president Herbert Hainer.

Even by his high standards, last season was extraordinary for Kane. He scored 73 goals and has eight assists for club and country, finished as Europe's top scorer, and broke records in Germany for Bayern Munich and captained England to a third-place finish. En route, Kane also became England's most successful goalscorer in World Cup finals. He has 14, four more than previous record holder Gary Lineker. Kane has played three World Cups, Lineker two.

But there is much more to Kane than goals. He has emerged leader at Bayern and has led England since 2018. He can play No.9 and often No.10 dropping deep to draw away markers and create space for his teammates. In the Champions League match against Arsenal last week, Opta said Kane was the first player to have scored, assisted and taken a goalkick in the competition since detailed data began to be maintained in 2003-04.

"I ran out of superlatives to describe your performances a long time ago, but I'm delighted to see that you have now been formally recognised by the football world," said England head coach Thomas Tuchel.

Michael Owen was the last English player to win the Ballon, in 2001. Only one player from England, Kevin Keegan, has won it twice. Between 2008 and 2017, it was shared between Lionel Messi and Cristiano Ronaldo. Messi won it thrice more since to take his tally to eight; Ronaldo has five.

It's still small returns for a country that birthed organised football, framed the rules and runs the world's best league. English players were often behind their counterparts from Spain, Germany and Brazil. Or a Croat. The Messi-Ronaldo duopoly was ended by Luka Modric in 2018.

Like Messi, Ronaldo and Modric, Kane's career is unlikely to end any time soon. He has enough to spur him on: the Champions League and a major trophy for England are but two.

> Anything is possible with hard work, when no one else is watching, to go through the ups and downs, to learn through resilience, determination and self-belief
>
> **HARRY KANE,** after receiving the Ballon d'Or

Kane aces the number game

61 Kane's 61 goals for Bayern last season was the highest by a player in Europe's top five leagues. Mbappe finished second with 42 goals. This was also the second-highest tally in Bayern after Gerd Muller — 66 goals in 1972-73.

5 Kane's 5 hat-tricks across all competitions for Bayern is more than any other player in Europe's top five leagues.

2 Only two other players have scored at least 61 goals in a season for a club in Europe's top five leagues this century: Cristiano Ronaldo (61 goals in 2014-15) and Lionel Messi (73 in 2011-12).

73 Kane finished the season with 73 goals in 65 games for club and country. Messi remains the only player to have scored more in a single season, having netted 82 in 2011-12.

FOR BAYERN MUNICH

	M	Goals (Assists)
Bundesliga	31	36 (5)
Champions League	13	14 (2)
DFB Pokal	6	10
DFL Supercup	1	1

WORLD CUP (INCL QUALIFIERS)

	M	Goals (Assists)
World Cup (2026)	7	6 (1)
World Cup Qualifiers (2025-26)	8	8

ENGLISH BALLON D'OR WINNERS

- Stanley Matthews (1956) Blackpool
- Bobby Charlton (1966) Manchester United
- Kevin Keegan (1978, 1979) Hamburg
- Michael Owen (2001) Liverpool
- Harry Kane (2026) Bayern Munich

MEN'S BALLON D'OR
Harry Kane
(Bayern Munich and England)

WOMEN'S BALLON D'OR
Alexia Putellas
(Barcelona and Spain)

WOMEN'S CLUB OF THE YEAR
Barcelona

MEN'S CLUB OF THE YEAR
Paris Saint-Germain

WOMEN'S COACH OF THE YEAR
Pere Romeu
(Barcelona)

MEN'S COACH OF THE YEAR
Luis de La Fuente
(Spain)

Starc takes six as Australia fight back

CAPE TOWN: Mitchell Starc took four wickets in six balls to cap an Australian fightback on Day 1 of the third Test against South Africa at Newlands. Starc finished with 6/72 as South Africa were bowled out for 329 shortly before the close in a match to decide a series between the two leading WTC nations.

Bad light robs India A of win over NZ A

LINCOLN: Pacer Auqib Nabi bowled an incisive opening spell but bad light prevented India A from a sensational come-from-behind win over New Zealand A. Chasing 313, NZ A struggled against Nabi (3/28). NZ A were 187/9 with 17 overs left when play was stopped.

Aditya wins World U19 Boxing gold

NEW DELHI: Aditya was on Tuesday crowned the men's 55kg champion at the World Boxing U-19 Championships in Budva, Montenegro. The Indian boxer fought back after narrowly losing the opening round to beat Islam Magomedov of Russia 4:1 in the summit clash. India finished with a gold, one silver and two bronze medals.

HC halts BFI SGM called by secretary

NEW DELHI: The Punjab and Haryana High Court directed Boxing Federation of India secretary general Pramod Kumar to keep the SGM scheduled for Wednesday in abeyance until the next hearing on Nov 13, following a petition filed by federation president Ajay Singh.

Indian wrestler Kajal Dhochak. WFI

Kajal and Neelam enter final of World Wrestling C'ships, assure medals

HT Correspondent
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India's Kajal Dhochak (76kg) and Neelam Sirohi (50kg) stormed into their respective finals of the ongoing wrestling World Championships in Astana on Tuesday, making it the first occasion of two Indian women making the Worlds final. The only other Indian woman wrestler to reach the World Championships final before these two was Anshu Malik (57kg) who returned with a silver medal from Oslo in 2021.

Kajal, 18, pulled off a stunning 10-7 comeback win over seasoned Kyrgyzstan wrestler Aiperi Medet Kyzy in the 76kg semi-final to set up the summit clash against Ukraine's Anastasiya Alpyeyeva. Having survived a pin attempt early in the bout and trailing 1-7 at the end of the first period, Kajal launched a spirited counter-attack in the second half to complete a remarkable win.

A transformed wrestler in the second period, Kajal began the turnaround with a couple of two-point throws in quick succession to reduce the deficit to 5-7.

Egged on by coach Virender Dahiya from the sidelines, Kajal effected a double-leg attack, again initiated from the side, to nose ahead at 8-7 and followed it with another takedown to seal a memorable 10-7 victory on her senior Worlds debut. Kajal, a two-time U20 world champion, cupped her face and broke down on the mat while her opponent lay flat on the mat in disbelief.

In the morning session, Kajal produced a convincing 9-2 victory over Mongolia's Davaanasan Enkh Amar after recording a 'win by fall' over Lithuania's Kamile Griskiene Gaucaite.

In the 50kg division, 26-year-old Neelam defeated Kazakhstan's Zeinep Bayanova 7-3 to set up a title clash with Japanese great Yui Susaki. The Indian blanked Belarus' Natallia Varakina 6-0 in her pre-quarterfinal and advanced to the last four after top seed Russian Elizaveta Smirnova withdrew from the quarters due to an injury.

Kajal and Neelam now have an opportunity to turn a historic day for Indian women's wrestling into a first world title.

Rajnita in medal hunt

Meanwhile, Rajnita pulled off an upset in the 65kg category, stunning 2024 World silver medallist Kateryna Zelenykh 8-6 in a qualification bout. She later lost her pre-quarterfinal bout by technical superiority to Moldova's Irina Ringaci.

Ringaci run to the final gave Rajnita a shot at bronze medal through the repechage route where she will face Japan's Nana Ikehata. Neha Sharma advanced to the pre-quarterfinals of the women's 57kg category with a hard-fought 4-2 win over Algeria's Achouak Djamila Tekouk but went down 1-4 to Belarus' Iryna Kurachkna in the next round and was eliminated.

India's Greco-Roman wrestlers drew a blank with only Lalit (55kg) making the medal round while the others cut a sorry figure. The men's freestyle competitions will begin on October 30 with Asian Games gold medallist Sujeet Kalkal (65kg) leading the charge.

WESTERN RAILWAY-RATLAM
E-TENDER NOTICE
Sr. No.: 1. **E-tender No.:** RTM-2026-27-116. **Name of Work:** Chanderia-Ratlam-Khandwa Section-Improvement of road surface by providing rubberized surface at Total 24 nos. **Approx. Quantity:** As per Tender Schedule. **Approx value Rs.:** 4,09,57,623.00. **Earnest Money in Rs.:** 8,19,200.00. **Cost of Tender Form Rs.:** Nil. **Completion period:** 15 Months. **Date of uploading on website:** 26.10.2026. **Date of opening & time at:** 18.11.2026. **Sr. No.:** 2. **E-tender No.:** RTM-2026-27-117. **Name of Work:** Chittorgarh-Infrastructure Facility for Termination and STR Examination of Trains, including Pathway, Rolling In/Out Hut, Lighting, CCTV, and T & P & 2. Shambhupura Provision of Hardonite Flooring in SMP ROH Shed at Wagon Depot & CCTV at Freight Examination line RTM, SMP. **Approx. Quantity:** As per Tender Schedule. **Approx value Rs.:** 2,32,99,028.83. **Earnest Money in Rs.:** 4,66,000.00. **Cost of Tender Form Rs.:** Nil. **Completion period:** 12 Months. **Date of uploading on website:** 26.10.2026. **Date of opening & time at:** 18.11.2026. Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria and terms and conditions are available at Website **www.ireps.gov.in**. 0307
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कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता उ0प्र0 पावर ट्रांसमिशन कारपोरेशन लिमिटेड विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल, लाल डिग्गी, अलीगढ़
ई-निविदा/जैम निविदा सूचना
अनुभवी कार्यकर्ता/आपूर्तिकर्ता / निर्माता फर्मों से निम्नलिखित ई-निविदा दो भागों में 12:00 बजे तक आमन्त्रित की जाती है जो उसी दिन 14:00 बजे खोली जायेगी। विस्तृत विवरण समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशन के उपरान्त ई-टेण्डर की बेबसाईट **www.etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध रहेगा तथा अन्य किसी भी प्रकार के संशोधन / तिथि विस्तार हेतु निविदा खुलने की तिथि तक लॉग ऑन करें। किसी भी निविदा को बिना कारण बताये निरस्त/अस्वीकार करने का अधिकार अधोहस्ताक्षरी के पास सुरक्षित रहेगा।
ईटीसी-42/2026-27 220 के0वी0 उपकेन्द्र, हरदुआगंज पर पैनल एवं सर्किट ब्रेकर से सम्बन्धित कार्य। निविदा खुलने की तिथि 16.10.2026। निविदा शूल्क 590.00/धरोहर राशि रू० 3600.00।
जैम-43/2026-27 विद्युत पारेषण खण्ड, प्रथम अलीगढ़ के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न उपकेन्दों पर डिजिटल टेस्टर (Megger) की आपूर्ति। निविदा खुलने की तिथि 16.10.2026।
जैम-44/2026-27 विद्युत पारेषण खण्ड, प्रथम अलीगढ़ के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न उपकेन्दों पर थर्मल स्कैनिंग कैमरा की आपूर्ति। निविदा खुलने की तिथि 16.10.2026 धरोहर राशि रू0 5300.00/-
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल, लाल डिग्गी, अलीगढ़।
राष्ट्र हित में बिजली बचायें, विद्युत चोरी की सूचना "www.igpowerup.org"
पत्रांक– 1607–वि.पा.मं.(अ)/निविदा प्रकाशन/2025–26, दिनांक–27.10.2026

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, (UP)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in
Expression of Interest (EOI) for development and operation of health, Ayurveda, medicinal, and holistic wellness facilities at the Medicinal Park located in Sector-91, Noida.
New Okhla Industrial Development Authority (NOIDA) invites "Expression of Interest (EOI) for development and operation of health, Ayurveda, medicinal, and holistic wellness facilities at the Medicinal Park located in Sector-91, Noida. (JOB NO-44/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27)

Publishing of EOI	**28.10.2026**
Last date for submission of pre-bid queries	**16.11.2026**
Last date of submission of EOI proposal	**23.11.2026 at 1700 hrs.**
Opening of EOI proposal	**24.11.2026 at 1200 hrs.**

EOI can be downloaded from the website **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** and **www.etender.up.nic.in**
Director, Horticulture, Noida
CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

RAIL COACH FACTORY KAPURTHALA
E-Tendering
PCMO/RCF acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders on website www.ireps.gov.in closing date 06.11.2026 at 11:00 a.m. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. Contractors are allowed to make payments against this tender towards tender document cost and earnest money only through online payment modes available on IREPS portal. Manual payments through Demand draft, Banker's cheque, Deposit receipts, FDR etc. are not allowed. **NIT HEADER:** Contract Type Service **Tender No.RCF-MED-WA-EOT-2-26-27 Name of Works:** Service contract for Spay Neuter Surgery, rabies vaccination and post operative care of stray dogs in Rail Coach Factory, Kapurthala (2026-27) **Date of opening:** 06.11.2026 at 11:05 a.m **Tender Closing Date** 06.11.2026 at 11:00 a.m **Bidding Start Date:** 24/10/2026 **Advertised Value:** 1. ₹ 13,07,415.00 **Validity of offer** 90 days **Bidding Style:** Single rate for each Schedule **Period of Completion:** 12 Months **Earnest Money:** 26200/- **Tender Document cost:** 0.00/- **Note :-** Credentials/documents received from the tenderer after opening of the tenders shall not be given cognizance.
PCMO

Dy.CME/Fur acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Tender No. OLNAC-MLD-26-2 Closing Date/Time 18.11.2026 15:00 Hrs. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **A. Tender No.:** OLNAC-MLD-26-2 B. **Name of Work:** Moulding Work of LHB Non-AC Coaches **C. Tender Closing Date Time:** 18.11.2026 15.00 Hrs. **D. Advertised Value:** Rs. 58,22,644.00 **E. Bid Security/Earnest Money** Rs. 1,16,500.00 **F. Validity of Offer** 60 Days **G Period of Completion** 12 Months **H. Website particulars** https://www.ireps.gov.in **Eligibility Criteria: A. Technical Eligibility Criteria:** The tenderer must have successfully completed or substantially completed any one of the following categories of work(s) during last 07 (seven) years, ending last day of month previous to the one in which tender is invited: (i) Three similar works each costing not less than the amount equal to 30% of advertised value of the tender, or (ii) Two similar works each costing not less than the amount equal to 40% of advertised value of the tender, or (iii) One similar work costing not less than the amount equal to 60% of advertised value of the tender. **Definition of "similar work":** "Interior partial furnishing like Roof Ceiling Panel/Side Wall Panel/Seat & Berth/FRP Lavatory Modular Toilet of any type of Railway Coach in Indian Railways/Metros" **B. Financial Eligibility Criteria:** The tenderer must have minimum average annual contractual turnover of V/N or V' whichever is less; where V= Advertised value of the tender in crores of Rupees N= Number of years prescribed for completion of work for which bids have been invited. The average annual contractual turnover shall be calculated as an average of "total contractual payments" in the previous three financial years, as per the audited balance sheet. However, in case balance sheet of the previous year is yet to be prepared/ audited, the audited balance sheet of the fourth previous year shall be considered for calculating average annual contractual turnover.
Dy.CME/Fur
No. 077-M/2026-27 Date: 27.10.2026

RAJASTHAN HOUSING BOARD
No. :- Dir.Proj./2026-27/66 Dated :- 27/10/2026
NIB : 03/2026-27
Bids for Construction of HIG 32 Nos. (S+8) flats under SFS at Aravali Vihar, Bhiwadi are invited from interested bidders from 30.10.2026 (6.00 PM) to 19.11.2026 upto 6.00 PM. Other particular of bid may be visited on the procurement portal **(http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in)** of the state & **https://rhb.rajasthan.gov.in** Department Website.
UBN No. :- RHB2627WLOB00207
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12562 **Director Project, Jaipur**

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Tender No. 383960 **Dated: - 27.10.2026**
On behalf of President of India Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, office at - Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work: -

NIT No.	383960
Name of Work and its location	Refurbishment of 30 LHB (LWACCN) coaches during MLR schedule at RCNK/SNP (As per Scope of Work)
Approx. Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 134980715.33/- including GST@18% (Rupees Thirteen Crore Forty-Nine Lakh Eighty Thousand Seven Hundred Fifteen and Thirty-Three Paisa Only)
Earnest Money	Rs. 2699600/-
Completion period of work	06 Months from date of issue of Letter of acceptance
Cost of Tender document (In Rs)	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Up to 15:00 hrs on 18.11.2026. Opening of Tender at 15:15 hrs on the same day.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**

3746/26
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

INDIAN RAILWAYS
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(RAILWAY BOARD)
NEW DELHI - 110001
E-TENDER NO. 2026RSI9547TC
Principal Executive Director, Railway Stores (S), Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, Government of India invites e-tender for procurement of 5800 Bogie Open Rapid Discharge Hoper Wagon type 'BOBRN' wagons to RDSO Specification No. WD-13-BOBRN-2011 of March, 2011. Index Drawing & Design WD-91071-S-50 with Design-M.
2.0 The interested tenderers are advised to visit the website **http://ireps.gov.in** for details of the tender and submission of their e-bids.
3.0 **No manual offers will be accepted against e-tender.**
4.0 **Tender will be closed at 15:00 hours on 26.11.2026.**
5.0 Any corrigendum to this tender will be published on the website **http://ireps.gov.in** only and not in print media.
Director, Railway Stores (W),
Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, New Delhi,
3752/2026 **For and on behalf of the President of India**
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, (UP)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in
E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **http://etender.up.nic.in**. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.
(A)
1. **82/S.M-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27,** D/o Village (Replacement of Damaged, Chocked and Small Diameter Sewer Line in Village-Bishanpura), Noida. **Cost** Rs. 178.31 Lacs
2. **83/S.M-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27,** M/o Water Supply (Two Years Annual Repairing of Bowl Assly. and Tube Shaft Set of Network-55, 56, 121, 122, 105, 108 and Village-Garhi Chaukhandi and Parthla Khanjarpur), Noida. **Cost** Rs. 130.53 Lacs
3. **40/S.M.(Jal)-II/ET/2026-27,** Internal Development of Various TWs & W/W Compound (Repair and maintenance Work of TWs & UGR in Sector-70, 71, 73, 22, 23, 24 and Village-Chaura, Raghunathpur, Sadatpur, Sarfabad and Basai), Noida. **Cost** Rs. 168.59 Lacs
4. **21/S.M.(Jal-O.A.)/E.T./2026-27,** O/M of STP (Major repair maintenance and diversion of M.S./C.I./D.I./PVC Treated Water Lines in different STP of Jal Outer Agency division at STP-50, 54, 123, 168), Noida. (For Two Year). **Cost** Rs. 194.00 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date: 10.11.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 11.11.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)
1. **64/S.M-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27,** Strengthening of Sewerage (Relaying of Damaged Trunk Sewer Line of Village-Salarpur and Bhangel at DSC Road) Noida. **Cost** Rs. 162.56 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date: 03.11.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 04.11.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office Sector-5 **General Manager (Jal) NOIDA**
CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

Smashing Abhishek, Vaibhav show helps India seal series

Openers Abhishek, Vaibhav thrash NZ bowlers to help India chase a target of 199 with 40 balls to spare

Somshuvra Laha
somshuvra.laha@htlive.com

KOLKATA: Your wish has come true. Abhishek Sharma and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi opening for India isn't a pipedream anymore. It's an outrageous 43-ball 133-run partnership taunting bowlers from a scorecard that makes scant sense despite repeated readings. Fifty in 14 balls, 100 in 30, a target of 199 annexed in — you read that right — 13.2 overs, it was shock-and-awe batting no bowling opposition can prepare to hide from.

Sooryavanshi missed out on a fifty but Abhishek motored to a 35-ball ton — still his second quickest — as India couldn't have carved a more dominant way to take an unassailable 3-0 lead in the five-match series at Wellington on Tuesday.

No target matters on days like these, but India making a habit out of chasing with such nonchalance will surely keep every team on edge. Forced to watch the carnage, New Zealand knew this match was as good as gone when India finished the powerplay on a staggering 118/0.

T20 gives you licence to hit, but this was extraordinary beyond the realms of belief. Fastest team fifty, fastest team hundred as well, Abhishek falling short of Yuvraj Singh's 12 ball fifty record by three balls, but more remarkably: 12 sixes and 11 fours hit by the time Sooryavanshi was caught by Daryl Mitchell to break the partnership .

Abhishek never lifted his foot off the gas, blazing his way to his fourth T20I hundred before holing to Glenn Phillips at midwicket, leaving India 21 to win off 60 balls.

Jacob Duffy's opening over cost 26 runs, including five wides and a no-ball, Adam Milne conceded 17 in his first over, Michael Bracewell went for 21 in his first, before Kyle Jamieson surrendered 20. By then, New Zealand had tried pace, spin and different field settings. India only tried hitting the ball harder.

To Abhishek, New Zealand went short and shorter but he kept toppling the bounce. He backed away, made room and dispatched the ball over the infield with a regularity that suggested the fielding captain had misplaced the instructions.

Sooryavanshi was scarcely more accommodating. The teenager combined brutal power with an unnerving simplicity—see the ball, hit the ball, looking annoyed if it didn't reach the boundary. Even two consecutive dot balls against Duffy provoked visible frustration. At this rate, New Zealand were not merely expected to concede runs; they were expected to do so without interrupting the entertainment.

India reached 100 in five overs, matching the fastest team hundred in T20Is in available records. The target of 199 had required a chase but India's opening pair turned it into a countdown. New Zealand's bowlers were not necessarily short of ideas. But they were simply running out of deliveries that Abhishek and Sooryavanshi were willing to respect. Abhishek ended with 20 boundary hits, 11 of them sixes, reducing the match to a mismatch.

It was certainly not on the cards after Mitchell's unbeaten 89 from 52 balls took New Zealand to 198/3. And to think of it, they could have certainly ended up with more had India's seamers not found their discipline at the death. Tim Seifert fell for two, once again undone by Arshdeep Singh's movement away from the right-hander, but Finn Allen counterattacked to change the tempo.

Allen's 25-ball 40, featuring five sixes, provided the impetus for an 86-run partnership with Mitchell. The pair took New Zealand to 88 for one after seven overs, exploiting India's difficulties with their lengths as the ball began to lose its early movement. Mitchell, who had struggled in the opening two matches, found his range with powerful strokes through the leg side and an inventive scoop that repeatedly unsettled the bowlers.

Nitish Kumar Reddy broke the stand by having Allen caught by Naman Dhir, but Mitchell continued unabated. He reached his half-century in 26 balls and accelerated further, mixing clean hitting with deft placement. Phillips contributed 17 before falling to Axar Patel, leaving Mitchell to build another substantial partnership, this time with Bevon Jacobs. New Zealand scored 135 in their first 13 overs but managed only 63 in the last seven, thanks to India's sharp response in the closing overs.

Reddy repeatedly attacked the blockhole, while Arshdeep mixed wide yorkers with full deliveries to deny the batters room to swing freely. Prince Yadav, despite an expensive middle spell, used full deliveries to concede only nine runs in the final over. As did Bhuvneshwar Kumar in the 18th. In hindsight, it probably didn't matter. Not when Abhishek Sharma plots to eviscerate a target in just 80 balls.

Brief scores: NZ 198/3 (Mitchell 89*, Allen 40). India 199/4 in 13.2 overs (Abhishek 113, Sooryavanshi 45). **India won by six wickets**.

Abhishek Sharma exults after his century in the third T20I between India and New Zealand at Hnry Stadium in Wellington on Tuesday. GETTY IMAGES

The power-hitter

Highest Powerplay scores in men's T20Is

India vs New Zealand (2026)	118/0
Romania vs Serbia (2021)	116/0
Australia vs Scotland (2024)	113/1
South Africa vs West Indies (2023)	102/0
West Indies vs Sri Lanka (2021)	98/4

Most 100s in T20Is

	Glenn Maxwell (AUS)	Rohit Sharma (IND)	Abhishek Sharma (IND)	Karanbir Singh (AUT)	Phil Salt (ENG)	Suryakumar Yadav (IND)
100s	5	5	4	4	4	4
Inns	118	151	69	64	60	107
Runs	2,897	4,231	2,240	2,616	1,852	3,272
SR	154.42	140.89	196.83	174.28	163.74	162.94
50s	12	32	14	20	10	25

Badoni hits consecutive double tons; Delhi on top

HTC and Agencies
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

RANCHI: Ayush Badoni on Tuesday joined Virat Kohli and Gautam Gambhir on the elite list of batters who have scored double hundreds in back-to-back first-class innings, putting Delhi in command against hosts Jharkhand in their Ranji Trophy Group C game.

Having amassed 217 against Gujarat earlier this month, Delhi captain Badoni made an unbeaten 210 off 228 balls before declaring the innings at 515. Badoni forged a mammoth 334-run stand with Sumit Mathur, who was unbeaten on 150 off 253 balls at the time of declaration. In reply, Jharkhand were 131/4 at stumps on Day 2.

Delhi greats Kohli and Gambhir are also among a handful of batters to have compiled successive double hundreds. Overall, Badoni is the 21st Indian batter to have made consecutive double tons in first-class cricket.

Badoni and Mathur dominated the bowling after resuming the day on 309/5. The duo first steadied the ship after Delhi found themselves under pressure at 181/5 before controlling the proceedings.

Musheer shines

MUMBAI: Mumbai failed to capitalise on the batting efforts of centurions Angkrish Raghuvanshi and Musheer Khan (109-185b, 12x4, 1x6) on a slow burn of a second day against Haryana.

The hosts, resuming on their overnight score of 290/3, were bowled out for 430. Haryana in reply were 108/2 at stumps after Musheer took both the wickets with his left-arm spin, making him the standout performer with bat and ball.

Brief scores: In Ranchi: Delhi 515/5 decl (Ayush Badoni 210*, Sumit Mathur 150*). Jharkhand 131/4 (Utkarsh Singh 53*).
In Mangalapuram: Bengal 350 (Shahbaz Ahmed 121; Aditya Sarwate 4/95). Kerala 101/6 (Vishnu Vinod 41; Mohd Shami 3/20).
In Pune: Gujarat 223. Maharashtra 278/9 (Saurabh Nawale 95; Chintan Gaja 3/55, Sidharth Desai 3/40).
In Mysuru: Tripura 197. Karnataka 297/7 (Karun Nair 63, Rohan Patil 72, KV Aneesh 68; Abhijit Sarkar 3/59).
In Secunderabad: Punjab 431 (Salil Arora 151, Prabhsimran Singh 81, Ramandeep Singh 52; Chama Milind 4/79, Rakshan Readdi 3/80). Hyderabad 193/2 (Abhirath Reddy 97, Rahul Radesh 72*).
In Vijayawada: Andhra 231. Chhattisgarh 216/8 (Amandeep Khare 74*; T Vijay 3/73).
In Indore: Bihar 99 and 134 (Ayush Loharuka 76*; Saransh Jain 6/49). MP 407/8 decl (Yash Dubey 84, Saksham Purohit 132, Rajat Patidar 109; Amod Yadav 3/54). **MP won by an innings and 174 runs.**
In Vadodara: Baroda 616 (Priyanshu Moliya 321*, Mahesh Pithiya 102; Sahil Lotra 4/160). J&K 6/0.
In Nagpur: Goa 220 (Yash Kasvankar 63*, Darshan Misal 51; Nachiket Bhute 5/48, Rajneesh Gurbani 3/33). Vidarbha 217/3 (Ravikumar Samarth 53, Dhruv Shorey 63*, Danish Malewar 51*).
In Puducherry: UP 328/9 (Karan Sharma 162*, Shivam Mavi 50; Sagar Udeshi 4/62, Ankit Sharma 3/73) vs Puducherry.
In Mumbai: Mumbai 430 (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 114, Musheer Khan 109, Tanush Kotian 52*; Samant Jakhar 3/41). Haryana 108/2 (Musheer Khan 2/28).
In Chennai: Railways 184 & 107/9 (Sahab Singh 42; R Sai Kishore 4/38). Tamil Nadu 165 (Baba Indrajith 59; Raj Choudhury 5/41, Toufik Mondal 4/48).

Goa players celebrate the fall of a Vidarbha wicket on Day 2 of their Ranji Trophy Elite Group A match in Nagpur. PTI

INDIA HAMMER BANGLADESH 13-0 IN ACT HOCKEY

HT Corespondent
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

JALANDHAR: Mandeep Singh returned to form with a fine hat-trick as five-time champions India hammered Bangladesh 13-0 to start their title defence at the Asian Champions Trophy hockey on Tuesday.

Mandeep struck in the 3rd, 10th and 54th minutes, while skipper Harmanpreet Singh (2nd, 44th), Dilpreet Singh (43rd, 44th) and vice-captain Hardik Singh (60th, 60th) scored a brace each. Shilanand Lakra (15th), Abhishek (18th), Nilakanta Sharma (26th) and Jugraj Singh (46th) were the other Indian goal scorers in the lop-sided match at the Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium.

Wicket-keepers likely to be the key attraction at 2027 WPL mini-auction

Probuddha Bhattacharjee
probuddha.bhattacharjee@htdigital.in

KOLKATA: As the countdown to the WPL's fifth season begins, a total of 146 players are set to go under the hammer as the five franchises look to finalise their squads at the auction on Wednesday in Kochi.

With only 27 vacant spots to fill, the auction is expected to be focused and quick with teams knowing the exact players they want to go after. The combined budget for this mini-auction is ₹8.15 crore. The teams have already retained 63 players, leaving room for 20 Indian and seven overseas players.

UP Warriorz walk into the auction with the biggest purse of ₹3.75 crore but they also have eight places to fill. The presence of Meg Lanning, Phoebe Litchfield, Deepti Sharma and Sophie Ecclestone gives them a settled core, but they will be hunting for players in specialised roles. The release of Navgire, Chloe Tryon and Deandra Dottin has left gaps in their big-hitting options. The departure of Amy Jones will probably also add a wicketkeeper to their wishlist.

Delhi Capitals will be eager to break their run of runner-up finishes with a few vital picks in the auction. They have a budget of ₹1.10 crore and five vacancies. Shafali Verma, Jemimah Rodrigues, Laura Wolvaardt and Marizanne Kapp retain much of the strength that carried them to four successive finals. However, the release of Taniyaa Bhatia and Lizelle Lee has left them with only Mamatha Madiwala as their wicketkeeping option. Their primary focus will probably be on an Indian keeper rather than a marquee overseas star.

Mumbai Indians are looking to return to trophy-winning ways as they enter the auction with a budget of ₹90 lakh and six spots to fill. They acquired USA pacer Tara Norris during the trade window to fill their overseas quota, so the focus will be on Indian players. Mumbai struggled with their top order last season, so the two-time champions will be searching for an Indian top-order batter.

Defending champions Royal Challengers Bengaluru walk in with a budget of ₹1.15 crore for five places. Smriti Mandhana, Richa Ghosh and the returning Ellyse Perry provide them with the stability to mount a title defence. However, they released Grace Harris, which might prompt them to look for a power-hitter but the two-time champions might also aggressively pursue bowling cover.

Gujarat Giants have considerable spending flexibility. They have a budget of ₹1.25 crore and only three spots to fill. Beth Mooney, Ashleigh Gardner and Georgia Wareham will form the core of the side. The Giants will probably enter the auction looking to fill the few gaps left in their squad.

Who could exceed expectations, and who might go unsold?

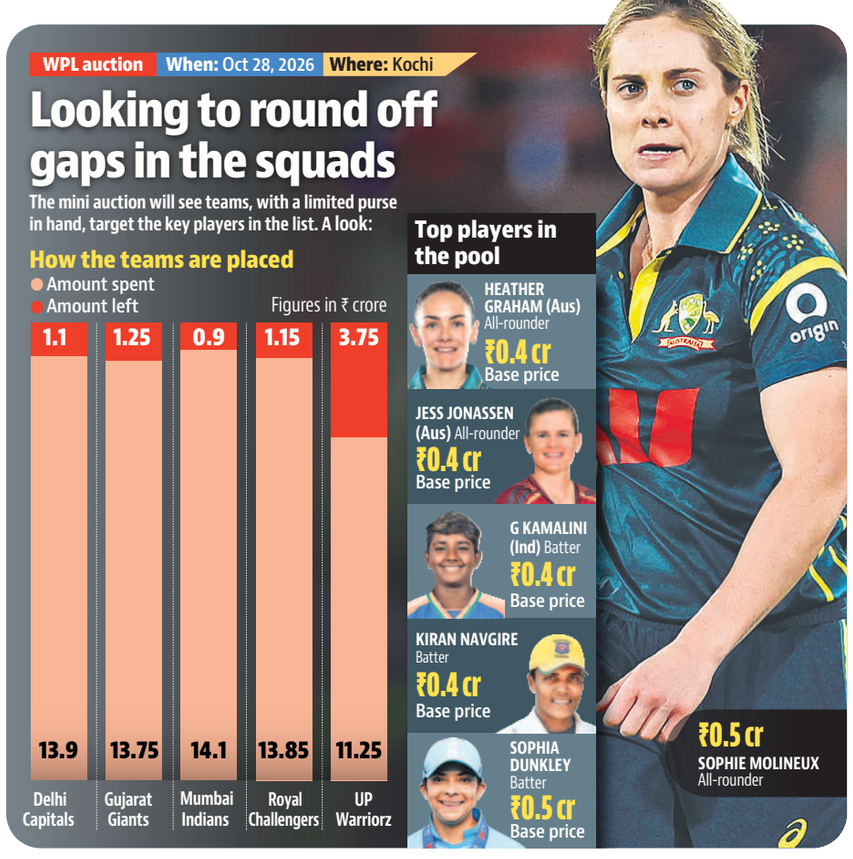
Indian wicketkeepers will probably be in the greatest demand. G Kamalini going under the hammer could be one of the most intriguing developments of the evening. She is registered as a specialist batter at ₹40 lakh. However, her keeping abilities will keep franchises, particularly DC and UPW interested.

Besides Kamalini, Uma Chetry and Taniyaa Bhatia could also benefit from the same scarcity. Among Indians, all-rounder Sneh Rana could be one of the most sought after names. Batters Vrinda Dinesh and Tejal Hasabnis could draw considerable attention. Shabnam Shakil has impressed with her pace and could attract franchises looking to strengthen their Indian pace department,

One overseas player that could be of interest to franchises is Sarah Bryce of Scotland, with a ₹10 lakh base price, as she presents a unique opportunity for franchises seeking greater flexibility. Under WPL rules, an Associate player can be fielded as the fifth overseas cricketer. She could provide valuable batting and wicketkeeping cover for the team that acquires her.

Some of the established internationals will face the opposite pressure. Sophia Dunkley, with a ₹50 lakh base price, will be competing for already-saturated top-order positions. Chamari Athapaththu, at ₹30 lakh, will face similar pressure. Heather Graham is an all-rounder, but at a ₹40 lakh base price and with most overseas spots filled, it will be interesting to see how much interest she attracts from the franchises.

Even proven WPL performers like Sophie Molineux and Jess Jonassen could face a shortage of demand. Most franchises have their spin departments sorted, making an expensive acquisition in that department less likely. Kiran Navgire has proven her worth as a big-hitting batter but her ₹40 lakh base price might limit the interest in her.



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NEW DELHI/METRO
Wednesday, **October 28**, 2026

Hindustan Times

FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

SC raps govt, DCGI over expired drug approvals

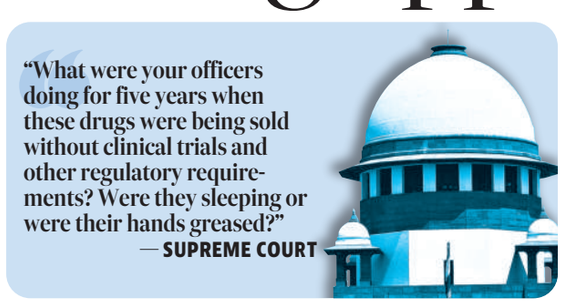
Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday came down hard on the Union government and the Drug Controller General of India (DCGI) for failing to act against pharmaceutical companies allegedly manufacturing and selling critical antifungal drug Liposomal Amphotericin B under expired emergency authorisations granted during the Covid-19 pandemic, asking what regulatory officials had been doing for five years while the drug was being sold without clinical trials and regulatory oversight.

"What were your officers doing for five years when these drugs were being sold without clinical trials and other regulatory requirements? Were they sleeping or were their hands greased?" a bench of justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and Aparesh Kumar Singh asked the government, expressing dismay over the delay in initiating regulatory action against companies accused of continuing to rely on temporary pandemic-era permissions.

The bench pointed out that the government had moved against the companies only earlier this year after the Supreme Court intervened in the matter. "You woke up only in February 2026 and started issuing notices after this court gave you a nudge," it observed.

The reprimand came during the hearing of a public interest litigation (PIL) filed by Rajendra Prasad, which has raised questions about the continuation of manufacturing and sale of Liposomal Amphotericin B under emergency permissions granted when India was battling a severe shortage of the drug during the devastating second Covid-19 wave in 2021. The drug was in critical demand at the time to treat mucormycosis, commonly known as black fungus, a potentially life-threatening infection reported among Covid-19 patients.



Senior advocate S Muralidhar, appearing for the petitioner, referred to the latest affidavit filed in the case to demonstrate that emergency approvals had been granted to several pharmaceutical companies but there had been no effective follow-up by the regulatory authorities.

Senior advocate Amit Anand Tiwari, appearing for Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd, told the court the company had not been granted emergency approvals.

The bench, however, made it clear that any directions issued by it would not be confined to individual manufacturers. "Whatever directions we issue will apply across the board for every company that were granted emergency licenses without proper trials during the Covid," said the bench while reserving its order.

The PIL has sought production of records relating to the emergency manufacturing permissions granted to pharmaceutical companies under Section 26B of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940, and the quashing of such licences or approvals. It has also sought directions to stop the manufacture, distribution and sale of the drug by the companies concerned, besides recalling and seizing stocks already in the market and destroying or disposing of them in accordance with appropriate safety protocols.

The plea questions whether temporary regulatory relaxations granted to address an extraordinary public-health emergency could continue to serve as the basis for commercial production and sale after the emergency permissions had expired, without manufacturers obtaining the requisite regular clearances.

During the 2021 crisis, the government invoked Section 26B to facilitate the availability of Liposomal Amphotericin B amid an acute shortage of the drug. The petitioner has argued that the emergency permissions were intended to be temporary and that companies could not continue manufacturing and marketing the drug on the strength of lapsed authorisations.

The proceedings have also brought the government's delayed response under scrutiny. In an order passed in April, the Supreme Court noted that show-cause notices had been issued in February 2026 to companies found not to have complied with the conditions of their licences. The notices had elicited replies, which were awaiting decisions by the competent authorities.

The bench had then directed the authorities to expedite the process and decide the show-cause notices within two months. It also distinguished between companies that had obtained regular manufacturing licences before the pandemic and those whose permissions arose from the emergency arrangements.

Cipla Ltd, Bharat Serums and Vaccines Ltd, BDR Pharmaceuticals International and Lifecare Innovations were among the companies deleted from the array of parties after it was pointed out that they held licences predating the pandemic and faced no show-cause notices. Sun Pharma's plea to be removed from the case, however, was rejected because a show-cause notice had been issued to it.

Other companies named in the proceedings include Emcure Pharmaceuticals Ltd, Gufic Biosciences Ltd, Alembic Pharmaceuticals Ltd, Lyka Labs Ltd, Natco Pharma Ltd and Intas Pharmaceuticals Ltd.

The PIL, represented by advocate-on-record Tushar Giri, has sought accountability from the Centre and the drug regulator over the alleged continuation of manufacturing and sale under expired emergency permissions.

'RIGGED, CORRUPT': TRUMP ON BRAZIL ELECTION AFTER LULA'S SHOCK WIN

SAO PAULO: US President Donald Trump claimed on Monday that Brazil's elections were "rigged", as his ally Flavio Bolsonaro called for the annulment of the poll won by leftist President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva.

Lula, who turns 81 on Tuesday, pulled off a dramatic comeback after losing to to Bolsonaro in a first-round vote, a defeat which fired up the left on the streets and social media to secure him a fourth term in office.

"I didn't take sides but it looked like another rigged election frankly...it looked so corrupt," Trump told reporters in Washington. "I like Lula, I get along with him very well. I just thought it was a very bad look, the way it was tabulated -- with the extension."

→P2

Need proof of intent in GST fraud cases: CBIC

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Goods and Services Tax field officers will now have to prove the intent of a taxpayer to evade taxes before invoking the stringent GST law provision relating to 'fraud, wilful-misstatement, or suppression of facts' for raising tax demand, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) has said.

In a circular, the CBIC said section 74(1) or section 74A(5)(ii) of the CGST Act cannot be invoked merely on the ground of non-payment of GST without "specific evidence" of fraud or wilful-misstatement or suppression of facts with intent to evade tax. These provisions would also not be applied in scrutiny cases solely because a discrepancy has been noticed, as scrutiny proceedings are conducted to examine the records and ascertain the nature of the issue and not to automatically presume fraud, it said.

THE CBIC CIRCULAR FOLLOWS THE DECISIONS TAKEN AT THE 57TH GST COUNCIL MEETING THAT DECIDED ON CHANGES TO DECRIMINALISE GST LAWS, RULES

"Accordingly, these provisions may be invoked only where the investigation discloses material evidence of such conduct, which must also be clearly set out in the SCN (show cause notice)," the CBIC said.

The circular follows the decisions taken at the 57th GST Council meeting held on October 8 that decided on several changes to decriminalise the GST law and rules. The Council, chaired by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and comprising state ministers, decided to scrap arrest powers of tax officers, while raising prosecution threshold to ₹5 crore from ₹1 crore.

The changes in GST law would require Parliament's nod and will be effective from April 1 next year, while the changes in administrative functioning are being done through issuance of circulars.

"The power to invoke fraud, wilful-misstatement, or suppression of facts for demand is conditional, hinging on proof of intent to evade tax, which is required to be clearly established in the SCN along with evidence," the CBIC said.

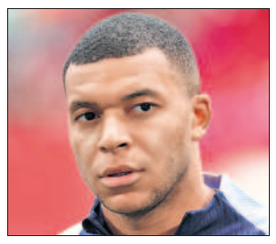
Mbappe faces brand backlash in China over alleged comments on Mao meme

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

BEIJING: Kylian Mbappe was dropped on Tuesday by major Chinese brands after a video circulated of the Real Madrid and France superstar apparently joking about Mao Zedong.

There were also signs of broader repercussions, with state-run *The Paper* reporting that public television was suspending broadcasts of matches from Spain's La Liga.

The offending video shows Mbappe saying that the funniest internet meme he had seen involving him was of his face edited onto that of "some guy — I think he's a Chinese dictator".


Kylian Mbappe

This was an apparent reference to a meme of Mbappe superimposed on an image of Mao, one of several using the footballer's face and other historical figures.

Beverage giant Dongpeng, which during this year's World Cup ran adverts with AI-generated images of Mbappe consuming its sports drink, said it was terminating all cooperation with the France captain.

Mengniu, China's largest dairy producer, and cheesemaker Milkground also said that they were cutting ties with Mbappe, who until now was hugely popular among Chinese fans with millions of followers on social media.

Asked on Tuesday about the controversy, China's foreign ministry said that it was aware of the reports. "Words and actions that hurt the feelings of the Chinese people will naturally be met with unanimous rejection from all sectors of Chinese society," spokesman Guo Jiakun told a regular briefing.

Later in the day, Mbappe apologised for his "ill-judged" comment. "My comment was ill-judged, and I now understand that it hurt many people in China and in Chinese communities around the world. I apologise to everyone my words have upset," he said in a statement.

Bureau of Investment Promotion
Udyog Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur

BIP/CMG/2026-27/186 Date :- 23/10/2026

Bids for procurement of Hampers for Bureau of Investment Promotion, Jaipur (a Government of Rajasthan undertaking) are invited from interested bidders up to 12:30 PM of 29.10.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal and **(http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in)** of the state.

UBN No. BIP2627GLOB00037
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12422 Commissioner (Inv. & NRIs)

RAJASTHAN STATE TEXT BOOK BOARD
2-2A, Jhalana Dungri, Jaipur-302004 (Rajasthan)
Phone : 0141-2700540, 2711237, 2703657 E-mail : rstbsecy22@gmail.com

No. : F-7/Production/RSTB/26-27 Date :- 22/10/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

E-Bids are invited for Job work of printing of Books having following details :

S. No.	Bid No.	Items	Specifications	Bid Value (in Crore)	Last date/ time of submission	UBN
1	382	Printing of Books	Sheet offset Printing	40.00	11.11.2026 (6:00 PM)	TBB2627SLRC 00014
2	383	Printing of Books	Web Offset Printing	20.00	11.11.2026 (6:00 PM)	TBB2627SLRC 00015

Details of the bids may be seen on the procurement portal https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, and https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/12506 Secretary

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-E-2026-242	Approx Cost : 10386002.22
Description of Work : KID-BZM section-TBTR (Replacement of channel sleepers by H-Beam sleepers)-292 Nos. (Bridge No. 1334/2 DN & 1354/1 DN) under jurisdiction of Sr. DEN/E/JHS.	
Earnest Money. : 207700.00	Date of closing Tender. : 18.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter. : 12 Months.	

• Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 18.11.2026 • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 2434/26 (C)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the Procurement of Boiler Tubes Protection Shiels which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 Tender Enquiry No. 212/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018401
"Procurement of Boiler Tubes Protection Shiels used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
GATP-109/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16549

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1 Tender Enquiry No. 214/GATP/IMD/50007822 dated 27.10.2026
"Award of Service Contract for Servicing and overhauling of motorized actuator at both the Units of GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB."
Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
GATP-102/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16538

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Boiler Tubes which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 Tender Enquiry No. 207/ GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018360
"Procurement of Boiler Tubes used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
GATP-104/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16539

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1. Tender Enquiry No. 215/GATP/IMD/50007829 dated 27.10.2026
"Award of Service Contract for Servicing and overhauling of motorized actuator at both the Units of GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB."
Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
GATP-103/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16541

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Carbon Steel Plates (Sail Hard) which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 Tender Enquiry No. 208/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018375
"Procurement of Carbon Steel Plates (Sail Hard) used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
GATP-105/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16543

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
Regd. Office: PSEB H.O. Building, The Mall, Patiala
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Contact No.: 96461-18773

TENDER ENQUIRY No.: QQ-1353/PO-C&S

Chief Purchase Officer/MM, Central Purchase Organization, PSPCL, 2nd floor, Multistorey Building, The Mall, Patiala, invites e-Tender for procurement of 4Cx50 sq.mm-888 Km as per tender specification no. QQ-1353/PO/C&S. For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 28.10.2026 (11.00 AM) onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
C1015/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16542

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Hot Air Control Dampers used in Mills of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 Tender Enquiry No. 210/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018313
"Procurement of Hot Air Control Dampers used in Mills of 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
GATP-107/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16545

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1 Tender Enquiry No. 213/GATP/IMD/50007821 dated 27.10.2026
"Award of Service Contract for Servicing and overhauling of Pneumatically Operated Actuators and Cylinders at both the Units GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB."
Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Power Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to https://eproc.punjab.gov.in from 27.10.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
GATP-101/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16537

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
DRM's OFFICE, TRD BRANCH, BHOPAL-24.
No. BPL/TRD/DRG/WC/484 RT2 & 486 RT, Date 26.10.2026
Open E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Rolling Department/West Central Railway, Bhopal, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders against following works, upto on the dates & time, mentioned against each tender. The complete tender documents and detailed information regarding tender is available on the website http://www.ireps.gov.in. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders. For any correction in this tender, if necessary, corrigendum will be uploaded on website prior to tender opening date which may be seen upto the date of tender opening. Tender No.: BPL/TRD/DRG/WC/484 RT2. Description of work: BHOPAL DIVISION:- OHE work for provision of FOB at 5 Nos. NSG stations, PAL, CRK, PGL, DKI & DRA in ET-KNW section (Electrical TRD work). Completion Period: 6 Months. Estimated Cost: ₹ 79,02,461.61. EMD: ₹ 1,58,100/-. Tender No.: BPL-TRD-DRG-WC-486 RT. Description of work: Bhopal Division:- OHE work for provision of additional turnout at Ashok Nagar (ASKN) (Electrical TRD work). Completion Period: 9 Months. Estimated Cost: ₹ 94,28,672.90. EMD: ₹ 1,88,600/-.
For both the above Tenders: Closing Date and Time for Submission of Tender: 17.11.2026 at 11.00 Hrs.
स्वच्छ भारत अभियान - एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (OPERATION & MAINTENANCE) , GARHWAL ZONE, 26-CIVIL LINES, ROORKEE

E-TENDER NOTICE

Power Transmission Corporation of Uttarakhand Ltd. invites e-tender for "Supply of spare Bushings for 40 MVA (132/33KV) Transformer at 132/33KV Substation, Virbhadra Rishikesh, under 220KV (O&M) Division Rishikesh" against e-tender specification No.CE/GZR-32/2026-27. Last date of submission of online/offline e-tender is 26.11.2026 upto 15.00 hrs. which shall be opened on 27.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs. Details of E-tender can be obtained from E-tender website www.uktenders.gov.in and information of E-tender can be seen from PTCUL website www.ptcul.org. For any assistance on e-tendering, please contact on Mb. No.+91-8899890000.
CHIEF ENGINEER (O&M)
No. 1082/CE(O&M)/GZR/Advt. Dated: 27-10-2026
"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF NATION"

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No:1003 Very Short Term Tender Notice Date: 27/10/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil) Maneri Bhali Stage - Ist Maneri, Uttarkashi invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tender are given below:
NIT No: 09/EE(Civil)/MB-I/TN/2026-27
Name of Works: Carrying out Survey work of Discontinued Loharinag-Pala HEP including Topographical Survey, L- Section & X-Sections of Barrage Site Area, Road to Surve Shaft Adits and appurtenant structures.
Estimated cost: Rs. 17.05 Lac (GST Extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 27-10-2026 from 11:00 hrs
Last Date for submission of bids: 03-11-2026 upto 11:00 hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"
Executive Engineer (Civil) MB-I, Maneri
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala - 147001)
Corporate Identity Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813, Website: www.pspcl.in
(O/o Controller of Stores & Disposal (South), PSPCL, Patiala)
(Email - cosandds@gmail.com, Mobile No. 96461-19412, 96461-48165)

Scrap e-Auction Notice

Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) will conduct a forward e-auction on 29.10.2026 for the disposal of approximately 34830 Damaged/Unserviceable Distribution Transformers (Approximate Total Start price Rs. 51.82 crores), lying at various Transformer Receiving Yards and General Scrap, Battery Scrap, E-waste, Plastic Waste (Approximate Total Start price Rs 5.50 crores) lying in various central Stores, TRYs and Outlet stores across Punjab, offered in separate multiple lots for each location. The e-auction will be conducted on the website portal https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/index_new.jsp. The Detailed auction catalogue with Terms & Conditions of e-auction, corrigendum and material list etc. will be available on the website https://www.mstcindia.co.in/content/Forthcoming_e_Auctions_For_All_regions.aspx and on https://www.pspcl.in/e-auction-notice.aspx. For queries related to registration, please contact at Phone No. 7229068247 or 7230022882.
C1016/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16552

कार्यालय नगर परिषद निम्बाहेड़ा जिला – चित्तौड़गढ़ (राज.)
क्रमांक / नपनि / निर्माण / 26–27 / 5095 दिनांक 22 / 10 / 2026

निविदा सूचना नं. 07/2026–27

राजस्थान लोक उपापन में पारदर्शिता अधिनियम, 2013 की पालना में बिड में पात्र संवेदको / फर्मो से निम्नानुसार वर्णित सम्पूर्ण नगरपरिषद निम्बाहेड़ा में घर–घर कचरा संग्रहण, पृथक्करण एवं निर्धारित स्थान पर कचरा परिवहन करने हेतु निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई–प्रोक्यूमेन्ट प्रक्रिया से वेबसाईड eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर ऑन लाईन निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती है। निविदा से संबंधित विवरण sppp.rajasthan.gov.in के NIB Code DLB2627A9012 पर भी देख सकते है :–

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WORLD

Israelis judge Netanyahu in fastest turnout in 50 yrs

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

Benjamin Netanyahu sits on a bench after voting at a polling station in Jerusalem on Tuesday. REUTERS

JERUSALEM: Israelis surged to the polls at the fastest rate in nearly half a century on Tuesday to pass wartime judgment on Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, in what voters described as the most consequential election in the nation's history.

Long lines formed outside polling stations for the first election since the October 7, 2023, Hamas-led attacks, with voters passionately engaged over the trauma of the country's deadliest day and the ensuing wars in Gaza, Lebanon and Iran.

Policies of Netanyahu's right-wing coalition have been divisive at home and have deepened Israel's international isolation, while he has defended his record, calling himself the only leader with the mettle to face down Israel's foes.

Netanyahu, Israel's longest-serving leader with 19 years in office, is an unmatched political survivor, and his nationalist politics are increasingly entrenched. Israel's fragmented system makes it difficult for an array of opponents to force out his coalition of right-wing, far-right and ultra-Orthodox parties.

His main rival Gadi Eisenkot, a military ex-chief of staff and security hawk, aims to unseat him with the support of parties on the right and centre, as well as the rump of an increasingly marginalised left. Opinion polls show a close race, with neither leader facing an easy path to power.

In a message to supporters more than five hours after polls opened, Netanyahu urged them to vote, saying turnout was high among his opponents on the left and among Israelis of Arab heritage, around a fifth of the country. "We need it to be high too. You all need to stream to the polls," he said. "This is a fateful moment."

Voters began casting ballots after polling stations opened at 7 a.m. (0500 GMT). The polls close at 10pm (2000 GMT).

The Central Elections Committee reported that 31.5% of eligible voters had cast their ballots within the first five hours. It was the fastest turnout since a legendary 1977 election that came to be known as "the upheaval", which brought the right to power for the first timein Israeli history.

"I think these elections are the most important of all the ones I've known," said Ruth Epstein, an 81-year-old longtime left-wing voter in Ramat Gan near Tel Aviv, who voted for the opposition Democrats. "I'm really scared about what will be here." Netanyahu has campaignedon an endorsement from US President Donald Trump, his ally in war against Iran, who has said they should "finish the job".

If neither Netanyahu nor Eisenkot can form a governing coalition in the 120-seat parliament, Netanyahu could stay on as caretaker until another election is held.

His opponents have managed to wrest him from the premiership only once since 2009, and that took four inconclusive elections in two years. He was back 18 months later.

For many of Netanyahu's opponents, the election turns on accountability for the security failures of October 7, Israel's deadliest day. Opposition groups have promised to hold a national inquiry, which Netanyahu's government has resisted.

"I am convinced that by the end of today, we will see a change — a new spirit for the State of Israel — that will serve as a rectification for the past three years and for that terrible day," Eisenkot said during a visit to kibbutz Nir Oz in southern Israel, targeted in the October 7 attacks.

He walked to the polls with Gadi Mozes, one of 251 people kidnapped by Hamas and taken to Gaza during the attack that killed 1,200 people.

Eisenkot says Israel's response — a war which health authorities say killed more than 74,000 Palestinians — was a failure because Hamas remains in charge. He repeated his commitment to dismantle or destroy Hamas' military and governing power in Gaza within 18 months of forming a government.

Itamar Ben-Gvir, leader of a far-right party in Netanyahu's coalition, cast his vote in the Kiryat Arba settlement in the occupied West Bank early on Tuesday. He predicted Netanyahu would return as prime minister and his own party would serve as the right-wing anchor of the government.

Voters from Israel's Arab minority, Israeli by citizenship but Palestinian by heritage, were voting in "unprecedented" numbers, Palestinian candidate Ahmed Tibi said.

Netanyahu had repeatedly warned supporters of the prospect of high turnout among Arab Israelis ahead of the vote, seeking to mobilise his base under the slogan "Right or Palestine".

Eisenkot has ruled out partnering with Arab parties, citing a lack of shared values, although some possible scenarios envision them propping up a minority government to ensure Netanyahu is removed from office.

Eisenkot joined Netanyahu's war cabinet after the October 7 attacks but quit after eight months, criticising his leadership.

Israel flattened much of Gaza in the offensive launched after October 7, and now occupies around two-thirds of the enclave under a year-old US-brokered ceasefire. Negotiations for Hamas to disarm and Israel to withdraw have stalled.

{ BRAZIL ELECTION }

Poll looked 'rigged': Trump; Bolsonaro's party concedes

Bolsonaro says he was ordered to hand over his passports; US prez gives no evidence to back claim

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

Donald Trump throws hats into the crowd during a campaign rally in Corinth on Monday. AP

SAO PAULO: US President Donald Trump said on Monday (local time) that leftist incumbent Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva's surprise win in Brazil's presidential vote "looked like another rigged election," although the party of defeated right-winger Flavio Bolsonaro later acknowledged the result. "I didn't take sides, but it looked like another rigged election," Trump told reporters, without providing any evidence. "It looked very bad to me."

The son of former President Jair Bolsonaro, Flavio Bolsonaro has refused to concede defeat in Sunday's presidential election, saying he would seek the annulment of Lula's victory after the Supreme Court extended voting by two hours.

Later on Monday, however, Bolsonaro's Liberal Party said it acknowledged the runoff result in a statement signed by the party's head Valdemar Costa Neto. "We recognise the presidential election results," Costa Neto said. "But we believe the issues raised need to be properly clarified."

Bolsonaro, who has not commented publicly since his party's statement, said earlier on Monday he would comply with a federal police order to hand over his passports, and denied he was planning to flee Brazil. "I was ordered right on the street to hand over my passports, and I'm also prohibited from leaving the country," Bolsonaro said.

Trump losing support among Indian-Americans, survey finds

Shashank Mattoo
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: A new survey finds US President Donald Trump has lost a significant chunk of his support among South Asian American voters, with 25% of those who voted for him in the 2024 presidential election planning to vote for the Democratic party in the crucial November midterm election.

In addition, 60% of South Asians plan to support the Democratic party as it battles to wrest control of the House of Representatives and Senate from Trump's Republican party. The survey, conducted by HIT Strategies, provides a key insight into the likely voting patterns of Indian-Americans, who accounted for roughly 90% of the 800 voters polled.

At a time of rising anti-Indian sentiment in the US, 90% of the voters surveyed said they had faced discrimination or knew someone who had, with almost half having experienced it personally. Almost 70% of respondents said discrimination against Sikh Americans is at least a moderate problem, alongside 64% for Hindu Americans.

Widespread perceived discrimination could lead several South Asian Americans to vote against Trump.

"Among those who believe that what happens to other South Asian Americans has a lot of impact on them personally, seven in ten are planning to vote for Democrats (71%). A majority of these voters oppose the Trump administration's ICE enforcement in cities (58%), and they are far more likely to say that discrimination and civil rights are top issues when deciding how they will vote (32%)," the survey finds.

The survey's findings mirror the results of other polls confirming a shift towards the Democratic party among Indian-American voters. Another survey conducted by AAPI Data in August found that 66% of Indian-Americans plan to vote for the party's candidates in the House of Representatives and the Senate, with just 18% backing Republican candidates in elections to the former and 22% in elections for the latter. These polls indicate a looming setback for Trump after a strong showing among Indian-Americans in the 2024 presidential election.

Jordan kills 20 Islamic State militants in Syria airstrikes

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

Orthodox priests stand beside the coffin of one of the victims of Friday's church shooting, in Amman, Jordan. AP

NEW YORK: Jordan said on Tuesday it had killed more than 20 Islamic State militants in airstrikes on southern Syria the previous evening, launched in response to a deadly church attack in Jordan that authorities linked to militants operating across the border.

Syria said the strikes killed seven people, including three children and a woman. Jordan regretted the civilian casualties, Government Communication Minister Mohammed al-Momani said in a post on X.

Jordan said on Monday its air force had struck what it described as militant hideouts in southern Syria after determining that the suspects behind last week's church attack were linked to "terrorist groups" based there.

Jordanian security officials said separately that security forces had arrested two brothers and their brother-in-law following a shootout linked to the church attack, which killed nine people. No group has claimed responsibility for the assault, although Jordan said the militants targeted in Syria were members of Islamic State.

Monday's strikes sparked anger in Syria. While the Jordanian military said the strikes were conducted in coordination with Damascus, Syria's government said they were carried out without prior coordination.

Saudi offered the Houthis $1bn for ceasefire: Report

TEL AVIV: Saudi Arabia has reportedly offered $ 1 billion to Yemen's Houthi group as part of an Iran-brokered deal to secure a ceasefire and halt attacks on the kingdom, Israeli media reported, citing diplomatic sources in the Gulf.

According to the reports, Saudi Defence Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman travelled to Tehran for talks aimed at securing a ceasefire with the Houthis, with the proposed arrangement involving the transfer of $1 billion to the group through Iran.

One diplomatic source claimed that the Saudi Minister had even brought the money aboard the Hercules military transport aircraft on which he arrived in Tehran. However, a Saudi official did not confirm that any money had been transferred, the reports said.

The talks reportedly involved Turkish intelligence chief Ibrahim Kalin and Pakistan's Army Chief, Field Marshal Asim Munir, alongside Iranian officials, including President Masoud Pezeshkian, Supreme National Security Council Secretary General Mohsen Rezaei and senior officials from the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps. ANI

France pledges new university admission system

PARIS: France's government pledged Monday to replace its national online university admissions platform in 2028, seeking to quell student anger after weeks of mass protests over education and living costs.Higher Education Minister Philippe Baptiste announced "substantial change" for 2027 before the platform's replacement in 2028, during a news conference. Called Parcoursup, the system handles applications to universities and other higher education courses. AP

Greenhouse gas levels hit new record highs: UN

GENEVA: Greenhouse gas concentrations in the atmosphere rose to new record highs in 2025, locking in climate impacts that will persist for centuries to come, the United Nations said Tuesday. Levels of the three main greenhouse gases — the climate-warming carbon dioxide, methane and nitrous oxide — all rose to unprecedented figures in 2025, the UN's weather and climate agency said. The World Meteorological Organization said the rise would lead to more long-term temperature increases. AFP

Several injured in car ramming in north Germany

BERLIN: Several people were injured after a car drove into a group of people in a northern German town close to Hanover shortly before midnight on Monday, a police officer aware of the matter said on Tuesday. A BMW was driven deliberately into a group of people in Neustadt am Ruebenberge, leaving four to five of them with injuries ranging from minor to severe, the police spokesperson said. REUTERS

JAPAN TO STEP UP 'BIG B' INITIATIVE IN BANGLADESH, SAYS TAKAICHI

Asian News International
letters@hindustantimes.com

DHAKA: The Prime Minister of Japan, Sanae Takaichi, on Tuesday said that under the new strategic cooperation with Bangladesh, they will upgrade the Big-B initiative. "Advancing the bilateral relationship, we will upgrade the "Big B" (Bay of Bengal Industrial Growth Belt) initiative and promote it as a new strategic cooperation initiative shared by both countries", Sanae Takaichi, the Prime Minister of Japan, said after meeting with Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman.

The Prime Minister of Bangladesh, Tarique Rahman, is currently in Japan for a four-day visit, and on the second day of his trip, he met with the Japanese Prime Minister.

After the meeting, both Prime Ministers gave separate statements, but the Japanese Prime Minister said that she encouraged cooperation to boost connectivity between South Asia and Southeast Asia, and in this regard, he emphasised advancing the Big-B initiative even further.

"Japan is committed to leading the development of the Bengal region. Japan is actively involved in strengthening the supply chain network connectivity and promoting investment in the region", she added.

Japanese Prime Minister mentioned four key pillars of relations with Bangladesh: Strengthening connectivity; preparing for disaster and geopolitical risks; promoting economic growth and preventing economic growth machine losses to ensure rule-based peace and stability and cooperating based on regional peace and stability so that both countries can develop and prosper together.

"Over the next five years, private investment totalling about 1 trillion yen is anticipated. The immense potential of Bangladesh, connecting South Asia and Southeast Asia, is extremely important for Japan's economy," Takaichi said.

Guptas' Johannesburg homes on sale as 'stigma' dampens interest

Bloomberg
letters@hindustantimes.com

Indian businessmen Ajay Gupta (right) and Atul Gupta. GETTY IMAGES

JOHANNESBURG: Two multi million rand South African mansions owned by the Gupta brothers, a trio of India-born businessmen at the center of a corruption scandal that triggered the nation's worst political and economic crisis since apartheid, are back on the market in Johannesburg.

The seven bedroom home — where the family allegedly lived — complete with an indoor swimming pool, thatched outdoor entertainment area, mini cricket pitch, water features and a garden with endangered cycad plants, was listed Wednesday alongside a neighboring 11-bedroom house that boasts a beauty parlor, cinema lounge and rooftop terrace.

While the properties have asking prices of 10 million rand ($599,000) and 12 million rand respectively, lower offers may be considered, online advertisements show.

The homes in Saxonwold, one of Johannesburg's oldest and most affluent neighborhoods, once belonged to a company linked to Atul, Rajesh and Ajay Gupta and form part of a compound that features in a scandal known locally as state capture.

A government-backed judicial inquiry that investigated graft involving more than 1,400 people and entities in 2018 heard that the brothers held clandestine meetings at the properties. There, influential guests were offered kickbacks and even government positions to help the family and their associates influence government decisions and to secure contracts.

"We've been battling to find buyers due to the stigma associated with the properties," said Kurt Knoop of Manci Knoop Financial Services, the business-rescue practitioners for Confident Concept Pty Ltd, the Gupta-linked company that owned the properties.

The brothers fled to Dubai shortly before the ruling African National Congress forced Jacob Zuma to quit as president in 2018.

Ebola cases top 10,000 in Congo; nurse killed

Bloomberg
letters@hindustantimes.com

KINSHASA: The number of confirmed Ebola cases in Democratic Republic of Congo surpassed 10,000 as violence against health workers responding to the outbreak left a nurse dead, according to the government and United Nations.

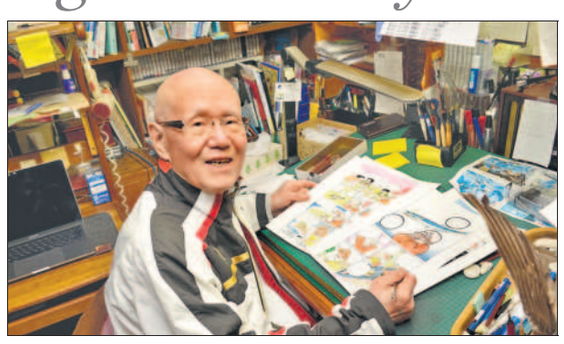
The death toll rose to 4,887 through October 25, Congo's National Institute for Public Health said in its daily report Monday. Forty of the 46 latest deaths occurred in communities rather than Ebola treatment centers, underscoring persistent challenges in detecting cases early and getting patients into care. The latest infections were reported in Ituri, North Kivu and Tshopo provinces.

"The situation highlights the need to strengthen early detection, contact tracing, dignified and safe burials, and the safety of response teams," INSP said. The outbreak is the largest ever recorded in Congo, with infections also detected beyond its borders. Misinformation about the outbreak has fuelled hostility toward health workers in some communities. A crowd attacked people involved in the response on Oct. 24, killing a nurse.

Experimental vaccines targeting Bundibugyo developed by Moderna and by the University of Oxford and Serum Institute of India could also be tested within weeks.

Japanese manga artist Tetsuya Chiba dies at 87

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com



Tetsuya Chiba was best known for 'Ashita no Joe'. AP

TOKYO: Legendary Japanese manga artist Tetsuya Chiba, who caused a national sensation with his boxing series "Ashita no Joe" or "Fighting for Tomorrow," a story about an orphan becoming a professional boxer, has died. He was 87.

Chiba's masterpiece series became so popular that fans even attended a mock funeral for the protagonist Joe Yabuki's rival. Chiba died at a Tokyo hospital last Thursday, his publisher Kodansha Ltd. said Tuesday, without specifying the cause of his death.

While he depicted aspiring young athletes fighting for their life and career, Chiba was a vocal supporter of peace and freedom of expression, telling stories of his harrowing memories of war as a child in autobiographical stories and manga.

Months after he was born in Tokyo in January, 1939, his family moved to northeastern China and Chiba spent his early childhood there during Japan's occupation in the region, where his father worked at a printing factory.

At age 6, Chiba and his family marked Japan's surrender on Aug. 15, 1945, while they were still in China. There, they faced danger and hunger in the face of anti-Japanese riots, but survived with the help of his father's Chinese translator who hid the family in an attic, where Chiba drew pictures for his three younger brothers.

The family eventually fled to China's port city of Huludao and returned to Japan in 1946.

The harrowing memories later influenced his work and activity with an anti-war theme.

Chiba debuted as a manga artist in 1956, initially drawing comic books for girls and later moving on to works for boys in the early 1960s.

In 1961, he debuted in a boys comic magazine with a baseball manga "Chikai no Makyu (The Magic Ball)," paving the way for a new genre of sports-themed manga in Japan.

Sebi's revised CAS raises broker hopes

Apoorva Ajith
apoorva.ajith@livemint.com

MUMBAI: The Securities and Exchange Board of India's (Sebi's) decision to revise its closing auction session (CAS) framework has raised hopes of a recovery in derivatives trading and brokerage revenues, offering relief to brokers suffering from a sharp slowdown in key income streams.

"The pre-CAS levels on volumes and revenue seen in Q1 FY27 will be a good indicator of where we are headed once the circular comes into action. However, one may not be able to replicate revenues from earlier since broader market factors also have an effect," a broking official told *Mint* on the condition of anonymity.

Introduced on August 3, CAS determined closing prices for 213 F&O-traded stocks through an auction that established a single equilibrium closing price, replacing the final volume-weighted average price (VWAP).

However, the framework caused abrupt price swings and uncertainty over settlement values on expiry days, prompting market participants to flag concerns about liquidity and price discovery. In response, Sebi changed course on October 15, restoring the 30-minute VWAP for settling derivatives contracts on expiry days. The changes will take effect on December 7.

The auction mechanism had quickly lost favour among traders. From August 3 to September 30, volumes in the closing auction session fell 84% to 4.2 million contracts, while traded value fell 77% to ₹297.72 crore, according to NSE data.

However, trading activity began recovering after Sebi issued a consultation paper on September 12 proposing to roll back the framework—offering an early hint of how market volumes might bounce back once the revised rules take effect on December 7.

On October 15, Sebi revised the CAS framework. REUTERS

Between August 3 and September 11, volumes in Bank Nifty futures fell 7% to 22,691 contracts, while total traded value declined 9% to ₹3,845.53 crore, according to exchange data. By the end of September, however, volumes had recovered to 26,622 contracts, up 9.6%, while traded value rose by 4% to ₹4,408.12 crore. Nifty futures, however, told a different story. Volumes grew 12% to 62,288 contracts in the initial period through 11 September, before momentum accelerated after the consultation paper to post a 20% gain by month-end at 66,539 contracts. Traded value expanded similarly, stepping up from a 6.4% gain before the consultation paper to an 11% increase by the end of September.

At Angel One, one of India's largest brokers, broking revenue accounted for 55% of consolidated gross revenue in the September quarter of FY27, down from 60% both a year earlier and in the preceding June quarter.

Groww experienced a similar trend. Broking operations, comprising equity derivatives, cash stocks, and commodity derivatives, contributed 68.4% of total revenue of ₹1,541 crore in the September quarter of FY27, down from 72.9% in the June quarter and 74.9% in the September quarter of FY26.

However, brokers are optimistic about a swift recovery. Two broking officials, speaking on condition of anonymity, said Sebi's latest circular could help brokerage revenues bounce back to levels seen in the first quarter of FY27, before the original CAS framework disrupted trading activity. "Our expectation is that it (volumes) will go back to normal in some ways. We think that from the day it becomes applicable, the normalization will be much faster. So, we don't expect it (volume) will go up. The way we are expecting is it will normalize the problem that it created," Ishan Bansal, co-founder of Groww, said during the company's earnings call for the September quarter of FY27, which took place before Sebi issued its latest circular in October.

Angel One is also optimistic about the regulatory changes. "The road ahead is also getting clearer with the Sebi circular yesterday evening on updates to the closing auction session. This will bring greater clarity to traders, and we expect that to create some tailwind for us," Ambarish Kenghe, group chief executive officer at Angel One, said during the company's earnings call for the latest quarter.

Amit Majumdar, group chief strategy officer at Angel One, said, "The initial pickup in derivatives activity following the announcement is encouraging, and we expect the improvement in market participation to gather momentum over the coming months."

L&T'S Q2 NET PROFIT RISES 33% TO ₹5,202 CRORE; ORDER INFLOWS INCREASE BY 28%

Press Trust of India
feedback@livemint.com

NEW DELHI: Engineering major Larsen & Toubro (L&T) on Tuesday reported a 32.5% rise in consolidated net profit to ₹5,202.10 crore for the quarter ended September 2026, on the back of higher revenues. The company had posted a consolidated net profit of ₹3,926.09 crore in the year-ago period.

L&T achieved a consolidated revenue of ₹78,750 crore for the reporting quarter, registering a year-on-year growth of 16%, driven by accelerated progress in various businesses, the company said in a statement. It secured orders worth ₹147,665 crore, registering an on-year growth of 28% for the quarter. During Q2 significant order wins were achieved across multiple businesses such as hydrocarbons – offshore and onshore, carbon-Lite solutions, public spaces and airports, and power transmission and distribution businesses.

International orders stood at ₹92,375 crore, contributing 63% to the total order inflow.

The Group's consolidated order book as of September 30, 2026, was at ₹853,514 crore.

"The company has delivered a strong quarter in an everchanging geopolitical landscape. This performance reflects continued customer confidence and our ability to secure large and complex orders across sectors and geographies. We achieved yet another record quarterly order inflow. Focused execution across our projects, products & manufacturing businesses supported a higher revenue growth. The highest ever order book at ₹8.5 lakh crore provides multi-year revenue visibility," Chairman and managing director S N Subrahmanyan said. The company is well positioned to sustain this growth momentum and will continue to invest in innovation, digital capabilities, and technology-led businesses to drive growth and create long-term value for stakeholders, he said.

'India to get comparative advantage in US trade deal'

Utpal Bhaskar
utpal.b@livemint.com

NEW DELHI: India's commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal said that under the proposed trade agreement with the United States, India will get a comparative advantage over other countries and preferential access to the US market.

The development assumes significance amid growing uncertainty in global trade following the ongoing wars in West Asia and Ukraine. Goyal said in a late Monday night (India time) press briefing, "And in the US also, we will get a comparative advantage from other countries. We will get preferential access. So, now the story has started."

Goyal had earlier on Monday said India and the United States had concluded most of the discussions and were fine-tuning the proposed trade agreement.

Efforts towards a limited India-US trade deal first began in 2018, during President Donald Trump's first term, but were put on hold under the Biden administration. Talks were revived last year after Trump returned to office.

Goyal added that concluded trade agreements and those under negotiation would give India preferential access to $85 trillion of the $115 trillion global GDP.In response to a *Mint* query, Goyal said the proposed free trade agreement (FTA) with Chile was at an advanced stage of conclusion, while Mexico was keen to secure an early harvest deal. He added that good progress was being made on the proposed Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) with Canada. Discussions with Mercosur (Mercado Común del Sur, or Southern Common Market) could also be accelerated now that elections in Brazil were over.

Piyush Goyal, commerce and industry minister. PTI

Goyal said countries including Ecuador and several in Africa wanted to sign FTAs with India. India has eight trade negotiations underway.

"Egypt has invited us to discuss potentially how we can work more," Goyal said, adding, "We have just started SACU (Southern African Customs Union) negotiations. So, it may take some time." He said negotiations with the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), which would add the four other Gulf countries and Israel, could take longer because of the West Asia crisis.

"The GCC (Gulf Cooperation Council), which would add those four other countries of the Gulf and Israel. These negotiations for obvious reasons because of the West Asia crisis may take some time. Though we are ready to speed up negotiations.

These proposed trade deals come in the backdrop of global supply chains getting affected and a global slowdown.

"The Eurasia FTA is only about goods. It doesn't include services. Hence, we are still assessing the benefits of entering into that agreement," Goyal said, adding that while many other countries were talking to India and wanted an FTA, "But we also don't have more bandwidth at the moment."

In response to a Mint query about building institutional capacity and sectoral expertise for trade negotiations, Goyal said the government had been working to ensure that experience gained in negotiations was retained and used in future agreements.

"Prime Minister Narendra Modi has been very focused on this aspect. That our negotiations and all the learnings and effort that's going in should not become a one-time affair. And therefore, in the last three years or so, we've prepared proper manuals which are a guide like a standard operating practice, SOP, towards proper and organized FTA negotiations. Every FTA that we enter into, we prepare a lot of documentation for future reference and to help guide officers in the future because people keep changing. And lastly, I think Indians are basically smarter."

Ramita Mishra contributed to the story.

INFOSYS DRAWS 4 DOWNGRADES IN A DAY ON WEAKER SALES OUTLOOK

Bloomberg
feedback@livemint.com

Infosys Ltd. was downgraded by at least four analysts in a single day after India's second-largest software exporter cut its annual sales forecast, deepening concerns over disruption from artificial intelligence.

Axis Capital Ltd., Arihant Capital Markets Ltd., and IIFL Capital Services Ltd. were among brokerages that lowered their ratings on Monday, data compiled by *Bloomberg* show.

Three others reduced their recommendations over the weekend, pushing its consensus rating to 3.7 out of 5, the lowest since January 2024. The downgrades for the sector's bellwether threatens to derail a nascent recovery in India's battered technology shares.

The Nifty IT Index is on track for its best month since July, even as concerns mount over soaring debt levels being used to fund the global AI buildout.

Infosys cutting its annual sales forecast signals that a broad-based recovery in information technology (IT) budgets has yet to materialise. Revenue will rise 1 to 2% on a constant-currency basis in the year through March 2027, the company said late Friday, versus analysts' estimates of just over 2%. India's $280 billion-plus software services industry has been grappling with a slowdown, with companies limiting spending in the midst of geopolitical crises such as the Iran conflict, surging energy prices and inflation.

ACC's Q2 profit plunges 91% on high fuel costs

Reuters
feedback@livemint.com

Adani Group-owned cement maker ACC reported a nearly 91% fall in second-quarter profit on Tuesday, hurt by weaker cement sales, higher fuel costs and an employee severance charge, while a one-time tax benefit had boosted earnings a year earlier.

Standalone net profit-after-tax fell to ₹101 crore ($10.62 million) in the quarter ended September 30 from ₹1,112 crore a year earlier, while revenue declined 4.7% year-on-year to ₹5,612 crore.

The year-ago quarter included a ₹671 crore write-back of tax provisions relating to earlier periods, which boosted profit.

During the September quarter, ACC recorded an exceptional expense of ₹71 crore towards voluntary severance benefits for permanent employees and third-party workers at various production facilities, including those where operations have been temporarily suspended.

Cement makers faced higher costs of key inputs such as petcoke, coal and diesel during the quarter, while seasonally weaker demand and intense competition limited their ability to pass on the increases to customers.

Brokerages had expected the industry's profitability to weaken during the September quarter as rising operating costs outpaced cement price increases.

TATA CAPITAL Q2 PROFIT SURGES 51% TO ₹1,660 CR

Press Trust of India
feedback@livemint.com

NEW DELHI: Tata Capital on Tuesday reported a 51% growth in consolidated net profit to ₹1,660 crore for the September quarter of FY27.

The company had posted a net profit of ₹1,097 crore in the July-September period of FY26.

Net total income rose 24% to ₹4,676 crore during the September quarter of FY27, from ₹3,774 crore in the corresponding period a year ago, the company said in a regulatory filing.

Tata Capital managing director and CEO, Rajiv Sabharwal, said the company's loan book crossed ₹3 trillion, "underscoring the scale, diversification and resilience of our franchise".

The non-bank lender's Assets Under Management (AUM) stood at ₹3,08,030 crore, up 26% year-on-year.

"Asset quality remained stable, reflecting our continued focus on portfolio quality, prudent underwriting and effective collections," Sabharwal said.

In a separate exchange filing, Tata Capital said its board approved a proposal for the enhancement of the existing medium-term note programme from $2 billion to $3 billion and, subject to market conditions, issuance of foreign currency bonds/debt instruments under the MTN Programme, in one or more tranches, by way of external commercial borrowings.

CIPLA Q2 NET PROFIT FALLS 35% TO ₹877.5 CRORE

NEW DELHI: Pharmaceutical major Cipla on Tuesday reported a 35% decline in its consolidated net profit for the second quarter ended September at ₹877.54 crore, as revenue fell marginally while expenses grew during the period. The company had posted a net profit of ₹1,351.17 crore during the corresponding period a year ago, a regulatory filing showed. During the July-September quarter under review, total revenue from operations declined to ₹7,403.93 crore, from ₹7,589.44 crore a year ago.

Meanwhile, total expenses rose to ₹6,377.75 crore, from ₹6,004.86 crore in the Q2 of the previous financial year. PTI

Maruti Suzuki Q2 net profit falls 26% to ₹2,466 cr; revenue rises

Press Trust of India
feedback@livemint.com

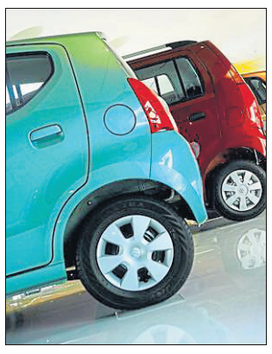
NEW DELHI: Car market leader Maruti Suzuki India Ltd on Tuesday reported a 26.36% decline in its consolidated net profit for the second quarter ended September at ₹2,466.1 crore, due to higher input costs resulting from the West-Asia conflict even as the revenue rose sharply, driven by record quarterly vehicle sales volumes.

The auto major had posted a net profit of ₹3,349 crore in the same quarter of the previous fiscal, a regulatory filing to the exchanges showed.

During July-September, total revenue from operations increased to ₹53,355.5 crore as against ₹42,344.2 crore in the same period of 2025-26 fiscal, Maruti Suzuki India said in the filing.

Total expenses in July-September also shot up to ₹50,619 crore as compared to ₹39,018.4 crore in the year-ago period, the company said.

Cost of materials consumed in the second quarter rose to ₹37,488.5 crore from ₹25,324.2 crore in the corresponding period last fiscal, it added.


The auto major had posted a net profit of ₹3,349 crore in the Q2 of the previous fiscal. MINT

In a statement, Maruti Suzuki India said the operating profit (EBIT) in the quarter stood at ₹2,803.7 crore as compared to ₹3,382 crore in Q2 FY25-26 owing to the West Asia-conflict-linked commodity price increases.

Sequentially this translated into a growth of 10.8% from Q1 FY26-27.

However, non-operating income declined sharply in Q2 due to mark-to-market losses on invested surplus.

"The company achieved its highest-ever quarterly total sales volume of 696,654 units, registering a growth of 26.5% over the same period previous year. The company's growth in the domestic passenger vehicle market was broad-based, with small car sales increasing by 35.9% and SUV sales by 68.2%. The company's recently introduced SUVs received a strong market response and contributed to this robust growth," it stated.

Maruti Suzuki India said its domestic market share increased by 2.2 percentage points to 40.8%.

"Recent capacity additions have enabled the company to serve the strong demand. Even with enhanced production capacity, demand continued to outpace supply resulting in a low network inventory of about 17 days and pending bookings of about 200,000 units at the end of the quarter. In export markets, despite the challenging geopolitical situation, the company could achieve sales of 1,08,119 units in Q2 FY 2026-27, as compared to 1,10,487 units in Q2 FY25-26," Maruti Suzuki said.

TAMO, AMAZON INK PACT FOR 3,000 ELECTRIC TRUCKS FOR LOGISTICS

Press Trust of India
feedback@livemint.com

NEW DELHI: Tata Motors and Amazon have joined hands to deploy 3,000 electric trucks for e-commerce logistics, a joint announcement said on Tuesday.

Heavy Industries Minister H D Kumaraswamy flagged off the initial fleet of trucks.

"I congratulate Tata Motors and Amazon on this significant collaboration to deploy 3,000 electric trucks across Amazon's transportation network in India," Kumaraswamy said.

The minister said while electric passenger vehicles and two-wheelers have made encouraging progress, the electrification of commercial transportation is equally important.

"As India's economy expands, the demand for freight transportation will continue to increase. We must therefore ensure that the growth of our logistics sector is accompanied by great energy efficiency. Today's initiative is an important step in that direction," he said.

A senior Amazon executive said all 3,000 electric trucks will be deployed within 3 years.

India eyes bigger share of diesel exports

Reuters
feedback@livemint.com

GOA: India's diesel exports are set to surge from 2027, giving the South Asian nation a bigger role in global markets, as state-run companies boost refining capacity, industry officials said on Tuesday.

That will bolster India's position as a swing supplier of refined products in an already tight global market buffeted by the US-Iran and Ukraine-Russia wars that have disrupted trade flows and boosted freight rates worldwide.

"We will be in a happy situation of not only refining for ourselves but for the world," said Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri.

India is becoming a global refining hub as it prepares to boost refining capacity to 300 million tonnes per year (tpy) by 2030, and increasing further to 400 million tpy later.

Amid unprecedented disruption to global refining from conflict and plant closures, with operating refineries running at historic utilisation rates to ease fuel shortages, India has emerged as the second-largest exporter of seaborne diesel this year, behind only the US, ship-tracking data from Kpler shows.

In 2027, Indian state refiners will together increase their diesel production capacity by 16.5 million tonnes as they boost capacity of existing refineries, officials said. "We will be exporting diesel due to refinery expansion," said A S Sahney, chairman of Indian Oil Corp, the country's largest refiner, which aims to add about 18 million tonnes of annual capacity, to produce about 8 million tpy of additional diesel.

Hindustan Petroleum Corp's new 9-million-tpy refinery in the western state of Rajasthan will turn out 3 million tpy of diesel next year, once the refinery stabilises, said Chairman Vikas Kaushal.

India has emerged as the second-largest exporter of seaborne diesel this year. HT

Bharat Petroleum Corp plans to produce 1.5 million tpy extra diesel from next year, its chairman, Sanjay Khanna, said.

Oil India's subsidiary Numaligarh refinery in the eastern region, which will be expanded to 9 million tpy in March next year, will add 3 million tpy of diesel production.

Some refiners, such as HPCL, buy refined products from private companies for sale by their retail outlets. The expansion will limit their purchases from other companies for local sales, and free up volumes for exports, officials said.

Additionally, India's expanding refining capacity is designed to process a broad range of crude grades and flexible petrochemical feedstocks, letting companies capitalise on price arbitrage and produce higher-value products.

Private refiners Reliance and Nayara now export refined fuels while state companies mainly meet domestic demand.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio described India as a refining "superpower" during a recent visit to Reliance's massive refining complex in the port city of Jamnagar. Puri said India aimed to become a global refining hub with fuel demand expected to rise to drive its economic expansion.

{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS
1 It works against the grain (6)
4 Wild colt in desert country (8)
9 Is Cain's brother a girl? (6)
10 Scratch game (8)
12 Eternally the dream of the French revolutionary (4)
13 High points of Danse Macabre (5)
14 A touching article or tract (4)
17 Quite the opposite of true humility (5,7)
20 How to get up fast and maybe have first nod (4,4,4)
23 Seek out supplements (4)
24 Points out a woman with an odd figure (5)
25 Grumpy speculator? (4)
28 Reversed a good deal lazily and without emotion (8)
29 Agree one is about a month in arrears (6)
30 With which one looks for consent in those in a row (8)
31 Singularly I'm the first (6)

DOWN
1 Send a letter but expect only a dead loss (5,3)
2 Yelled at eccentric excitedly (8)
3 Make a note of the time perhaps (4)
5 Distorted opinion the rooster has of life? (8,4)
6 Contrive what is needed to melt ice (4)
7 Keep watch on this chap (6)
8 One said initially to work through records (6)
11 Large sum not declared apparently (6,6)
15 Hard-hearted king whose widow was merry (5)
16 Tears out for a look (5)
18 Without vigour of late? (8)
19 A brief way to stimulate fish (8)
21 Tenant not having so many points (6)
22 Earlier brew of beer (6)
26 Female wear that wasn't long in fashion (4)
27 Getting married in a church will be a high spot (4)

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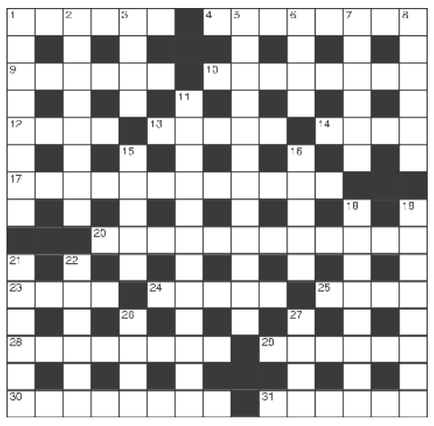


QUICK CLUES

ACROSS
1 Unlawful constraint (6)
4 Remain firmly in one's place (3,5)
9 Protective covering (6)
10 In point of fact (8)
12 Source of trouble (4)
13 Ward off (5)
14 Meagre (4)
17 High state of readiness (7,5)
20 Freedom from bondage (12)
23 Space (4)
24 Of late (5)
25 Feel the loss of (4)
28 American football field (8)
29 Usher in (6)
30 Aloof unemotional person (4,4)
31 Be present at (6)

DOWN
1 A disadvantage (8)
2 Contemplative (8)
3 Avoid (4)
5 Beyond reform (12)
6 Accordingly (4)
7 Ship's kitchen (6)
8 Difficult (6)
11 Irascible (12)
15 Disreputable (5)
16 Small detached piece (5)
18 Be party to a lawsuit (8)
19 Biased (3-5)
21 Deeply sad (6)
22 Heartily good-humoured (6)
26 Trivial quarrel (4)
27 Adroit (4)

YESTERDAY'S SOLUTIONS (17627)

{ SUDOKU }

DIFFICULTY LEVEL ★★★★

		4	7		6	3		
	9							
		5			1	2	8	
			8		7		6	3
5	6		3		2			
	3	7	1			5		
							1	
		9	6		8	7		

Fill in all the squares in the grid so that each row, column and each of the 9X9 squares contains all the digits from 1 to 9.

GAME ZONE: Scan the QR code for more daily puzzles and brain teasers

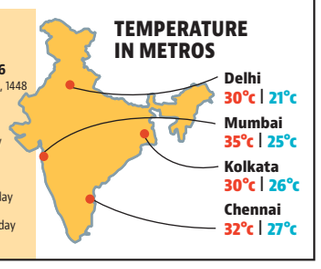
{ WEATHER }

TEMPERATURE ■HIGH ■LOW

WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
Partly cloudy sky	Thunderstorm with rain	Thunderstorm with rain
30c | 16°c	28°c | 17°c	28°c | 18°c

ALMANAC
Today is 28th October 2026
- 16 Jumada Al-Awwal, 1448
- 03, Kartika, Krishna Paksha, 03
- Samvat 2083
- **Sunset:** Wednesday at 05:39 p.m.
- **Sunrise:** Thursday at 06:30 a.m.
- **Moonset:** Wednesday at 08:46 a.m.
- **Moonrise:** Wednesday at 07:11 p.m.

TEMPERATURE IN METROS



buzz

IREDA REPORTS STRONG Q2 GROWTH, WITH ASSET QUALITY

IREDA reported a 31% year-on-year rise in Q2 FY27 loan disbursements to ₹10,579 crore, while its loan book grew 15% to ₹97,411 crore. Revenue from operations increased 14% to ₹2,345 crore, and net NPAs improved to 1.08% from 1.97%. Net worth rose 11% to ₹14,337 crore, while profit after tax stood at ₹554 crore, reflecting sustained business growth and stronger asset quality.

TRENTAR SIGNS ₹30,000 CR GREEN DATA CENTRE MOU

Trentar Private Limited has signed an MoU with the Maharashtra government to invest ₹30,000 crore in a proposed 500 MW green integrated hyperscale data centre. The project will support AI, high-performance computing and large-scale data processing, with at least 51% renewable energy targeted. The initiative marks the Dorf Ketal Group's entry into large-scale digital infrastructure, combining advanced technology, energy storage and water-efficient cooling solutions to support growing digital economy, and strengthen digital infrastructure.

PUNJAB & SIND BANK INTRODUCES PSB SHUBH UTSAV

Punjab & Sind Bank has introduced PSB Shubh Utsav 2026, offering nil processing fees on vehicle loans, home loans and jewel loans. The initiative aims to make credit more accessible to customers seeking financing for their personal and household needs. The Bank provides digital loan services, including online home and vehicle loan facilities and Digital Gold Loan, enabling customers to access financing through digital channels.

BIS SEIZES 27,000 METRES OF CABLES IN DELHI

The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), Delhi Branch Office-I, seized over 27,000 metres of cables from Chirag Cable Industries in Narela, Delhi, during an enforcement operation on October 8, 2026. The unit was allegedly manufacturing cables without a valid BIS licence and using a counterfeit ISI Mark. BIS said appropriate legal action would follow and urged consumers to verify certification details through the BIS CARE app.

Pragyata Foundation to Extend Mental Wellness Support to 4,000 Students

Pragyata Foundation, with Iris Software Inc., has launched the Iris Young Minds Initiative to promote mental well-being among 4,000 students across Delhi-NCR. Psychologist-led sessions will focus on stress management, emotional intelligence, gender sensitivity and healthy relationships, helping students develop emotional awareness and essential life skills, with plans to expand through future school engagements, teacher training and parent orientation.

IREDA's Vigilance Awareness Week with CMD-Led Pledge

IREDA inaugurated Vigilance Awareness Week 2026 under the theme "Probity for Prosperity", with CMD Dr. Bijay Kumar Mohanty administering the Integrity Pledge. Running from October 26 to November 1, the observance features workshops, programmes and competitions to promote integrity and accountability, reinforcing ethical governance and India's green energy goals.

ITRA Hosts National Conference "Ayu-Tech Navonmesh 2026

ITRA Jamnagar, led by Director Prof. (Dr.) Tanuja Nesari, hosted "Ayu-Tech Navonmesh 2026", bringing together experts including WHO-GTMC's Dr. Geetha Krishnan, Prof. Shubhada Nagarkar, Dr. Maki Kajiwara, Dr. Girish Tillu and Prof. (Dr.) Mitali Mukherjee to explore responsible AI integration in Ayurveda across healthcare, education, drug development and clinical services.

NCRTC Receives Award for Best Passenger Services and Satisfaction in Urban Mobility India and Expo

NCRTC has been conferred with an award for the best passenger services and satisfaction for the Delhi-Meerut Namo Bharat corridor at the 19th Urban Mobility India (UMI) Conference and Expo 2026, held at Bhubaneshwar. The award was presented by Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs & Power, Shri Manohar Lal, to Managing Director, NCRTC, Shri Shalabh Goel. NCRTC also secured first prize for its exhibition, recognising its commitment to enhance passenger experience and promoting sustainable urban mobility solutions.

Ahmedabad Celebrates the Joy of Reading

The Ahmedabad International Book Festival 2026 runs from October 24 to November 1 at Sabarmati Riverfront, featuring authors' sessions, cultural performances, storytelling and creative workshops to promote reading and literary engagement.

Coal India Reaffirms Its Ethical Governance

Coal India Chairman B. Sairam inaugurated Vigilance Awareness Week 2026 in Kolkata, urging employees to uphold transparency and integrity. Initiatives included a pledge, a walkathon promoting "Probity for Prosperity" and a grievance redressal camp.

LBSIM and IIMCIP Drive Student Innovation

LBSIM, Delhi, will host Hackathon 2.0 with IIM Calcutta Innovation Park on October 30–31, bringing together 55 teams to develop real-world solutions, build prototypes and identify ventures for incubation, mentoring and growth.

NHPC observes 'Vigilance Awareness Week'

NHPC CMD Shri Bhupender Gupta inaugurated Vigilance Awareness Week 2026 in Faridabad, emphasising transparency, accountability and decision-making, alongside awareness initiatives to promote ethical conduct among employees and stakeholders.

Inauguration of Vigilance Awareness at BPCL

BPCL inaugurated Vigilance Awareness Week 2026 in Mumbai, welcoming CVO Dr. Shalini Verma and releasing the Vigilance Manual 2026 and CVC Master Circulars to strengthen preventive vigilance, ethical practices and accountability, reinforcing transparency and trust.

Padma Shri Prof. (Dr.) Mahesh Verma, Vice Chancellor of IP University, inaugurates Pragati Public School's Silver Jubilee celebrations in New Delhi, marking 25 years of educational excellence with cultural performances, awards and commemorations.

Northern Railway launches a capacity-building programme for Traction Power Controllers, combining classroom sessions, simulator exercises and field visits to strengthen technical skills, emergency preparedness and train operational safety.

Shri R. Venkataramani, Attorney General for India and Court Receiver (Amrapali), and Dr. K.P. Mahadevaswamy, CMD, NBCC, hand over possession letters to 51 homebuyers at Adarsh Awas Yojana, Greater Noida West, marking the start of deliveries at the last stalled Amrapali Phase-I project.

The Delhi State Legal Services Authority under the aegis of the NALSA, organised the Third National Lok Adalat of 2026 across Delhi's court complexes, facilitating dispute settlements through digital services while promoting accessible, efficient and inclusive justice for citizens.

Shri Suneel Anchipaka, MD and CEO of DTTDC, inaugurates the Special Weekend Nights at Festival of Lights 2026, organised with Dastkar at Nature Bazaar, celebrating Indian crafts, artisan livelihoods, regional cuisine and cultural performances.

Shri Saleem Ahmad, CMD, RVNL, administers the Integrity Pledge at the inauguration of Vigilance Awareness Week 2026 in New Delhi, reaffirming the organisation's commitment to probity, transparency, accountability and ethical governance.

Dr. Ranjit Rath, CMD, Oil India Ltd., and Shri Shalabh Tyagi, CVO, administer the Integrity Pledge during Vigilance Awareness Week 2026, themed "Probity for Prosperity", in New Delhi.

PNB ED M. Paramasivam and Chief Vigilance Officer Raghvendra Kumar administer the Integrity Pledge during Vigilance Awareness Week 2026, reinforcing the bank's commitment to ethical governance and transparency.

Note: This section features information shared by organisations and does not constitute editorial content.

HT Classifieds {Wednesday}

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PANCHSHEEL PARK
Nayan Singh 9811109597
PANCHSHEEL PARK, S Block 500 sq yards,. Basement /Ground, 2 Car parking. private elevator, Ready possession. Contact 9811109597

SAFDARJUNG ENCLAVE
Nayan Singh 9811109597
SAFDARJUNG ENCLAVE A- 1 Block 300 yds 1st floor New Hight 3 BHK 2 Car Parking, Ready possession Contact 9811109597

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Independent Houses
Park Facing / Corner
KAILASH COLONY Corner 160 Yds. Wide Road. Aradhana Enclave 185 Yds Park Facing. Liveable Bungalow with Basement & Lift Multiple Options Available # 999-000-00-50

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AEROCITY DELHI
AIRPORT VIEWS
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SOUTH DELHI

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MALIK ESTATES 9810039071
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VASANT VIHAR
USED FLOORS
MALIK ESTATES 9810039071
GROUND+BASEMENT 850 yd suitable for Doctor's Clinic, Architects, CA & Lawyers, 20 year old Also 3rd Floor+ terrace 600 yd corner, 10 year old. Call Sanjay Malik 9810039071

KANT ENCLAVE
FARIDABAD
KESAR PROPERTIES
9319263555
KANT ENCLAVE, Kant Enclave Kant Enclave , Kant Enclave Suraj Kund Road Sector-40 Faridabad, Contact Kesar Properties # 9319263555.

LAND FOR SALE
200 Bigha
Residential / Farm House
9811527999
LAND FOR Sale 200 Bigha Land, ideal for Residential and Farm House Projects at Garh Mukteshwar, Uttar Pradesh. 120071 Contact number 9811527999

LODHI MARKET
Comm. Building
AMAN BAJAJ
98100-81588
LODHI MARKET - Retail. Indep. Commercial Building @25 cr Can get 10L Rent. Suits investor

DLF – SUSHANT LOK

DLF CITY
Stilt + 4 Floors
DESRAJ 9811072035
LOKESH 9811078877
DLF CITY. Wide Road / Park Facing, Tastefully Built, Stilt + 4 Floors, 4 Bedrooms each Floor. Full Building or Floorwise. Lokesh Bhardwaj 9811078877, Desraj - 9811072035

DLF – SUSHANT LOK

PRIME RENTED PROPERTY FOR SALE
Independent Building
Sunill Chandna : 9810980800
INDEPENDENT BUILDING Sec - 15 Part 2, Gurgaon, 3 Adjoining SCOs (145*3) 435 Yards, Tenant-Basement, Ground & First Floor Rent -10.60 Lac, Total Rent-12.10Lac, Lease -18 Years

NOIDA/GREATER NOIDA

INDUSTRIAL
MAAN SINGH
99999 95326
INDUSTRIAL BUILDING for Sale / Lease Plot 980 mtr. Covered Area 28,000sqft. in Sec-60, all compliance done, suit. for Manufacturing/ Warehouse/Corporate.# 9971768326

NOIDA PROPERTIES
FOR SALE
JAYPEE K-P 2 & SECTOR 26
9643-2222-35
JAYPEE K-P 2, Sector 131: 478 sq.mtr. Pair Corner Plot, 15 mtr. Wide Road and Sector 26: Urgent Sale, 250 sq.mtr. Old Duplex Kothi, G+F, 18 mtr. Wide Road. Cont. 9643-2222-35

FARIDABAD

KANT ENCLAVE
GREEN FIELDS
LOVELY REAL ESTATE
9999292524, 9811470200
KANT ENCLAVE, Green Fields Faridabad, Sale/Purchase Plots, Houses & Builder Floors. Contact Lovely Real Estate 9999292524, 9811470200

KANT ENCLAVE
FARIDABAD
RAJIV KESAR
9810944606
KANT ENCLAVE, Kant Enclave Kant Enclave , Kant Enclave Suraj Kund Road Sector-40 Faridabad, Contact Rajiv Kesar # 9810944606

CHANGE OF NAME

I, YASH Kumar Kushwaha, s/o Satyadev Kumar Prasad, R/o House No. P-40, Private Colony, Sriniwaspuri, New Delhi-110065, have changed my name to Yash Kumar and shall hereafter be known as Yash Kumar.

I, SUSHIL Kumar Soni S/o Santram, R/o 111, 3rd Floor, Krishan Kunj Colony, Laxmi Nagar, New Delhi-110092 have changed my name from Sushil Kumar Soni to Sushil Kumar. Hereinafter, I shall be called and known by the name of Sushil Kumar for all intents and purposes.

I, DOLLY Soni W/o Jitender Verma R/o H.No. 1376 Gali No. 2 Arjun Nagar, Gurugram, Hr 122001, declares that Vidya Verma and Dolly Soni is one and the same Person

THAT I Renu Aggarwal certify that my name is registered as Renu in my bank account but in my other documents my name is registered as Renu Aggarwal.

I, ROHIT Singal, S/o Shri Pawan Kumar Singal, R/o MP-114 , Pitam Pura, Delhi 110034 have changed my name to Rohit Singhal for all future purposes. Further it is declared that Rohit Singal & Rohit Singhal is one & same person.

I, KABIR Luthra, R/o A-76, 2nd Floor, Narang Colony, New Delhi-110058, have changed my name from Kabir Luthra to Kabir Singh Luthra for all purposes.

I, MUKESH Singh, S/o Shri Bhagat Singh Rawat, residing at 266/66, School Block, Gali No. 7, Mandawali Uchay Par, Mandawali, Delhi - 110092, do hereby declare that, for all purposes, my given name shall be Mukesh and my surname shall be Singh, and I wish to have my name recorded accordingly in my passport.

I, SUNIL Kumar Rathi, son of Shri Nepal Singh Rathi, resident of Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, hereby declare that my name is recorded as Sunil Kumar Rathi in my Aadhaar Card and as Sunil Rathi in other documents. Both names refer to one and the same person, i.e., myself.

I, MANOJ Chauhan S/o Deshpal Singh Chauhan, R/o F-231, Beta-2, Greater Noida have changed my name from Manoj Chauhan to Manoj Kumar Chauhan for all purposes.

I, NIRMAL Kumar S/o Jai Singh Bhesoni R/o 2 A, Royal Flats, Shipra Sun City, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014, have changed my name to Nirmal Kumar Bhesoni for all future purposes. Further it is declared that Nirmal Kumar & Nirmal Kumar Bhesoni is one & same person

I, DILIP Kumar Bachhety S/o Bhagwati Prasad Bachhety R/o 1101/32, Lotus Boulevard Espacia, GH-002, Sector-100, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201301 state that Dilip Bachhety & Dilip Kumar Bachhety both name are the same & one person.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, BHARAT Advani S/o Shri Jagdish Advani R/o H.No. C-12/3, Block-C, Sector-85, BPTP Parklands, Faridabad, Haryana-121002 have changed my name from Bharat Jagdish Advani to Bharat Advani for all future purposes.

I, SHUBHI Gupta, d/o Sachin Gupta, aged 18 years, residing at C-1/1103 TDI Kingsbury, kundli sonipat, Haryana have changed my name from Shubhi Jindal to Shubhi Gupta vide affidavit dated 19/10/26 sworn before Notary Public Parveen kumar Rai. I shall henceforth be known as Shubhi Gupta for all future purposes.

I, BENI Prasad Mahawer S/o Sunder Lal Mahawer R/o B-508 Dakshinpuri Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, New Delhi-62 have changed my minor son's name from Siddhant to Siddhant Mahawer for all future purposes.

I, BHAWIKA Bajaj, D/o Munish Bajaj, R/o B-37, 2nd Floor, Ashoka Enclave Part-II, Faridabad-121003, Haryana, have corrected my name spelling to Bhavika Bajaj via Affidavit dated 27 Oct 2026 sworn before Notary.

I, ANAND Ballabh alias Anand Ballabh Dhyani alias Anand Dhyani alias A K Dhyani, S/o Chintamani, R/o H.No. 171, Street No. 5, Tukmirpur Extn., Karawal Nagar, North East Delhi - 110094, do hereby declare that all these four names refer to one and the same person.

I, TARA Bhushan Singh S/O B.D. Singh R/O C-2C , Pocket - 2 , House No. 46 , Janakpuri , New Delhi - 110058 have changed my son's name Khitish Rajput to Yash Raj Singh for future.

I, VISHWAMBHAR Jha S/o Mahesh Kant Jha R/o B-147, Durga Vihar, Deoli, Delhi-110062 have changed my name to Biswambher Jha.

I, KUSUM, D/o Ganesh Sharma, R/o A1, Street No. 3, Goyla Vihar, South West Delhi, New Delhi 110071, have changed my name to Kusum Sharma as per Aadhar

THIS IS to certify that my surname is wrongly written in various documents as Srivastava, the correct surname is Shrivastava. My Actual name is Sunil Kumar Shrivastava S/o late Sh. Chandrama Prasad Srivastav, R/o P-20 A, Sector-23, Sanjay Nagar, Ghaziabad-201002 UP

I, SUSHMA W/o Sh. Virender R/o H.No. 296, Gram - Mirjapur, Nimka (96), Neemka, Faridabad, Haryana-121004 have changed my name from Sushma to Sushma Sharma for all future purposes. Sushma & Sushma Sharma is the same & one person.

I, SANGITA Gupta W/o Sh. Vijay Kumar Bansal, R/o Vijay Kirana Store, Bishara Road, Dadri (Gautam Budh Nagar) U.P.-203207, have changed my name to Sangeeta Rani for all future purposes.

CHANGE OF NAME

FEROZA SULTANA, W/o Md Shakil Akhtar, R/o - N95/1, Third Floor, Batla House, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025 changed my name as- Firoza Sultana

LOST & FOUND

I, RAJAT Jain, R/o 5811, Sector 38 West, Chandigarh-160036, inform that I have lost the original Allotment Letter of Flat No. C4B/071, Carlton Estate 4, DLF Phase 5, Gurugram. Lost Document Report No. 708446/2026 dated 09.10.2026, P.S. Hauz Khas, Delhi Police. If found, please contact Rajat Jain at 9810272369 or email: imjainrajat@gmail.com.

AUCTION NOTICES

AUCTION NOTICE

NISSAN CARAVAN 2WD MINIVAN
Year of Manufacture : 2016 |
Year of Registration : 2017 |
Kilometer: 64772 | Fuel : Petrol
Imported from Japan (taxes as applicable)

The Embassy of France in India invites bids for the purchase of the above-mentioned vehicle. The vehicle will be sold to the highest bidder, subject to the Embassy's right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason. Interested parties are requested to submit their bids in a sealed envelope at the Embassy's main gate, clearly written "Bid for Purchase of NISSAN CARAVAN MINIVAN - SGA, Embassy of France, New Delhi."

The deadline for submission of bids is 5 November 2026, 11 AM.

An additional tax of 6% of the purchase price shall be payable by the successful bidder. The successful bidder shall also be responsible for all applicable vehicle registration charges and related fees payable to the competent local authorities.

Eligibility Requirement: The purchaser must possess an Aadhaar card bearing a Delhi address and the vehicle must be registered in Delhi.

Inspection of the Vehicle: The vehicle may be inspected at the Embassy of France, New Delhi, by prior appointment. Appointments may be requested by telephone at 011-43196100 or by email at **scg.new-delhi-amba@diplomatie.gouv.fr** Inspections may be arranged from Monday to Friday, excluding weekends, subject to prior confirmation.

PUBLIC NOTICES

Kind Attention

It is to inform all of you that the Metro Hospital, Sector-16A, Faridabad is going to destroy all Medical Records till 2021 as per document retention policy of Government. If any person have any objection or query kindly contact hospital administration before 01st December 2026.

Administration
Metro Hospital, Faridabad

PUBLIC NOTICE

Sub: Transfer of ownership in respect of Property House No.: 766, Sector-07 Extn., Gurgaon, Haryana-122001 consequent upon the death of owner Late Sh. Tej Prakash Sachdeva S/o Late Sh. Asa Nand Sachdeva.
Late Sh. Tej Prakash Sachdeva S/o Late Sh. Asa Nand Sachdeva who was the owner of the subject cited property has expired on 06.10.2019 and has no registered/ unregistered WILL, leaving behind following legal heirs:
(1) Nirmala Devi (Wife)
(2) Dhiraj Sachdeva (Son)
(3) Ritu Bhardwaj (Daughter)
Now Smt. Nirmala Devi W/o Late Sh. Tej Prakash Sachdeva House No.: 766, Sector-07 Extn., Gurgaon, Haryana-122001 intends to apply for the transfer of property in her favor being the legal heir.
If any person is having any objections against the transfer of ibid house, he/she can submit objections in writing to the Estate Officer-1, HSVP, Sector-14, Gurugram along with supporting documents, within 30 days of publication of this notice, otherwise The Estate officer may accord permission to transfer/Re-allotment of the said property as per Huda policy and shall not entertain subsequent claim if any.

Legal Heir :- Smt. Nirmala Devi
on behalf of Estate Officer-1, HSVP, Gurugram

PUBLIC NOTICE

Sub: Transfer of ownership in respect of Property House No.: 611, Sector-7, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001 consequent upon the death of owner Late Smt. Krishna Kaura W/o Late Sh. Gurbax Rai Kaura.
Late Smt. Krishna Kaura W/o Late Sh. Gurbax Rai Kaura who was the owner of the subject cited property has expired on 14.11.2025 and has no registered/ unregistered WILL, leaving behind following legal heirs:
(1) Aridaman Kaura (Son)
(2) Ripudaman Kaura (Son)
Now Aridaman Kaura and Ripudaman Kaura both S/o Late Smt. Krishna Kaura W/o Late Sh. Gurbax Rai Kaura R/o House No.: 611, Sector-7, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001 intends to apply for the transfer of property in their favor being the legal heir.
If any person is having any objections against the transfer of ibid house, he/she can submit objections in writing to the Estate Officer-1, HSVP, Sector-14, Gurugram along with supporting documents, within 30 days of publication of this notice, otherwise The Estate officer may accord permission to transfer/Re-allotment of the said property as per Huda policy and shall not entertain subsequent claim if any.

Legal Heir :- Aridaman Kaura & Ripudaman kaura
on behalf of Estate Officer-1, HSVP, Gurugram

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is inform to General Public on behalf of my client Grihum Housing Finance Limited Faridabad that Sekh Mukaddar Alam S/o Sekh Samsul Alam availing the loan facility from my client against the House No. 69/7, Old No. E.P-22, and New M.C.F House No. 69/C,7, Old Faridabad, area measuring 45.5 Sq. yrds, Situated at Mohalla Sheikh Wara, Old Faridabad, Tehsil & Distt.- Faridabad in which Original Sale Deed No. 3424 Dated 09-05-2008 registered in the S.R.- Faridabad in favour of Sh. Parmod Kumar S/o Sh. Gyan Chand which has been lost.
If Any person/institution having any right, title, interest, claim or demand of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said property, is hereby required to make the same known in writing along with the documentary proof thereof, to the undersigned at our address as mentioned below within 7 Days from the date of publication hereof, failing which the negotiations/ deal shall be completed, without any reference to such claims and the claims if any, shall be deemed to have been given up or waived.

Lal Singh Perswal Advocate, 9811126183
Chamber No.213, L.C.B, Distt. Court, Faridabad

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is informed to general public that my Father Late Sh. Priyavart singh Narwat residing at Munda Mohalla VPO kheri kalan Faridabad Haryana 121002 has passed away. I Manender his legal heir and applying for the transfer of the property 1BPYT4A7 in my name. Anyone having any objection must submit written objection to the Property Tax Office within 30 days.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Subject:- Transfer of ownership in respect H.No.235, Sec-15, Urban Estate, Faridabad, Haryana after death of Sh. Gordhan Dass @ Gordhan Dass Nagpal (G.D. Nagpal) S/o Late Sh. Nirmal Dass.

Sh. Gordhan Dass Nagpal S/o Late Sh. Nirmal Dass R/o H.No.235, Sec-15, Faridabad, Haryana was the owner/allottee of 100% share of the subject cited property as per record of (HSVP), Faridabad, (HR). Sh. Gordhan Dass Nagpal S/o Late Sh. Nirmal Dass has died on 25.02.2019 and he had no registered or un-registered will and leaving behind the following legal heirs (1) Paraveen Nagpal (Wife) (2) Ravi Nagpal (Son) (3) Mohit Dev Nagpal (Son) (4) Archna Gupta (Daughter) and there are no other legal heirs. Father Late Sh. Nirmal Dass and mother Late Smt. Gaya Devi of Late Sh. Gordhan Dass Nagpal have already expired since long back, no documentary proof is available due to oldest.

Now, Sh. Ravi Nagpal S/o Late Sh. G.D. Nagpal @ Gordhan Dass Nagpal R/o H.No. 235, Sec-15, Faridabad, Haryana intends to apply for the transfer of 100% share of the above said property in his favour being legal heir as per death case. If any person is having any objection against the transfer of H.No. 235, Sec-15, Faridabad (HR), he/she can submit objections in writing to the Estate Officer, HSVP, Faridabad, Haryana along with supporting documents within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice, otherwise the Estate Officer, HSVP, Faridabad, Haryana may grant permission to transfer of the said property as per HSVP policy and may not entertain subsequent claim, if any.

Legal heir:-Sh. Ravi Nagpal

Before the Estate Officer I, HUDA, HSVP, Sector-14, Gurugram
PUBLIC NOTICE

Subject: Transfer of ownership in respect of constructed Property No. 404, Sector 4, Urban Estate, Gurugram consequent upon the intestate death of allottee Late Sh. Anup Pahuja

Sh. Anup Pahuja who was allottee of the subject cited property as per record has died on 29/07/2025 and has registered will, leaving behind following legal heirs:
1 Shikha Pahuja (Wife) 2 Ketan Pahuja (Son) 3. Pratyush Pahuja (Son).
Now, Shikha Pahuja W/o Late Anup Pahuja R/o 404, Sector 4, Urban Estate, Gurugram intends to apply for the transfer of the said property in their favour being the legal heirs and request for re-allotment in the name Shikha Pahuja.
If any person is having any objection to the transfer of said property he/she can submit objections in writing to the Estate Officer I, HSVP, Gurugram, Haryana along with supporting documents within 30 days from the date of publication of this notice, otherwise the Estate Officer I, HSVP, Sector 14, Gurugram may accord permission to transfer/ allotment of the said property as per HSVP policy and may not entertain subsequent claim, if any.

legal heirs: 1 Shikha Pahuja (Wife) 2 Ketan Pahuja (Son) 3. Pratyush Pahuja (Son) behalf of Estate Officer, HSVP, Sector-14 , Gurugram

Office of the Municipal Corporation, Gurugram
Public Notice

In the property tax records of the Municipal Corporation, Gurugram, the name of the late Shri Parmanand Kaushik is registered against the unique property ID 1C2WTCL5 (Plot No. 53, near Shiv Shakti Hanuman Mandir, Gurgaon Gaon, Lal Dhora). Shri Parmanand Kaushik passed away on 12-06-2021. His legal heirs, Manoj Kaushik and Naveen Kaushik (sons of the late Shri Parmanand Kaushik), have submitted an application (Request No. 0121687926-5680515) to have their names recorded against this property ID (1C2WTCL5). They have stated that, by virtue of Will No. 851 dated 08-02-2023, they are the legal heirs of the late Shri Parmanand Kaushik and have requested that their names be entered into the records.If any person has any objection to the registration of the names of the legal heirs (Manoj Kaushik and Naveen Kaushik) for the property (Property ID 1C2WTCL5; Plot No. 53, near Shiv Shakti Hanuman Mandir, Gurgaon Gaon, Lal Dhora), they may submit their objections in writing to the office of the undersigned within 30 days (one month) from the date of publication of this notice in the 'Hindustan Times' newspaper. Upon the expiry of this period, the transfer of the property record will be processed based on the documents submitted. The Municipal Corporation shall not be held liable.Please take note.
Reference No.: MCG/ZTO-IV/2026/30633
Date: 22-10-2026

HT Classifieds
FOR PROPERTY RELATED ADS
Please Contact
Abhishek Tiwari
9899865804
Gaurav
8630242501
Direct Line : 011-6656-1139